Company workspaces

The business workspace, investor room, master control and the public company site. **31 screens.**

business



Opening view



Launch tracker (1/2)

31 Security	Evidence register mapped to controls	Founder	P1	In progress	HECVAT	EVIDENCE-REGISTER.md
33 Security	Trust Center page (verified controls only)	Founder	P1	Not started	Procurement	docs/trust/
35 Accessibility	Accessibility statement + feedback route	Founder	P1	Not started	Public launch	—
38 Finance	12-month model: burn, runway, scenarios	Founder	P1	Not started	Bootstrapped planning	Budget $5k–$20k for setup
39 Finance	Unit costs: infra + AI cost per active user	Founder	P1	Not started	Pricing	—
40 Finance	Pricing memo: pilot → department → institution	Founder	P1	Draft	Annual proposal	PUBLIC-CLAIMS register: prices “planned”
41 Sales	Ideal customer profile + tier-1 account list	Founder	P1	Not started	Second pilot	—
42 Sales	Discovery + demo scripts by persona	Founder	P1	Not started	Second pilot	—
45 Sales	Results deck + annual conversion proposal	Founder	P1	Not started	Before renewal decision	—
46 Sales	Security/procurement response kit	Founder	P1	Not started	Second pilot	—
50 Customer success	QBR / renewal process	Founder	P1	Not started	Mid-pilot	—
51 Operations	Weekly operating cadence + decision log	Founder	P1	In progress	Ongoing	DECISIONS.md, docs/decisions/
52 Operations	Risk register (owner, mitigation, review)	Founder	P1	In progress	Ongoing	LAUNCH-RISK-REGISTER.md
53 Operations	Public claims approval register	Founder	P1	In progress	Any marketing	PUBLIC-CLAIMS-APPROVAL-REGISTER.md
54 Hiring	Contractor onboarding/offboarding (access, IP, NDA)	Founder	P1	Not started	Next contractor	IP assignments in place
8 Formation	Decision: convert LLC → Delaware C-corp	Founder + counsel	P2	Deferred	Before priced equity round	Bootstrapping — revisit at fundraising
17 Contracts	Mutual NDA	Counsel	P2	Not started	New prospects	—
32 Security	Penetration-test plan	Founder	P2	Not started	After first renewal	—
55 Hiring	First hire profile + trigger	Founder	P2	Not started	Second paid customer	Solo founder
56 Fundraising	Fundraising readiness checklist	Founder	P2	Deferred	When raising	Bootstrapping for now

56 of 56 · status changes save on this device

Launch tracker (2/2)

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Gap analysis | Launch tracker | 90-day roadmap | Go-to-market | Launch checklist | Pilot checklist | Risk register | Hiring plan | Fundraising | Documents & decks

Business workspace
Solo founder · LLC · paid pilot

90-day roadmapSemester company

Search or ask… ⌘K

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Business · 90-day roadmap

90-day roadmap

Days 1–30 · Make the pilot legal to run

1. Bind cyber + E&O insurance (contract requirement)
2. EIN, state tax registration, business bank, bookkeeping
3. Map every DPA/FERPA obligation to a control and an owner
4. Publish subprocessor list: Vercel, Supabase (+ AI provider, with "no student records" boundary)
5. Data inventory + data-flow map for student records
6. Retention + deletion schedule
7. Test that student records never reach an AI provider; document it

Days 31–60 · Pass the university reviews

1. Complete HECVAT Full from docs/trust + evidence register
2. Ship SAML / Shibboleth SSO with the university IdP
3. VPAT / ACR against WCAG 2.1 AA (use existing a11y tests as evidence)
4. Incident-response tabletop; record it
5. Restore-from-backup test; record RTO/RPO
6. Privacy Policy + Terms reviewed by counsel

Days 61–90 · Launch and prove the pilot

1. Agree pilot start + renewal decision dates in a mutual action plan
2. Baseline the success metrics with the champion
3. Onboarding + support intake with severity levels
4. Weekly check-in and KPI review
5. Draft the results deck and annual conversion proposal

90-day roadmap

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Business · Go-to-market

Go-to-market

WedgeUniversities first. One department champion, one economic buyer, a paid one-term pilot with named success metrics and a renewal decision date.

Offer
Registration Readiness Pilot
Buyer: Student Success, Advising or Registrar

Platform (planning)
$18 / enrolled student / yr
Floor $30,000 · planning assumption
≈EstimatedWorked out by Semester from what it knows. Not an official figure.

Premium support
15% of platform fee
Floor $15,000 · planning assumption
≈EstimatedWorked out by Semester from what it knows. Not an official figure.

Personas

Personas

Persona	Cares about	Our promise	Objection	Answer
VP Student Success	Retention and on-time progress	Fewer students surprised by holds and deadlines	Will it add work for my advisors?	Advisors see only what students share; no new queue
Registrar	Accurate records, clean registration	Students arrive at registration ready	Will it change official records?	Read-only; your SIS stays authoritative
CIO / IT	Security, integration load	One governed integration, SSO, audit	Another system to secure?	HECVAT Full, SAML SSO, RLS per tenant, subprocessor list
Accessibility office	WCAG 2.2 AA	Accessible by design, ACR provided	Do you have a VPAT?	ACR in preparation; manual test protocol shared
Procurement / counsel	Risk and terms	Standard DPA/FERPA, insurance, SLA	FERPA and AI?	DPA addendum; student records never reach an AI provider
Students	What do I do next?	One clear next step with its source	Is this tracking me?	You decide what is shared; export or delete anytime

Messaging

Headline
One clear next step for every student.
Subhead
Semester turns the semester into the next thing to do — and shows where each fact came from. Your official systems stay official.
Pilot CTA
Request a pilot design session
Proof line
In a bounded, paid pilot with one university.
AI line
AI-assisted, source-linked. Student records never reach an AI provider.

Objection handling

We already have a portal
Semester sits on top of it and turns its data into a next step; nothing is replaced in the pilot.
Our advisors are overloaded
Students resolve more on their own; advisors get shared plans, not a new inbox.
AI risk
Course AI policy is enforced, answers are labelled and cited, and records stay out of AI providers.
No budget this year
A one-term paid pilot fits a discretionary budget; annual pricing is decided after results.
You are a small company
Insurance, DPA, HECVAT and exit/export terms are in the contract; data is yours to export.

Acquisition funnel

Stage	Required evidence	Primary KPI
Contacted	Personalised outreach, channel, date, contact role	Reply / referral rate
Discovery	Pain, stakeholders, budget, timeline, workflow	Qualification rate
Demo	Role-specific demo, objections, next action	Demo-to-design rate
Activated pilot	Admin setup, invitations, adoption baseline	Activation rate
Success achieved	Outcome report + sponsor validation	Pilot KPI attainment
Annual conversion	Annual order form, scope, close date	Pilot-to-annual conversion
Expansion	New cohort/department, reference	Net revenue retention

Mutual action plan

Workstream	Customer owner	Semester owner	Completion evidence
Executive sponsorship	Named VP / Dean / CIO	Founder	Goals, decision date, sponsor attendance
Security / privacy	CISO / privacy office	Founder	HECVAT Full, DPA signed
Accessibility	Accessibility office	Founder	ACR reviewed
Integration	IT / registrar	Engineering	SSO live, data feed validated
Adoption	Champion	Founder	Invitations sent, baseline recorded

Sales process

Stage	Objective	Exit criteria
1 Targeting	Accounts with real, visible pain	Tier-1 list with named champion
2 Outreach	Relevant first conversation	Discovery booked
3 Discovery	Confirm urgent pain + owner	Champion + economic buyer named
4 Demo	Show the exact target workflow	Champion agrees success metrics
5 Solution design	Scope pilot, data, integrations	Pilot design signed off
6 Security/legal	Start HECVAT, DPA, VPAT early	Review path agreed
7 Proposal	Pilot price + annual conversion price	Mutual action plan
8 Contracting	Signature	Signed pilot (done for #1)
9 Pilot	Activation + weekly KPIs	KPIs met
10 Conversion	Results deck → annual contract	Renew / expand / close-lost

Go-to-market (1/2)

Qualification

- Is the problem expensive, risky or visible?
- Is there a champion and an economic buyer?
- Can the buyer fund a pilot?
- Can success be measured within one term?
- Can the account become a reference?

Funnel metrics

Named target accounts
Top-of-funnel capacity
Qualified opportunities
Real pipeline
Champion + buyer identified
Deal viability
Security review initiated
Institutional seriousness
Pilot close rate
Offer quality
Pilot KPI attainment
Conversion readiness
Pilot → annual conversion
Commercial proof

Go-to-market (2/2)

SEMESTER

Gap analysis | Launch tracker | 90-day roadmap | Go-to-market | Launch checklist | Pilot checklist | Risk register | Hiring plan | Fundraising | Documents & decks

Business workspace
Solo founder · LLC · paid pilot

Launch checklistSemester company

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Business · Launch checklist

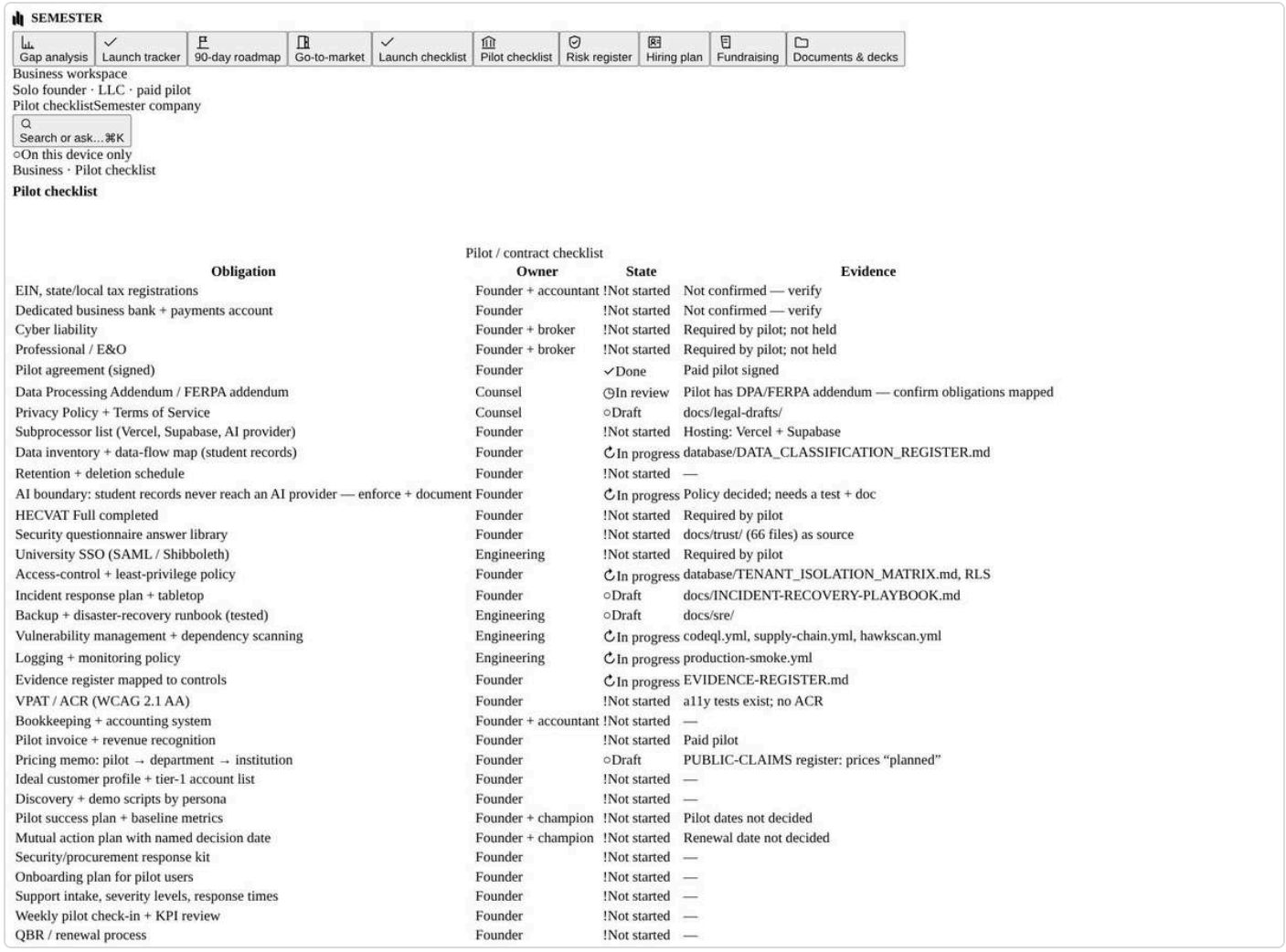
Launch checklist

Launch master checklist Each area lists what to create and the evidence that proves it is done. Counsel, accountant and broker own their rows.

Launch master checklist

Area	Create / complete	Launch evidence
Corporate	Company owns all IP; founder + contractor assignments filed	Signed assignments in records folder
Banking	Business account, approval rules, chart of accounts	Business funds separate from personal
Accounting	Bookkeeping, monthly close checklist, expense policy, tax calendar	Monthly P&L, balance sheet, cash flow
Financial model	36-month driver-based model	Unit economics, runway, break-even
Pricing	Pilot, institution, implementation, AI overage, support	Approved price book + discount rules
Insurance	Cyber, E&O, general liability; evaluate D&O later	Coverage reviewed against contract
Legal	Terms, Privacy, DPA, SLA, MSA	Versioned and counsel-reviewed
Identity	MFA on admin, code, cloud, finance, CRM, support, production	MFA report
Access	Least privilege, role review, contractor offboarding	Quarterly access review log
Data	Encryption in transit/at rest, backups, restore test	Restore test record with RTO/RPO
Monitoring	Errors, uptime, security alert triage, audit logging	Alert runbook + on-call
Resilience	Business continuity + DR runbook, tested	Tabletop record
Vendor risk	Subprocessor review + vendor register	Vendor register
Procurement	HECVAT Full, answer library, DPA/SLA path	Completed HECVAT
Accessibility	ACR/VPAT, manual test protocol, statement	Published ACR

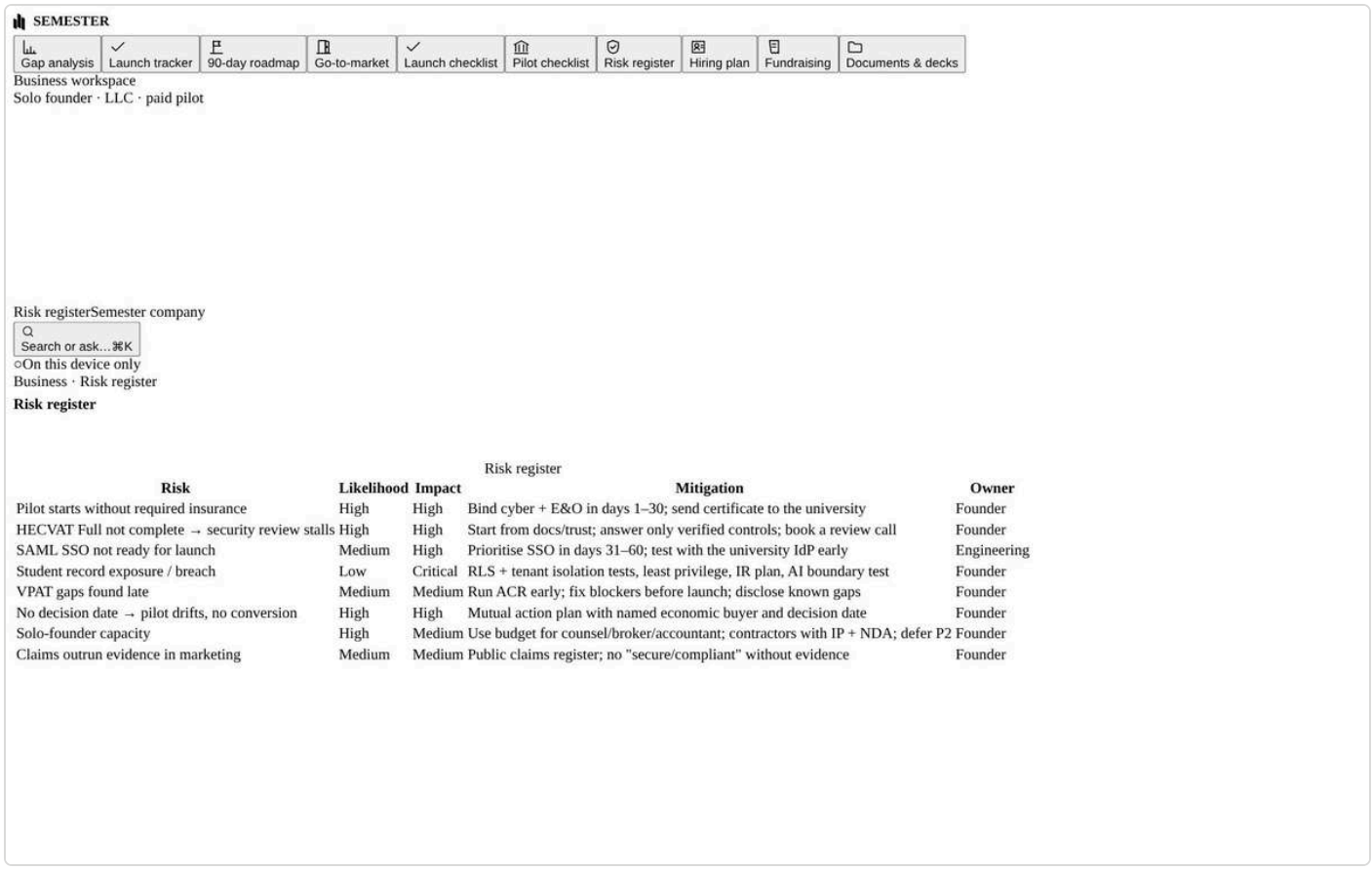
Launch checklist



Pilot / contract checklist

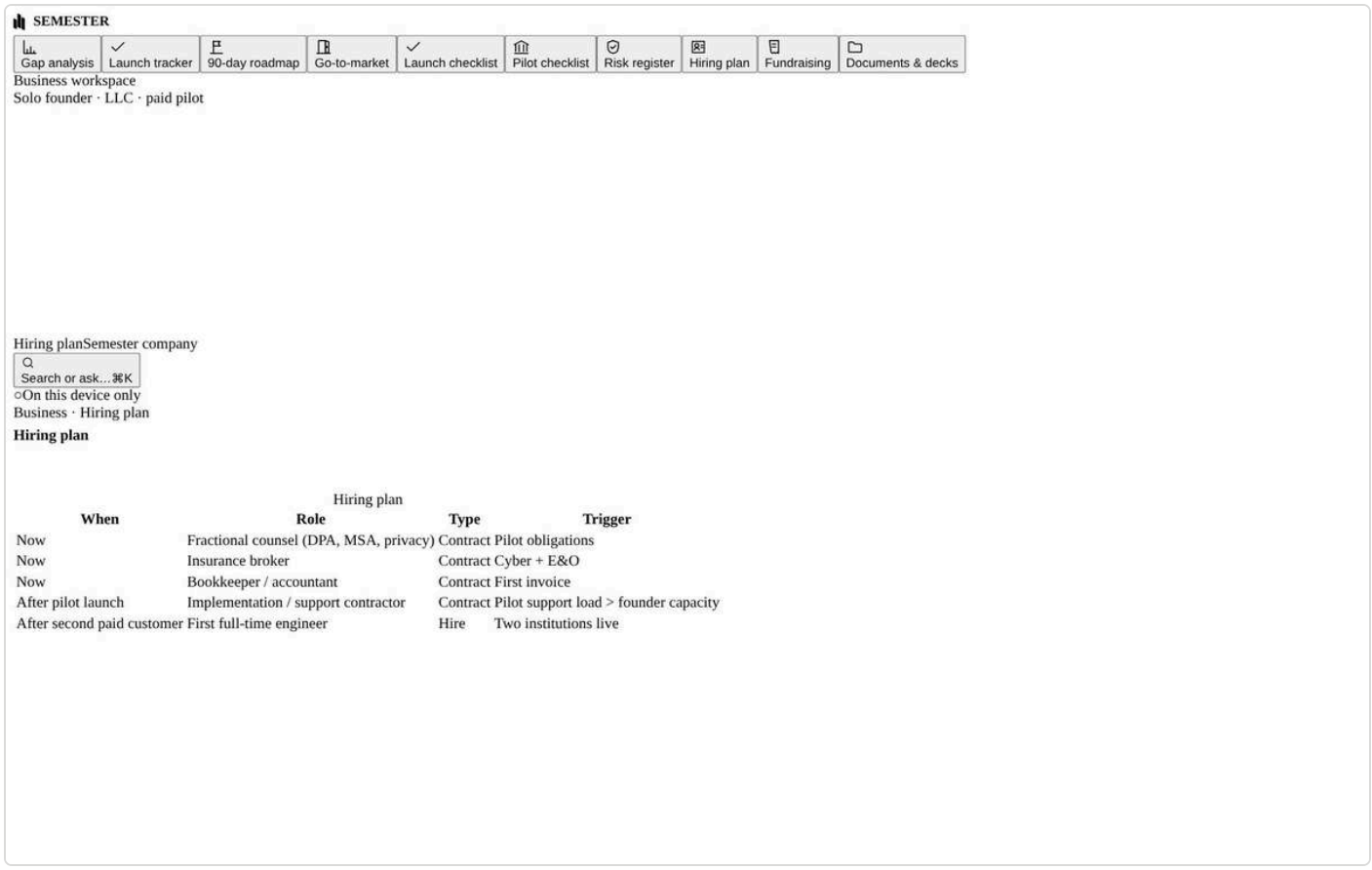
Obligation	Owner	State	Evidence
EIN, state/local tax registrations	Founder + accountant	!Not started	Not confirmed — verify
Dedicated business bank + payments account	Founder	!Not started	Not confirmed — verify
Cyber liability	Founder + broker	!Not started	Required by pilot; not held
Professional / E&O	Founder + broker	!Not started	Required by pilot; not held
Pilot agreement (signed)	Founder	✓Done	Paid pilot signed
Data Processing Addendum / FERPA addendum	Counsel	◷In review	Pilot has DPA/FERPA addendum — confirm obligations mapped
Privacy Policy + Terms of Service	Counsel	○Draft	docs/legal-drafts/
Subprocessor list (Vercel, Supabase, AI provider)	Founder	!Not started	Hosting: Vercel + Supabase
Data inventory + data-flow map (student records)	Founder	↻In progress	database/DATA_CLASSIFICATION_REGISTER.md
Retention + deletion schedule	Founder	!Not started	—
AI boundary: student records never reach an AI provider — enforce + document	Founder	↻In progress	Policy decided; needs a test + doc
HECVAT Full completed	Founder	!Not started	Required by pilot
Security questionnaire answer library	Founder	!Not started	docs/trust/ (66 files) as source
University SSO (SAML / Shibboleth)	Engineering	!Not started	Required by pilot
Access-control + least-privilege policy	Founder	↻In progress	database/TENANT_ISOLATION_MATRIX.md, RLS
Incident response plan + tabletop	Founder	○Draft	docs/INCIDENT-RECOVERY-PLAYBOOK.md
Backup + disaster-recovery runbook (tested)	Engineering	○Draft	docs/sre/
Vulnerability management + dependency scanning	Engineering	↻In progress	codeql.yml, supply-chain.yml, hawkscan.yml
Logging + monitoring policy	Engineering	↻In progress	production-smoke.yml
Evidence register mapped to controls	Founder	↻In progress	EVIDENCE-REGISTER.md
VPAT / ACR (WCAG 2.1 AA)	Founder	!Not started	a11y tests exist; no ACR
Bookkeeping + accounting system	Founder + accountant	!Not started	—
Pilot invoice + revenue recognition	Founder	!Not started	Paid pilot
Pricing memo: pilot → department → institution	Founder	○Draft	PUBLIC-CLAIMS register: prices “planned”
Ideal customer profile + tier-1 account list	Founder	!Not started	—
Discovery + demo scripts by persona	Founder	!Not started	—
Pilot success plan + baseline metrics	Founder + champion	!Not started	Pilot dates not decided
Mutual action plan with named decision date	Founder + champion	!Not started	Renewal date not decided
Security/procurement response kit	Founder	!Not started	—
Onboarding plan for pilot users	Founder	!Not started	—
Support intake, severity levels, response times	Founder	!Not started	—
Weekly pilot check-in + KPI review	Founder	!Not started	—
QBR / renewal process	Founder	!Not started	—

Pilot checklist

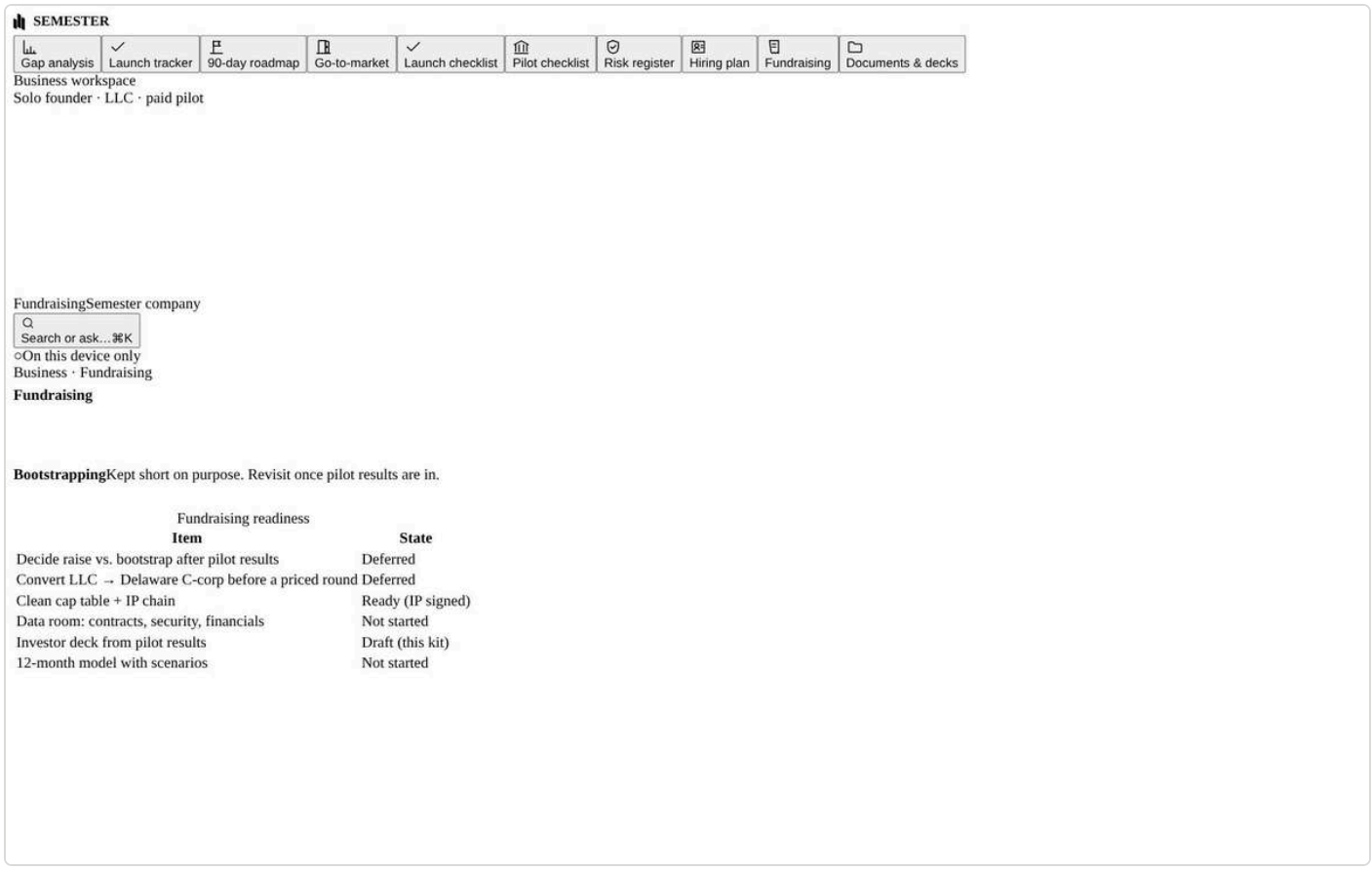


Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Owner
Pilot starts without required insurance	High	High	Bind cyber + E&O in days 1–30; send certificate to the university	Founder
HECVAT Full not complete → security review stalls	High	High	Start from docs/trust; answer only verified controls; book a review call	Founder
SAML SSO not ready for launch	Medium	High	Prioritise SSO in days 31–60; test with the university IdP early	Engineering
Student record exposure / breach	Low	Critical	RLS + tenant isolation tests, least privilege, IR plan, AI boundary test	Founder
VPAT gaps found late	Medium	Medium	Run ACR early; fix blockers before launch; disclose known gaps	Founder
No decision date → pilot drifts, no conversion	High	High	Mutual action plan with named economic buyer and decision date	Founder
Solo-founder capacity	High	Medium	Use budget for counsel/broker/accountant; contractors with IP + NDA; defer P2	Founder
Claims outrun evidence in marketing	Medium	Medium	Public claims register; no "secure/compliant" without evidence	Founder

Risk register


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Gap analysis
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Launch checklist
Pilot checklist
Risk register
Hiring plan
Fundraising
Documents & decks
Business workspace
Solo founder · LLC · paid pilot
Hiring planSemester company
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Hiring plan
Hiring plan
When
Role
Type
Trigger
Now
Fractional counsel (DPA, MSA, privacy)
Contract
Pilot obligations
Now
Insurance broker
Contract
Cyber + E&O
Now
Bookkeeper / accountant
Contract
First invoice
After pilot launch
Implementation / support contractor
Contract
Pilot support load > founder capacity
After second paid customer
First full-time engineer
Hire
Two institutions live

Hiring plan



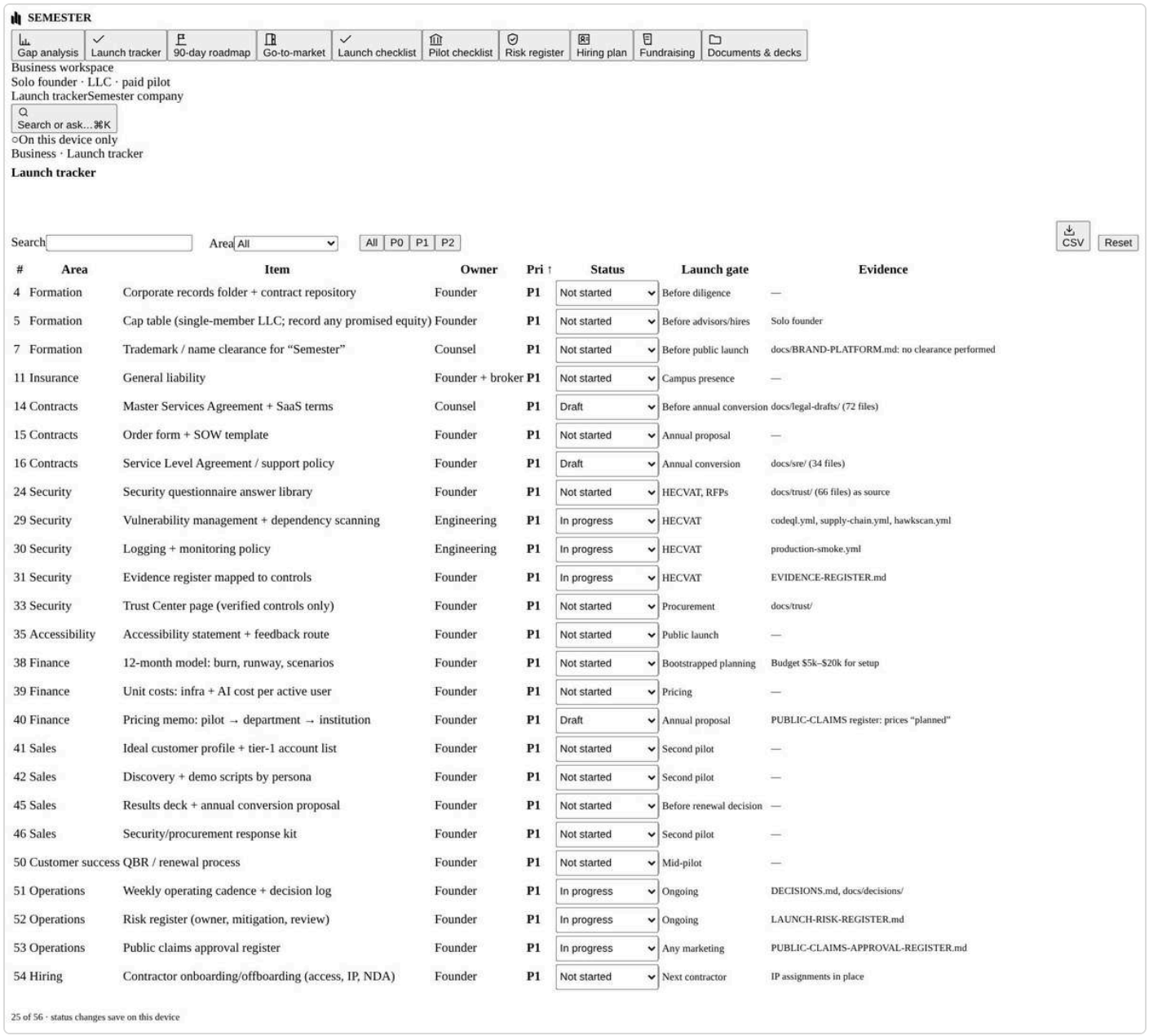
Fundraising



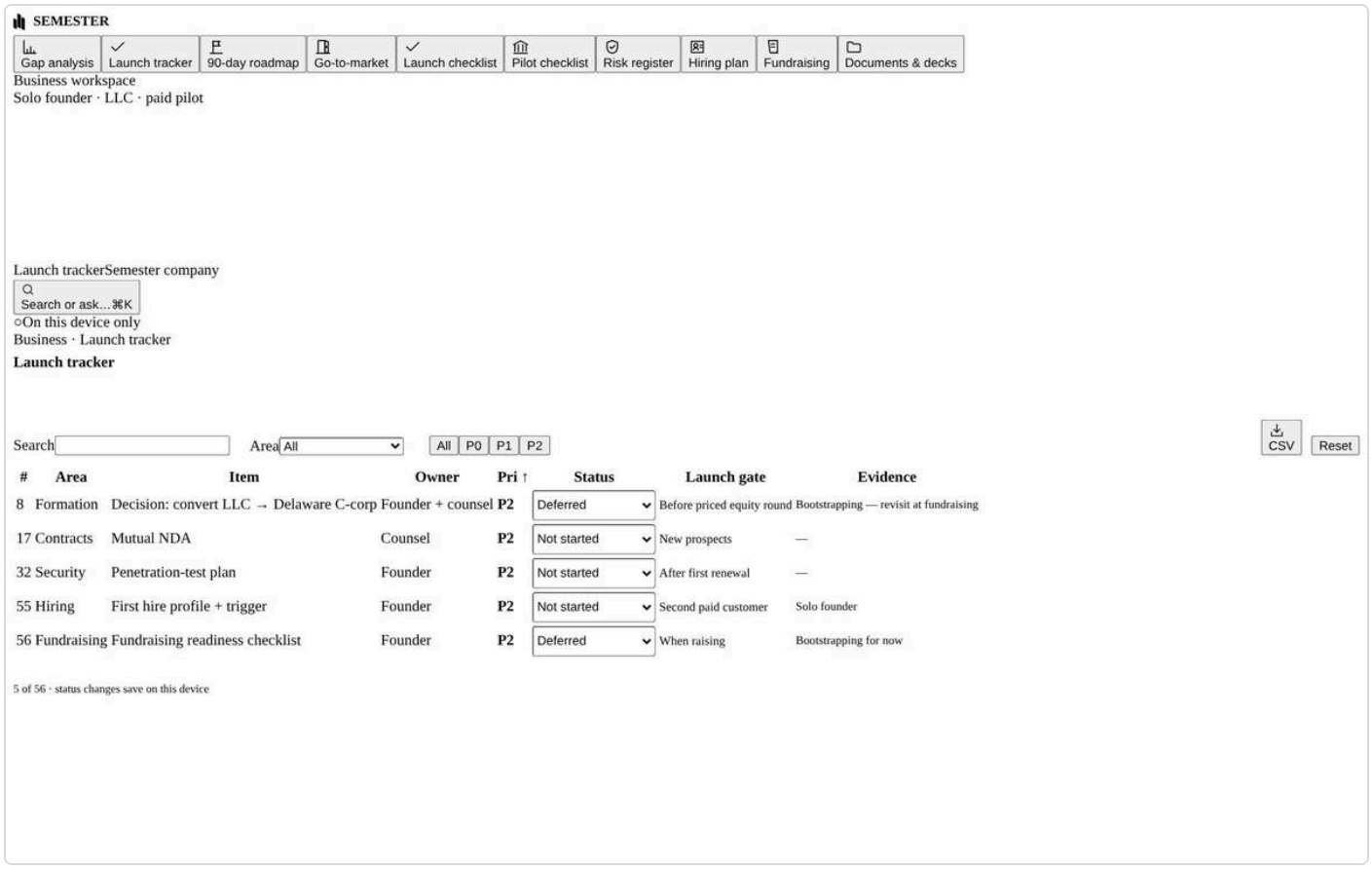
Documents & decks



Launch tracker › P0

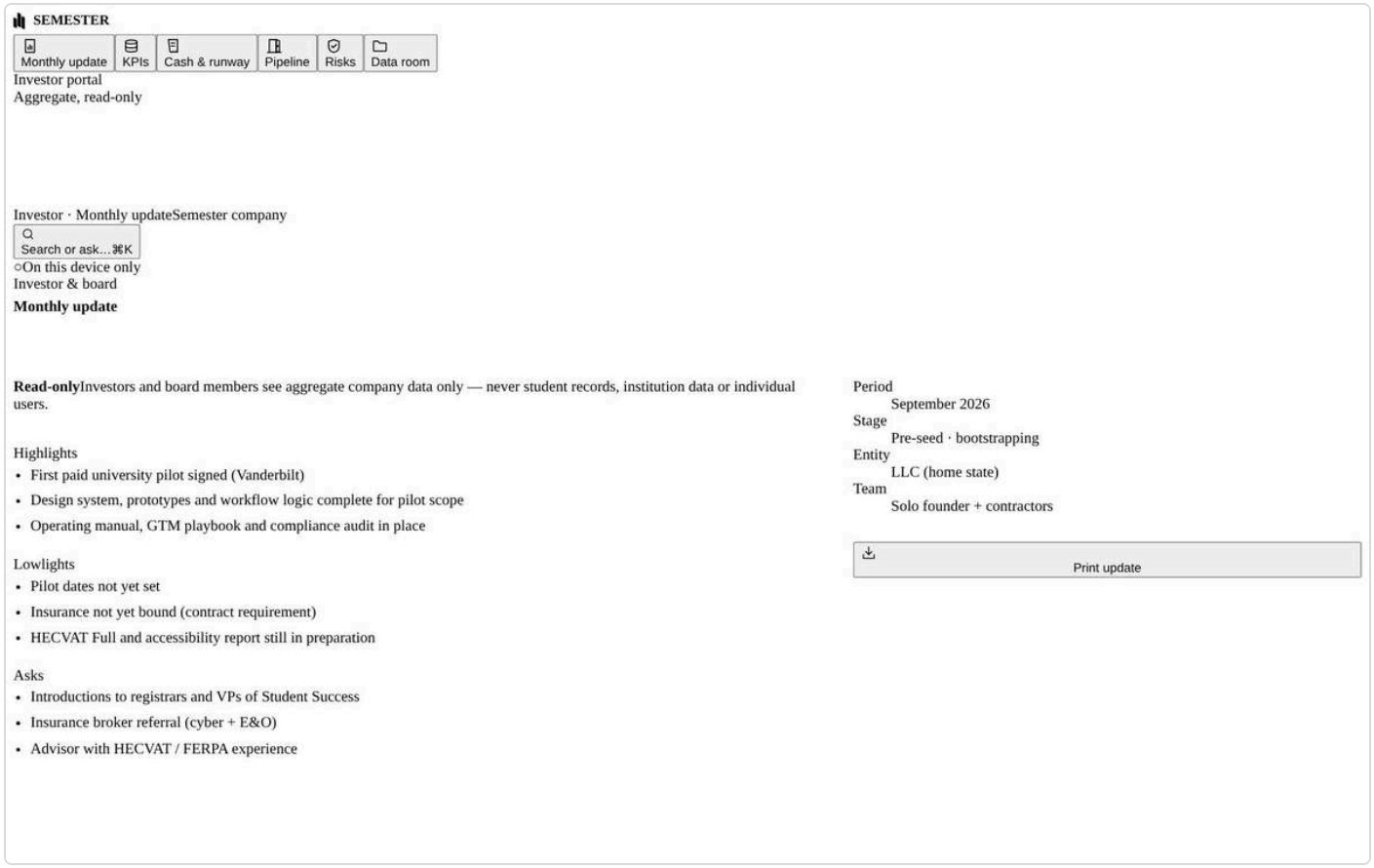


Launch tracker › P1

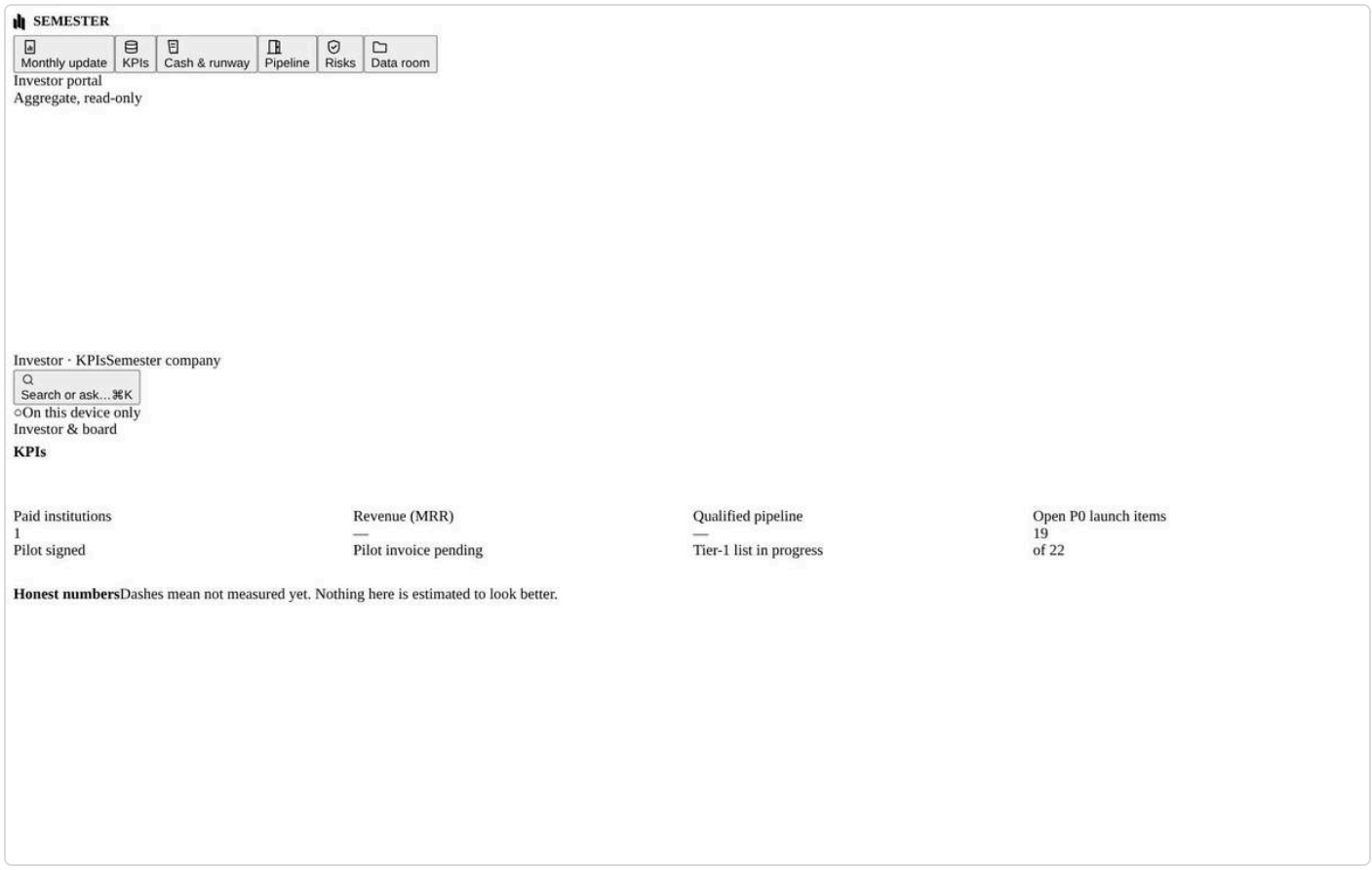


Launch tracker › P2

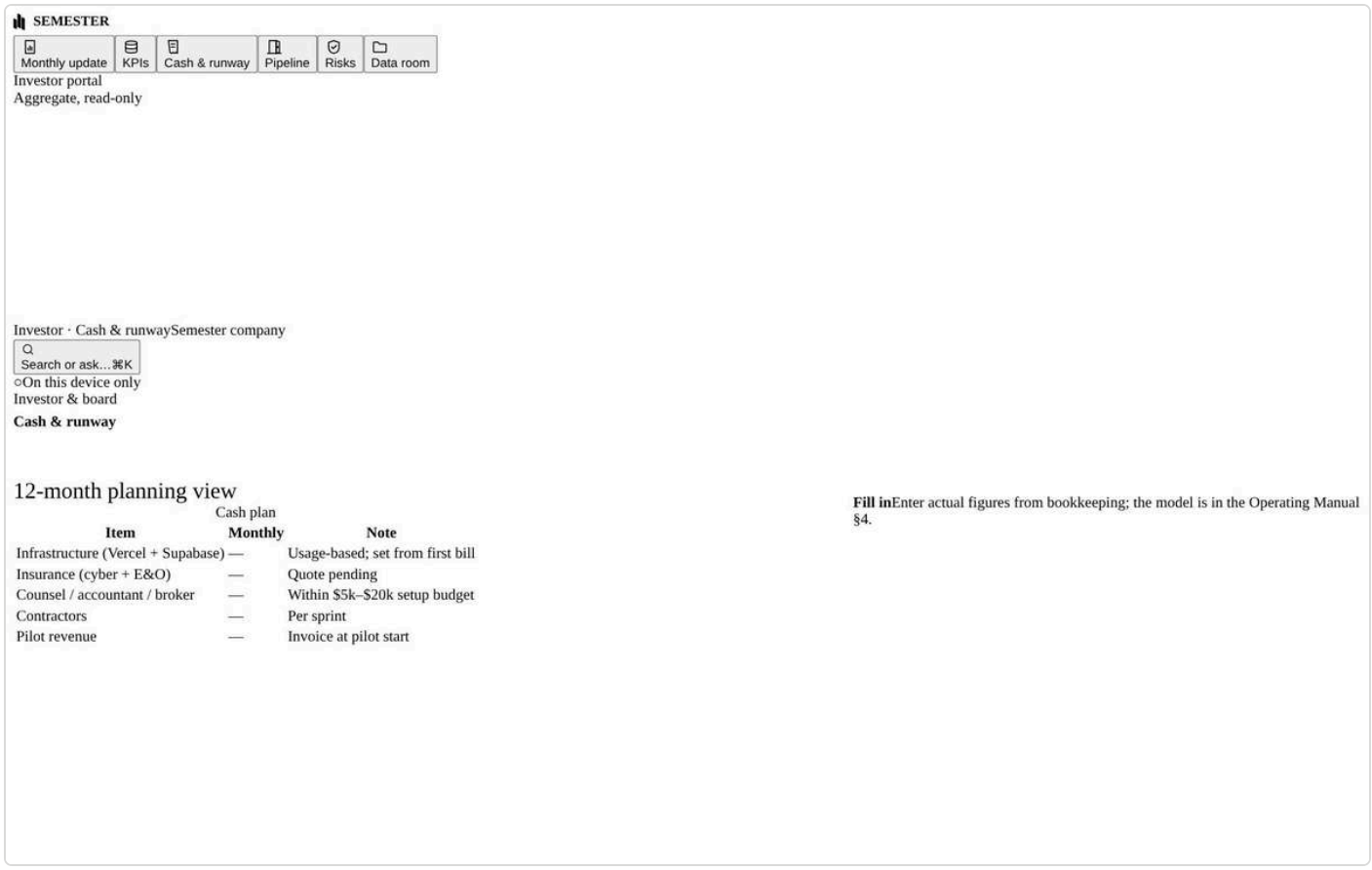
investor



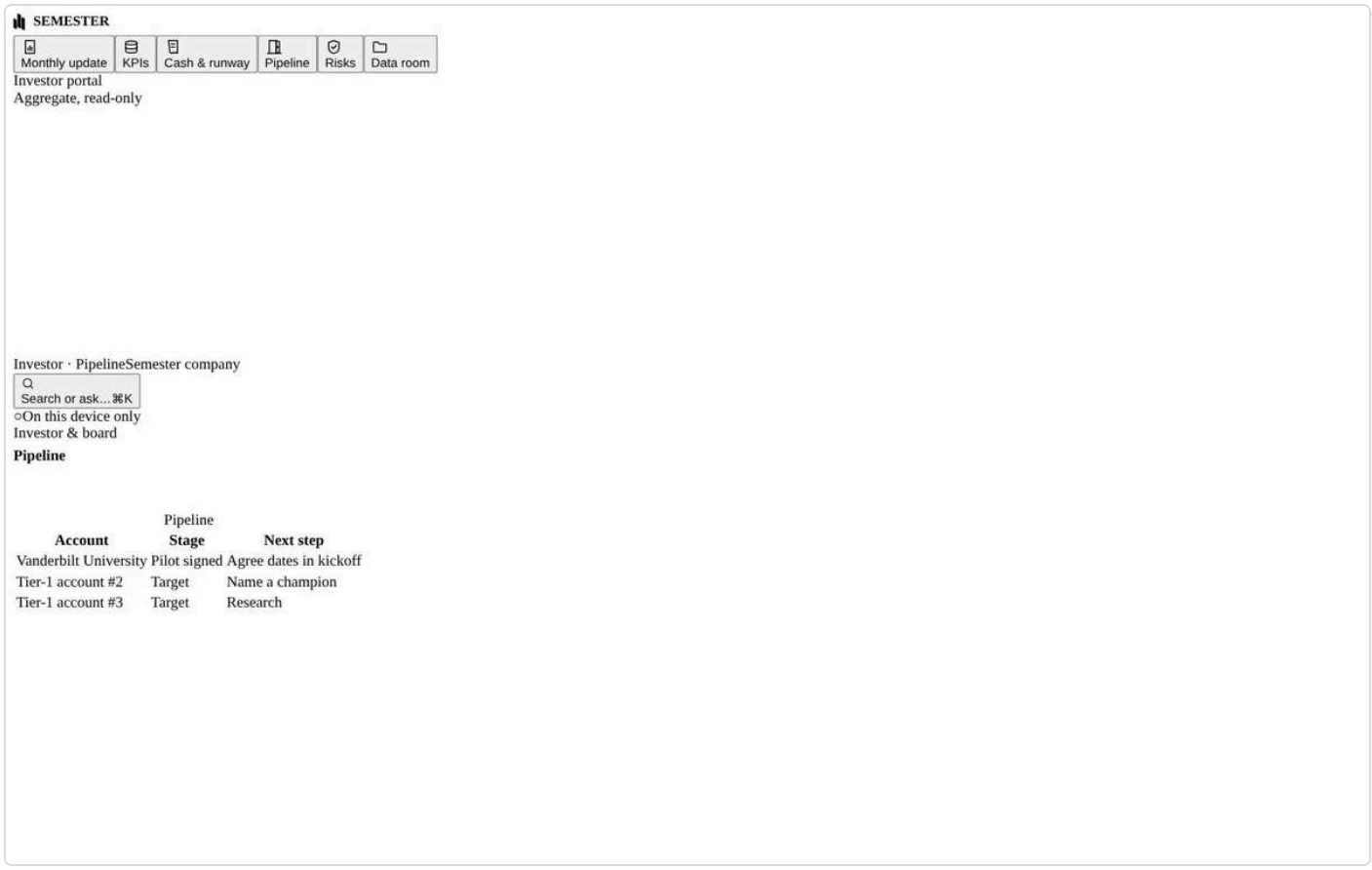
Opening view


SEMESTER
Monthly update
KPIs
Cash & runway
Pipeline
Risks
Data room
Investor portal
Aggregate, read-only
Investor · KPIsSemester company
Search or ask… ⌘K
On this device only
Investor & board
KPIs
Paid institutions
1
Pilot signed
Revenue (MRR)
—
Pilot invoice pending
Qualified pipeline
—
Tier-1 list in progress
Open P0 launch items
19
of 22
Honest numbersDashes mean not measured yet. Nothing here is estimated to look better.

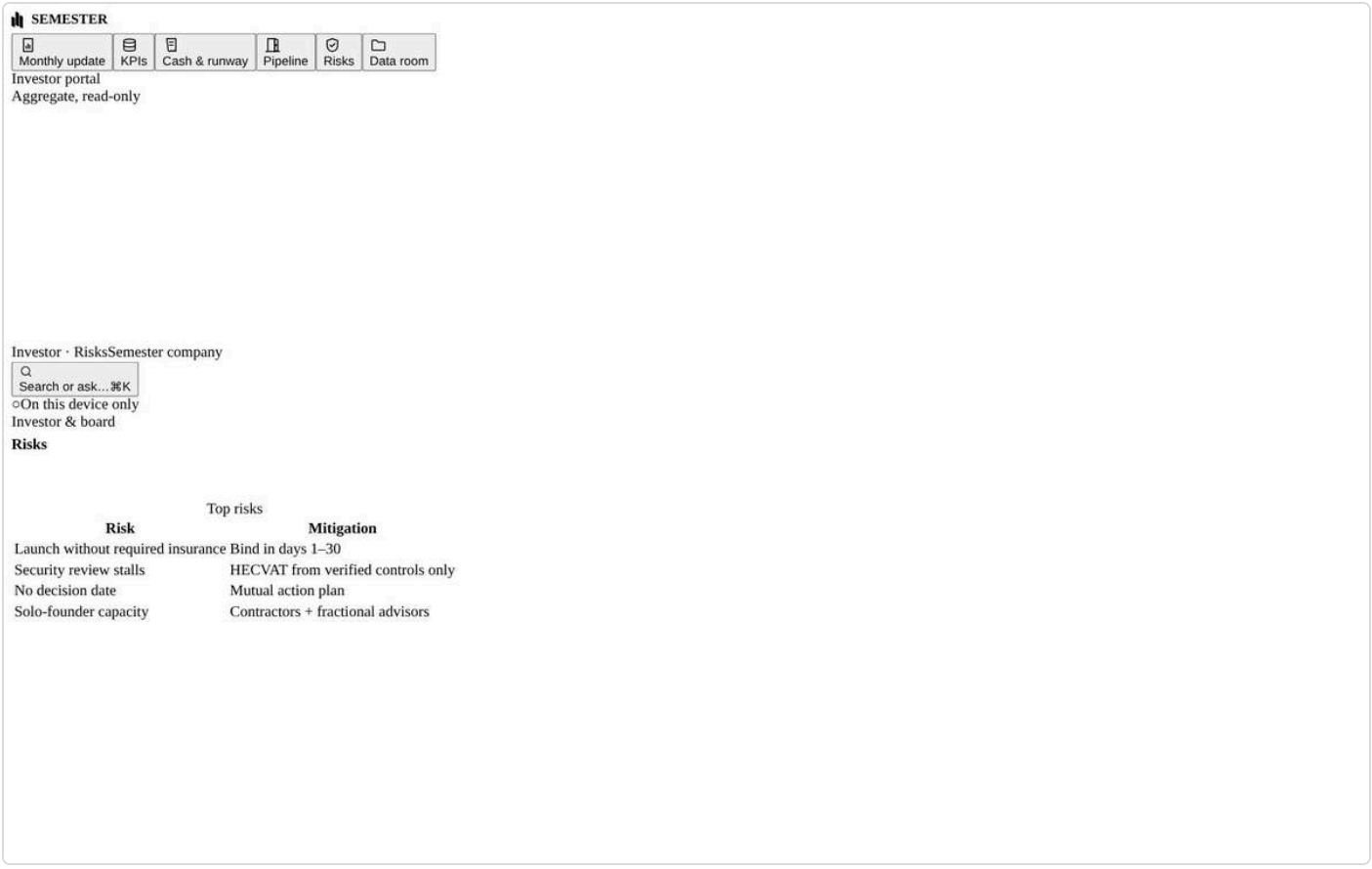
KPIs


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Cash & runway
12-month planning view
Cash plan
Item
Monthly
Note
Infrastructure (Vercel + Supabase) —
Usage-based; set from first bill
Insurance (cyber + E&O) —
Quote pending
Counsel / accountant / broker —
Within $5k–$20k setup budget
Contractors —
Per sprint
Pilot revenue —
Invoice at pilot start
Fill inEnter actual figures from bookkeeping; the model is in the Operating Manual §4.

Cash & runway


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Pipeline
Account
Stage
Next step
Vanderbilt University
Pilot signed
Agree dates in kickoff
Tier-1 account #2
Target
Name a champion
Tier-1 account #3
Target
Research

Pipeline

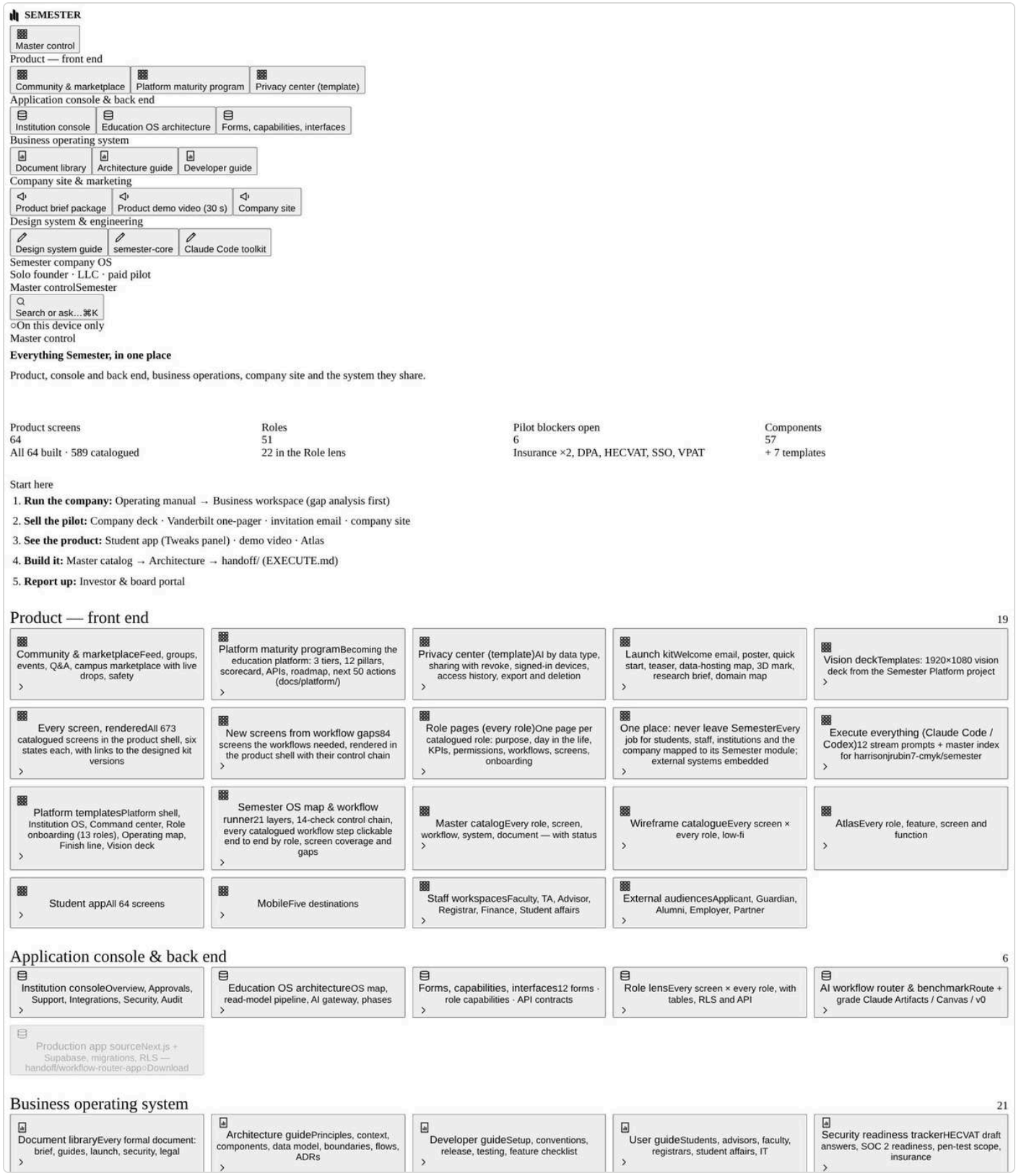

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Risks
Top risks
Risk
Mitigation
Launch without required insurance
Bind in days 1–30
Security review stalls
HECVAT from verified controls only
No decision date
Mutual action plan
Solo-founder capacity
Contractors + fractional advisors

Risks

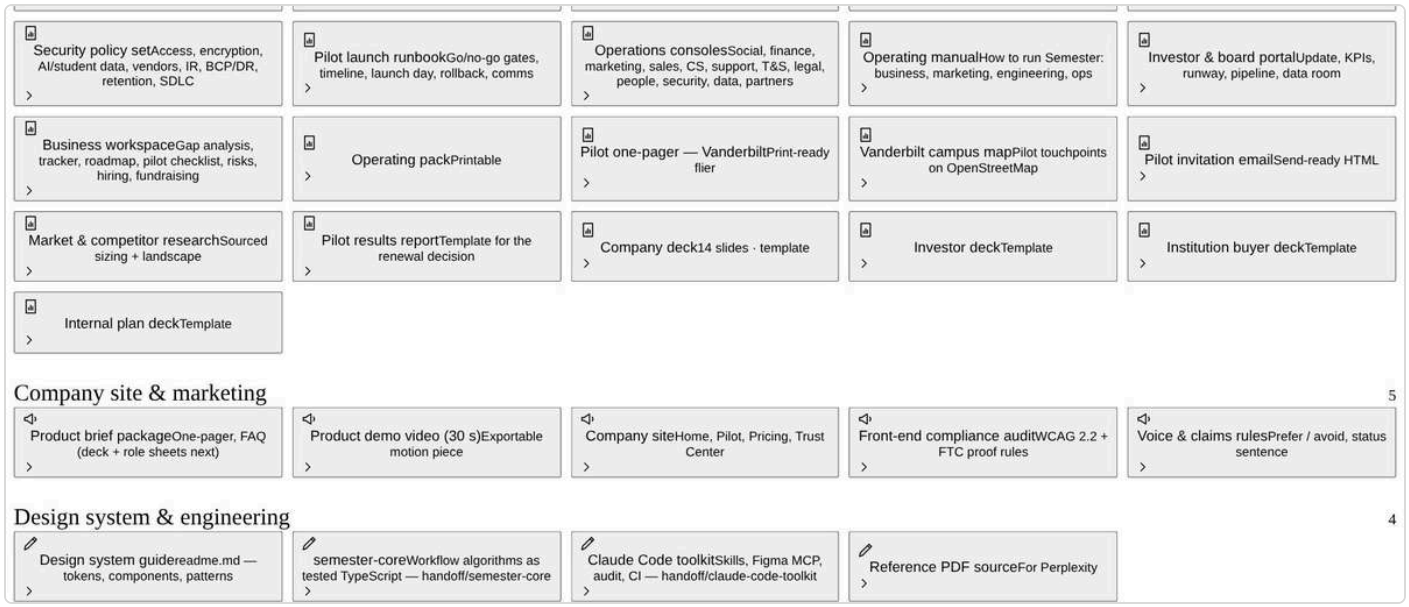

SEMESTER
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Investor & board
Data room
Company deckOpen
Investor deckOpen
Market & competitor researchOpen
Operating manualOpen
ArchitectureOpen
Master catalogOpen

Data room

master-control



Opening view (1/2)

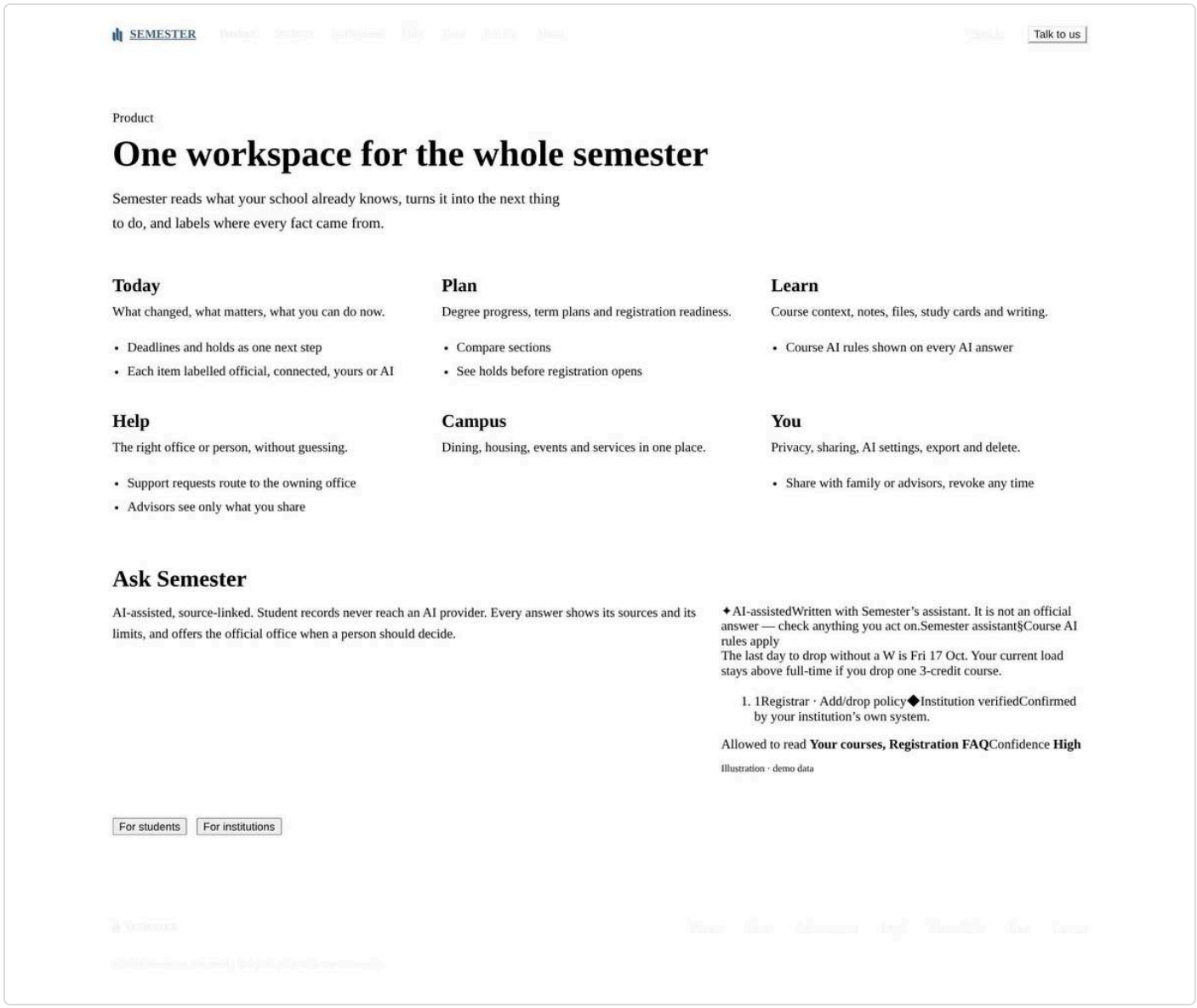


Opening view (2/2)

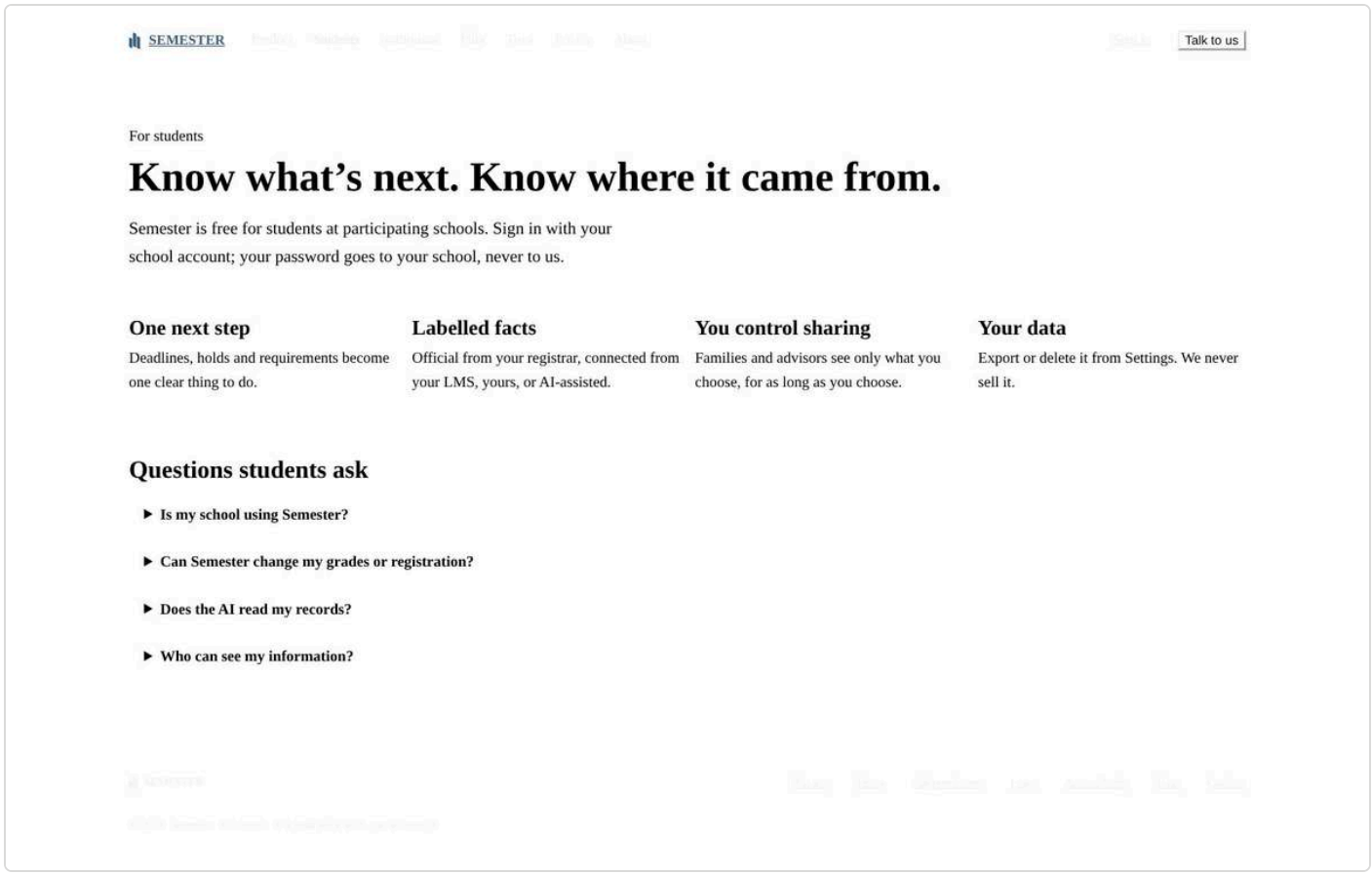
company-site



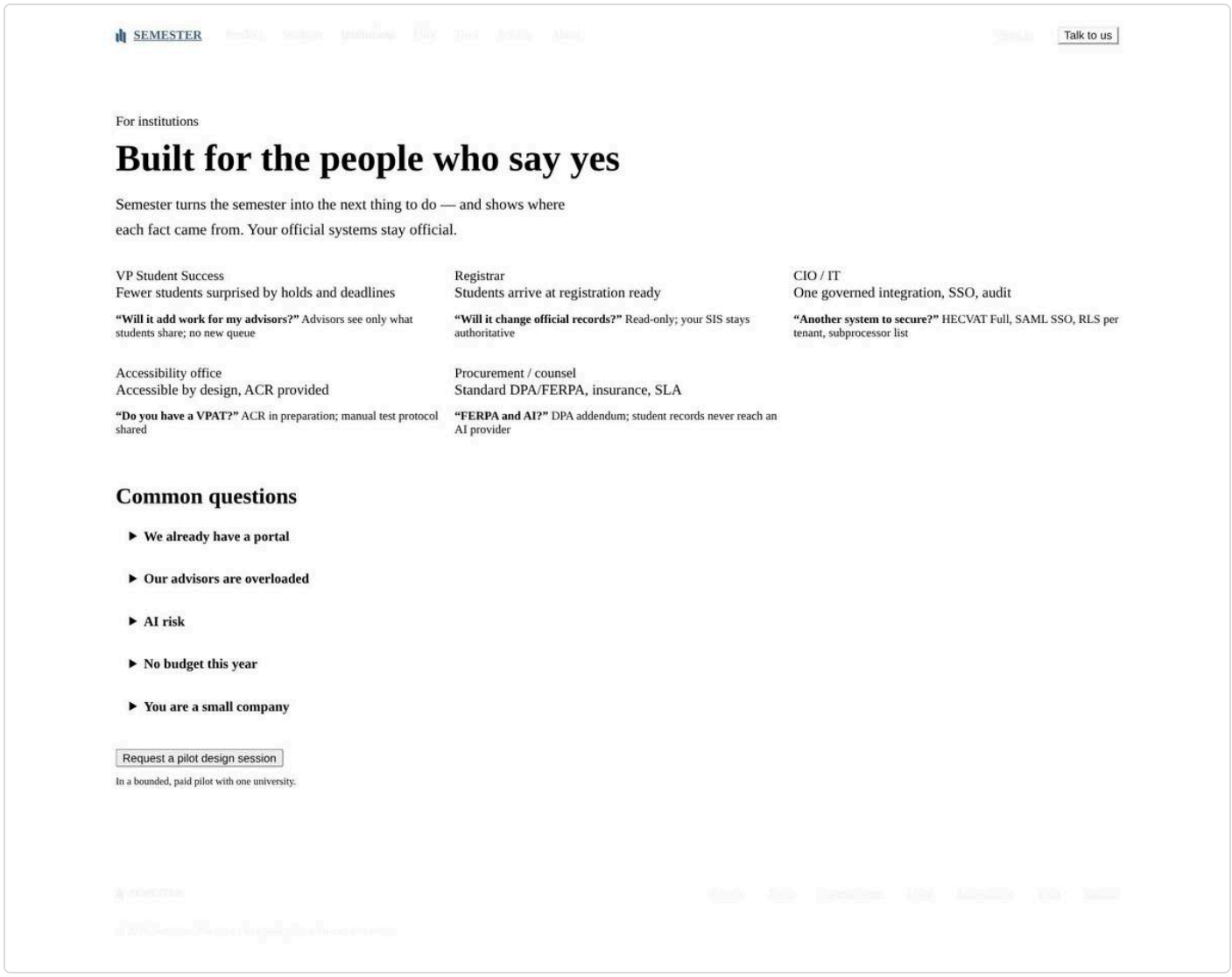
Opening view


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Product
One workspace for the whole semester
Semester reads what your school already knows, turns it into the next thing to do, and labels where every fact came from.
Today
What changed, what matters, what you can do now.
Deadlines and holds as one next step
Each item labelled official, connected, yours or AI
Plan
Degree progress, term plans and registration readiness.
Compare sections
See holds before registration opens
Learn
Course context, notes, files, study cards and writing.
Course AI rules shown on every AI answer
Help
The right office or person, without guessing.
Support requests route to the owning office
Advisors see only what you share
Campus
Dining, housing, events and services in one place.
You
Privacy, sharing, AI settings, export and delete.
Share with family or advisors, revoke any time
Ask Semester
AI-assisted, source-linked. Student records never reach an AI provider. Every answer shows its sources and its limits, and offers the official office when a person should decide.
✦AI-assistedWritten with Semester's assistant. It is not an official answer — check anything you act on.Semester assistant§Course AI rules apply
The last day to drop without a W is Fri 17 Oct. Your current load stays above full-time if you drop one 3-credit course.
1. 1Registrar · Add/drop policy◆Institution verifiedConfirmed by your institution's own system.
Allowed to read Your courses, Registration FAQConfidence High
Illustration · demo data
For students
For institutions

Product


SEMESTER
Talk to us
For students
Know what’s next. Know where it came from.
Semester is free for students at participating schools. Sign in with your school account; your password goes to your school, never to us.
One next step
Deadlines, holds and requirements become one clear thing to do.
Labelled facts
Official from your registrar, connected from your LMS, yours, or AI-assisted.
You control sharing
Families and advisors see only what you choose, for as long as you choose.
Your data
Export or delete it from Settings. We never sell it.
Questions students ask
Is my school using Semester?
Can Semester change my grades or registration?
Does the AI read my records?
Who can see my information?

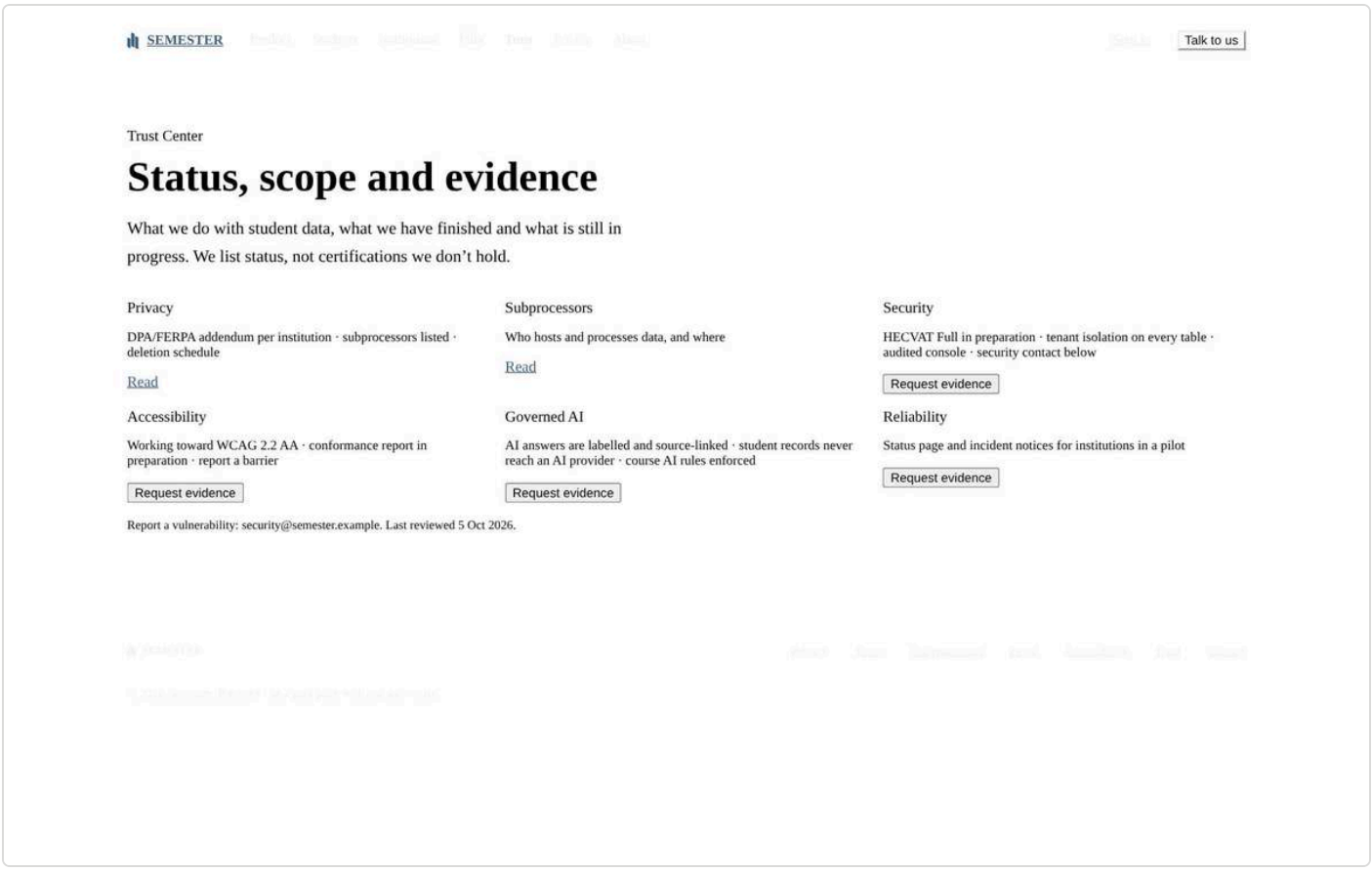
Students



Institutions


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Registration Readiness Pilot
A one-term pilot with named success measures
Paid, bounded and read-only. You agree the measures before launch, and the results decide what happens next.
Who it’s for
A student success, advising or registrar team that wants fewer students surprised by holds and missed registration steps.
What changes
Students in the pilot cohort see one next step for registration, with the source of each fact. Advisors see what students choose to share.
Scope and non-goals
One term, one cohort. Read-only SIS and LMS connection. No changes to official records; no replacement of existing systems.
Timeline
About six weeks of setup before launch: contracts and security review, SSO and SIS connection, staff training, then a dry run.
Data, security, accessibility
DPA/FERPA addendum, HECVAT Full, SAML SSO and an accessibility conformance report. Student records never reach an AI provider.
Success measures
Agreed and signed before launch, measured against a baseline, reported at the end of term.
Roles
Your sponsor, champion, IT and registrar contacts; Semester runs setup, support and reporting.
After the pilot
A results report, then a decision: annual agreement, a second term, or a clean exit with your data exported and deleted.
Request a pilot design session
Name (required)
Work email (required)
Institution type
University
Anything we should know
Send
We reply within two business days. No marketing list. Please don’t include student information.

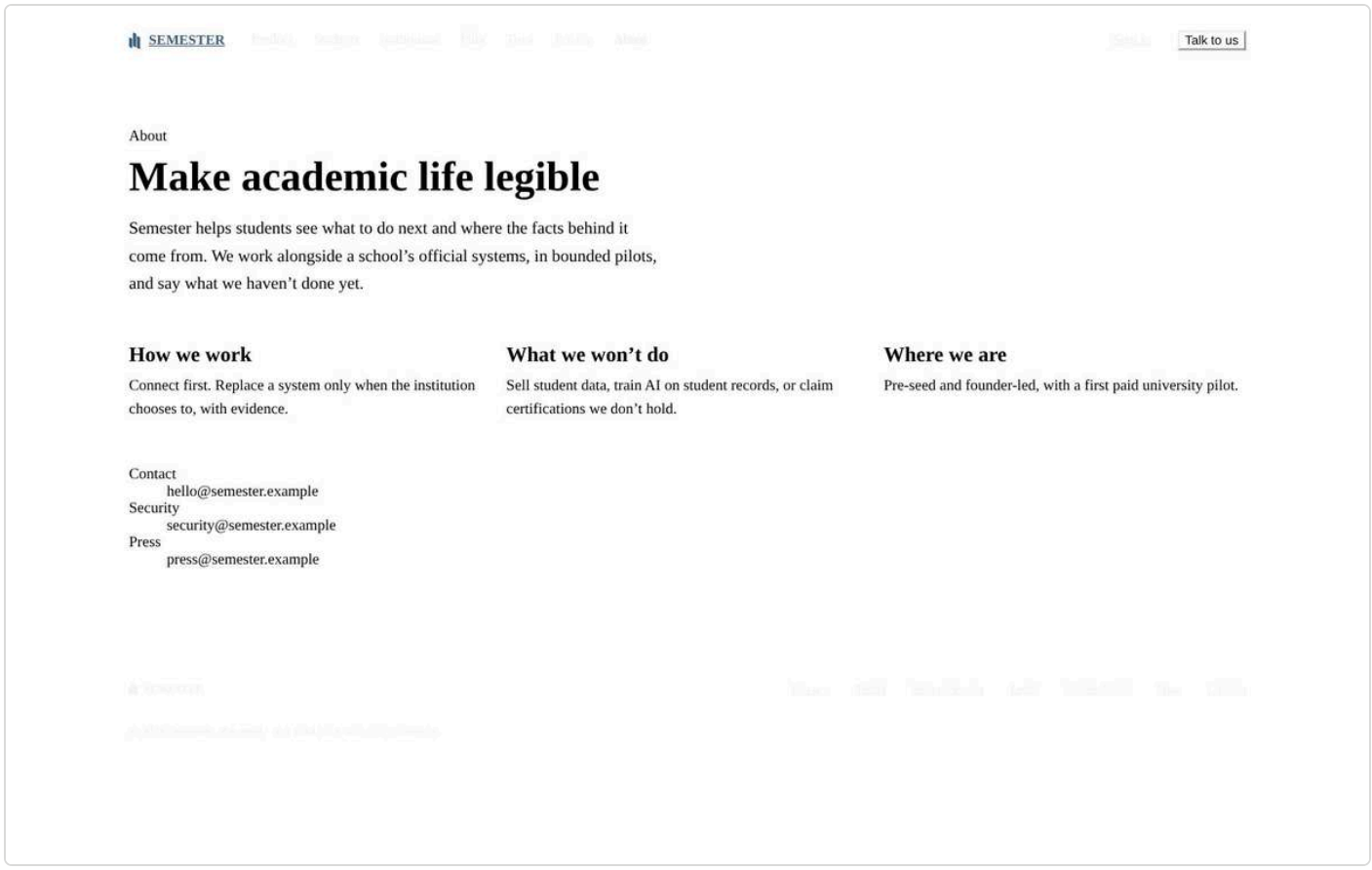
Pilot


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Trust Center
Status, scope and evidence
What we do with student data, what we have finished and what is still in progress. We list status, not certifications we don’t hold.
Privacy
DPA/FERPA addendum per institution · subprocessors listed · deletion schedule
Read
Subprocessors
Who hosts and processes data, and where
Read
Security
HECVAT Full in preparation · tenant isolation on every table · audited console · security contact below
Request evidence
Accessibility
Working toward WCAG 2.2 AA · conformance report in preparation · report a barrier
Request evidence
Governed AI
AI answers are labelled and source-linked · student records never reach an AI provider · course AI rules enforced
Request evidence
Reliability
Status page and incident notices for institutions in a pilot
Request evidence
Report a vulnerability: security@semester.example. Last reviewed 5 Oct 2026.

Trust


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Pricing
Plans
Free for students. Institution prices are quoted per pilot and per campus; they are not published yet.
Student
Free
Planning workspace, Today, sharing
Pilot
Quoted
One term, named measures, SSO, read-only connection
Institution
Quoted
Console, integrations, SSO, annual
Enterprise
Quoted
Multi-campus, advanced controls
Features
Feature
Student
Department
Institution
Enterprise
Student planning workspace
Included
Included
Included
Included
Advisor workflows
Limited
Included
Included
Advanced
Tenant configuration
—
Limited
Included
Advanced
SSO
—
Optional
Included
Required
Integrations
—
Limited
Included
Advanced
Premium support
—
Add-on
Add-on
Included
Ask for a quote

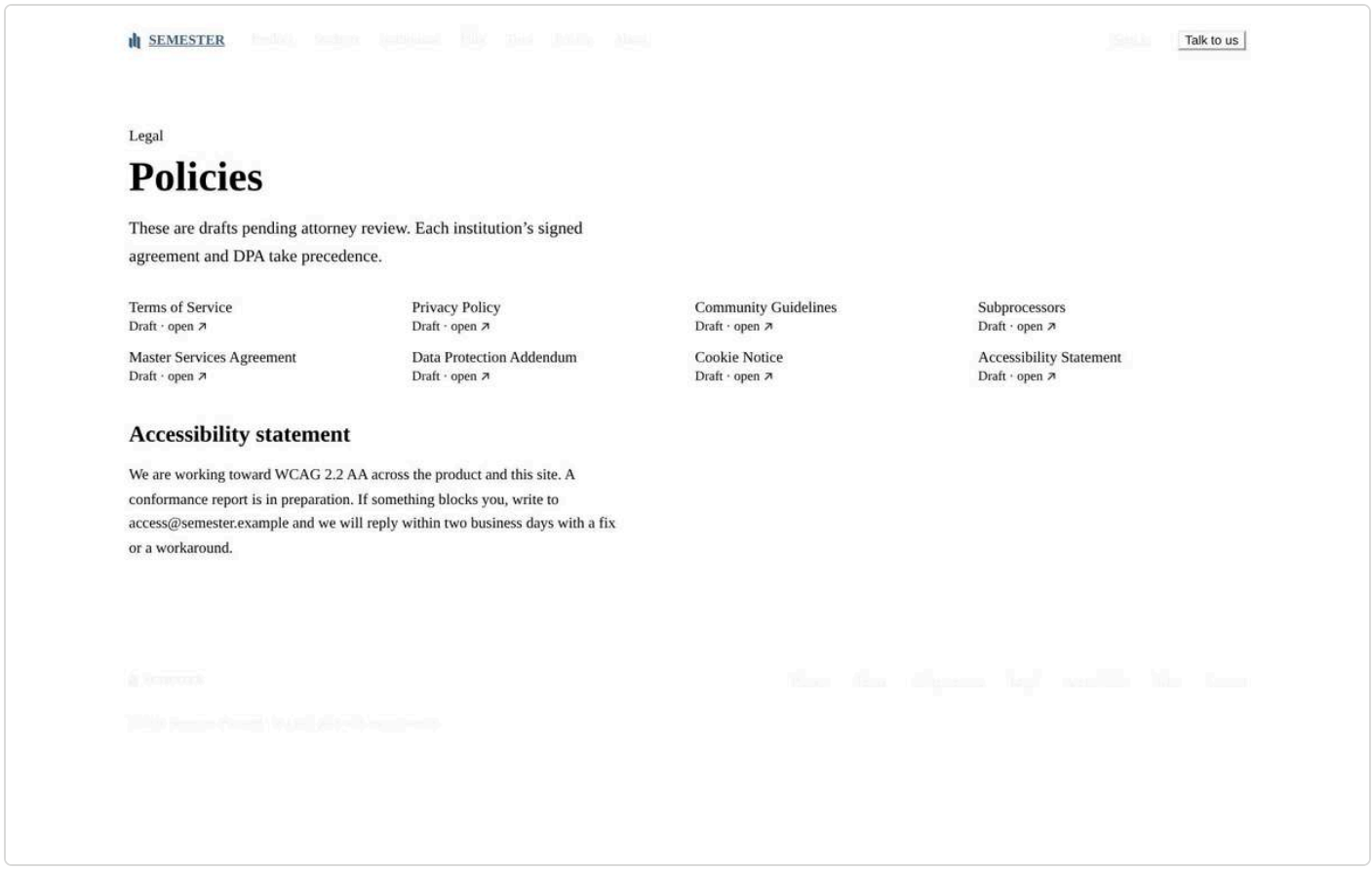
Pricing


SEMESTER
Talk to us
About
Make academic life legible
Semester helps students see what to do next and where the facts behind it come from. We work alongside a school’s official systems, in bounded pilots, and say what we haven’t done yet.
How we work
Connect first. Replace a system only when the institution chooses to, with evidence.
What we won’t do
Sell student data, train AI on student records, or claim certifications we don’t hold.
Where we are
Pre-seed and founder-led, with a first paid university pilot.
Contact
hello@semester.example
Security
security@semester.example
Press
press@semester.example

About


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Contact
Talk to us
Pilots, pricing, security reviews or accessibility questions. A person replies within two business days.
General
hello@semester.example
Security
security@semester.example
Accessibility
access@semester.example
Students: questions about your account go to your school's help desk first.
Send a message
Name (required)
Work email (required)
Topic
Pilot or pricing
Anything we should know
Send
We reply within two business days. No marketing list. Please don't include student information.

Talk to us

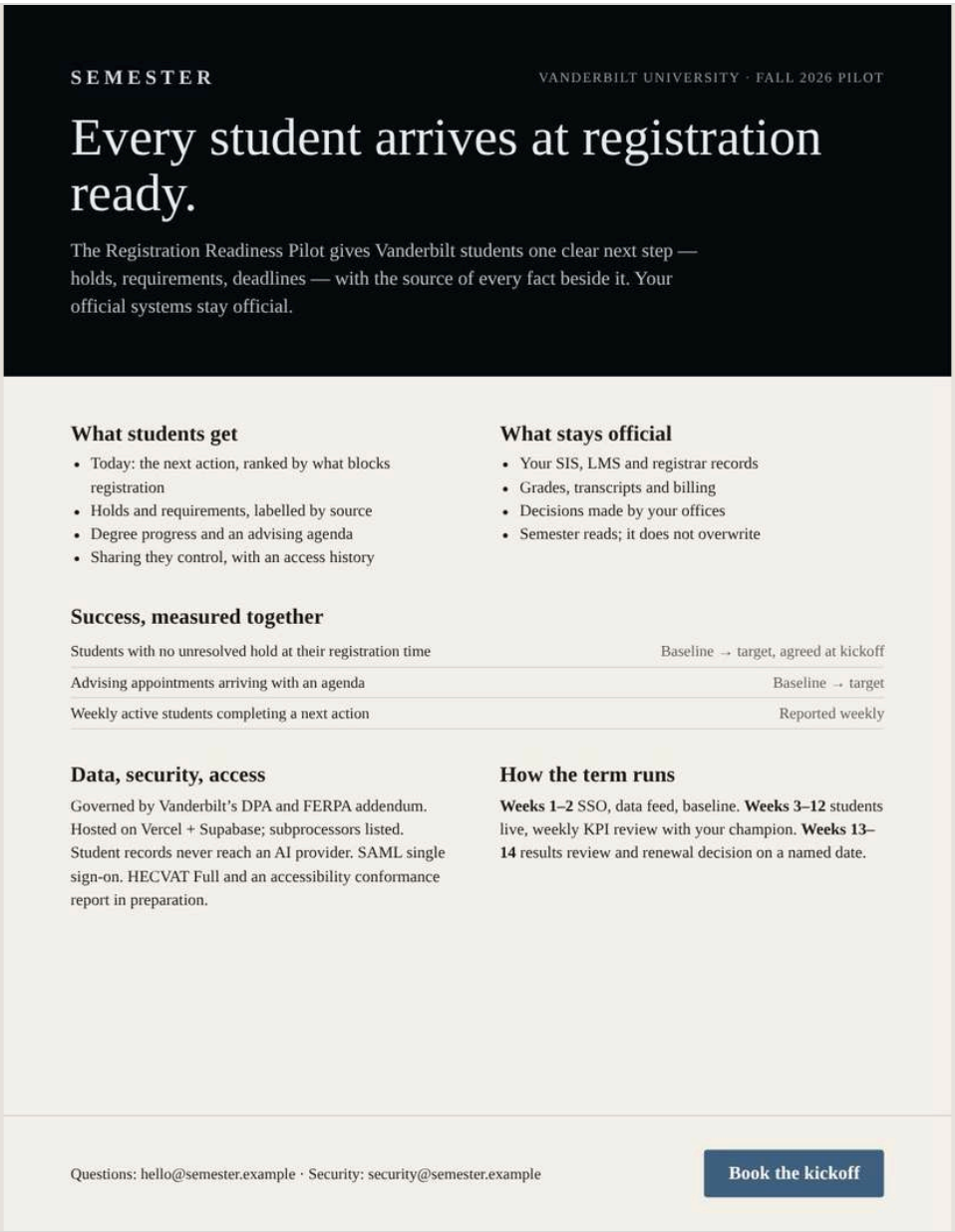

SEMESTER
Talk to us
Legal
Policies
These are drafts pending attorney review. Each institution’s signed agreement and DPA take precedence.
Terms of Service
Draft · open ↗
Privacy Policy
Draft · open ↗
Community Guidelines
Draft · open ↗
Subprocessors
Draft · open ↗
Master Services Agreement
Draft · open ↗
Data Protection Addendum
Draft · open ↗
Cookie Notice
Draft · open ↗
Accessibility Statement
Draft · open ↗
Accessibility statement
We are working toward WCAG 2.2 AA across the product and this site. A conformance report is in preparation. If something blocks you, write to access@semester.example and we will reply within two business days with a fix or a workaround.

Legal


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Registration Readiness Pilot
A one-term pilot with named success measures
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Roles
Your sponsor, champion, IT and registrar contacts; Semester runs setup, support and reporting.
After the pilot
A results report, then a decision: annual agreement, a second term, or a clean exit with your data exported and deleted.
Request a pilot design session
! 2 fields need attention.
Name (required)
!Enter your name.
Work email (required)
!Enter a full email address, like name@university.edu.
Institution type
University
Anything we should know
Send
We reply within two business days. No marketing list. Please don’t include student information.

Pilot › Send

Pilot One Pager



SEMESTER

VANDERBILT UNIVERSITY · FALL 2026 PILOT

Every student arrives at registration ready.

The Registration Readiness Pilot gives Vanderbilt students one clear next step — holds, requirements, deadlines — with the source of every fact beside it. Your official systems stay official.

What students get

- Today: the next action, ranked by what blocks registration
- Holds and requirements, labelled by source
- Degree progress and an advising agenda
- Sharing they control, with an access history

What stays official

- Your SIS, LMS and registrar records
- Grades, transcripts and billing
- Decisions made by your offices
- Semester reads; it does not overwrite

Success, measured together

Students with no unresolved hold at their registration time	Baseline → target, agreed at kickoff
Advising appointments arriving with an agenda	Baseline → target
Weekly active students completing a next action	Reported weekly

Data, security, access

Governed by Vanderbilt's DPA and FERPA addendum. Hosted on Vercel + Supabase; subprocessors listed. Student records never reach an AI provider. SAML single sign-on. HECVAT Full and an accessibility conformance report in preparation.

How the term runs

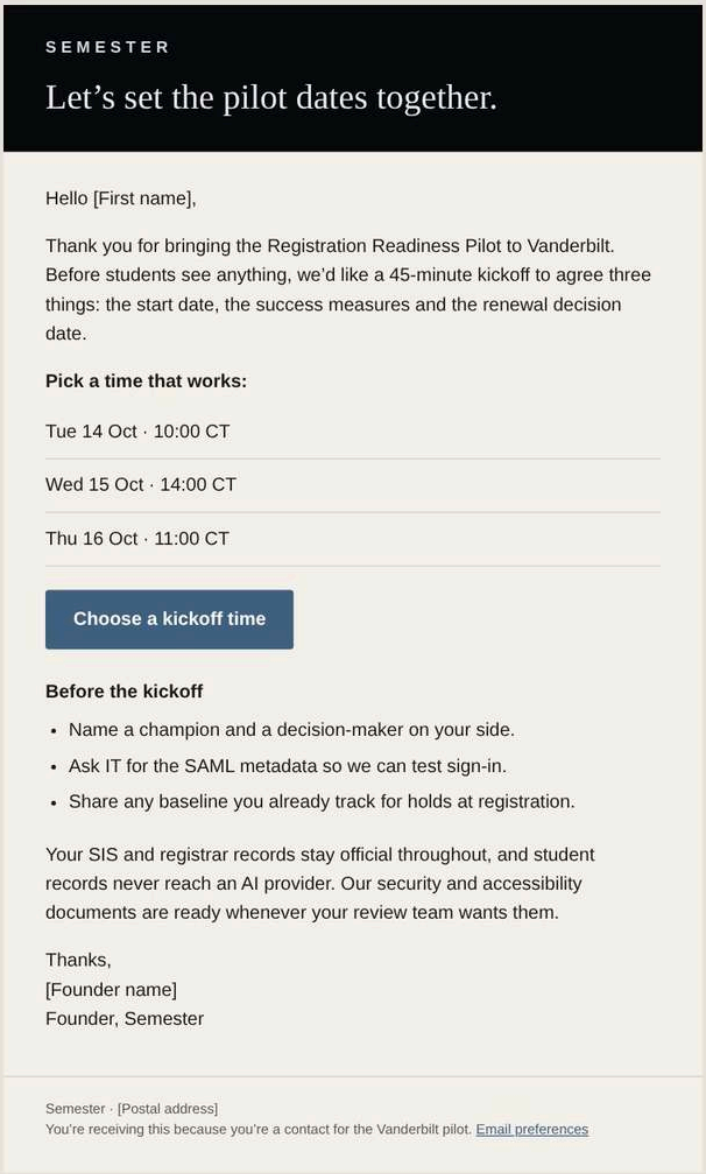
Weeks 1–2 SSO, data feed, baseline. **Weeks 3–12** students live, weekly KPI review with your champion. **Weeks 13–14** results review and renewal decision on a named date.

Questions: hello@semester.example · Security: security@semester.example

Book the kickoff

Opening view

Pilot Invitation Email



SEMESTER

Let’s set the pilot dates together.

Hello [First name],

Thank you for bringing the Registration Readiness Pilot to Vanderbilt. Before students see anything, we’d like a 45-minute kickoff to agree three things: the start date, the success measures and the renewal decision date.

Pick a time that works:

Tue 14 Oct · 10:00 CT

Wed 15 Oct · 14:00 CT

Thu 16 Oct · 11:00 CT

Choose a kickoff time

Before the kickoff

- Name a champion and a decision-maker on your side.
- Ask IT for the SAML metadata so we can test sign-in.
- Share any baseline you already track for holds at registration.

Your SIS and registrar records stay official throughout, and student records never reach an AI provider. Our security and accessibility documents are ready whenever your review team wants them.

Thanks,
[Founder name]
Founder, Semester

Semester · [Postal address]
You’re receiving this because you’re a contact for the Vanderbilt pilot. Email preferences

Opening view

Vanderbilt Campus Map

SEMESTER

Where the pilot touches campus

1 · Kirkland Hall

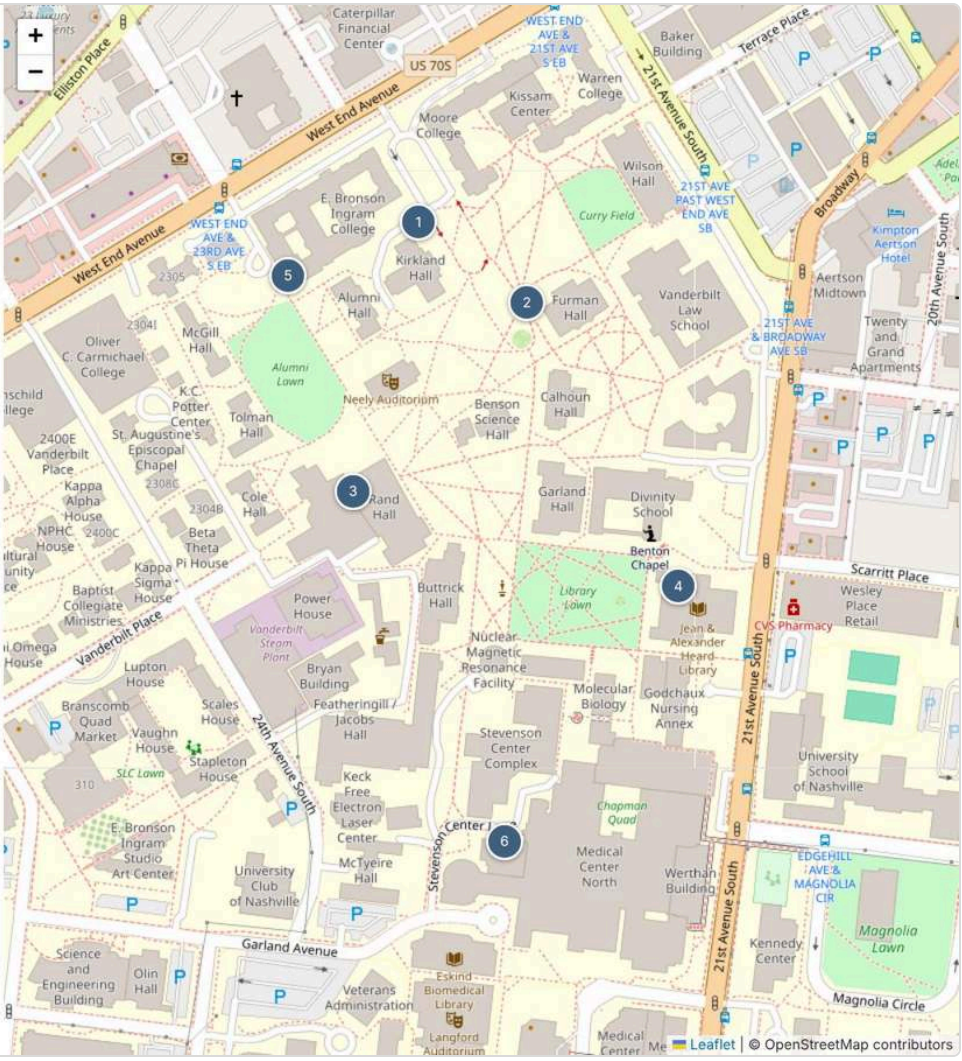
2 · University Registrar

3 · Rand Hall

4 · Central Library

5 · Student Accounts

6 · Student Health Center



Opening view

SEMESTER

Master Services Agreement

Version [x] · Between Semester [LLC legal name], a [state] limited liability company ("Semester"), and [Institution legal name] ("Institution")

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Institutions often require their own paper; use this as Semester's starting position and fallback.

1. Structure

This Agreement sets the terms for every Order Form signed under it. Each Order Form lists the services, term, fees and named measures. The Data Protection Addendum (DPA) governs student and personal data. If documents conflict, the order of precedence is: DPA, then Order Form, then this Agreement, then documentation.

2. Definitions

- **Services:** the Semester platform and any implementation or support listed in an Order Form.
- **Institution Data:** data Institution or its users provide or connect, including Education Records as defined by FERPA.
- **Authorized Users:** students, staff and others Institution permits to use the Services.
- **Official System:** Institution's SIS, LMS or other system of record.

3. Services

- Semester provides the Services described in the Order Form and the documentation.
- Official Systems remain authoritative. Semester reads from them as Institution approves and doesn't change official records unless an Order Form expressly allows a write integration, approved in writing.
- Semester may update the Services if it doesn't materially reduce agreed functionality, security or accessibility.

4. Institution responsibilities

- Name an executive sponsor, an operational champion and IT, registrar and security contacts.
- Provide SSO configuration and the agreed data access in time for the implementation plan.
- Make sure its use and its disclosures to Semester comply with FERPA and its own policies.

5. Data protection and security

- Semester acts as a "school official" with a legitimate educational interest under FERPA, under Institution's direct control for its use of Education Records, as set out in the DPA.

- Semester keeps an information security program described in its security policies and HECVAT response, including tenant isolation, encryption in transit and at rest, access logging and incident response.
- Semester doesn't send Education Records to AI model providers and doesn't use Institution Data to train AI models.
- Semester doesn't sell Institution Data or use it for advertising.

---

6. Accessibility

Semester designs to WCAG 2.2 AA, provides an accessibility conformance report (ACR) on request, and fixes reported barriers on a timeline agreed in the Order Form.

---

7. Fees and payment

- Fees are in the Order Form. Invoices are due [net 30] from receipt.
- Fees exclude taxes; Institution's tax-exempt status is honored with a valid certificate.
- Late amounts may be suspended after written notice and a [30]-day cure period. Suspension never deletes data.

---

8. Term and termination

- This Agreement runs until all Order Forms end.
- Either party may terminate for material breach not cured within [30] days of notice.
- Institution may terminate a pilot Order Form at the end of the pilot term without cause.
- On termination, Semester makes Institution Data available for export for [30] days, then deletes it as the DPA requires and certifies deletion on request.

---

9. Confidentiality

Each party protects the other's confidential information with at least reasonable care and uses it only for this Agreement. Public-records laws that apply to Institution take precedence.

---

10. Intellectual property

- Semester owns the Services and improvements to them. Institution owns Institution Data.
- Institution grants Semester the right to process Institution Data only to provide the Services.
- Feedback may be used without obligation, with no Institution Data attached.

---

11. Warranties

- Semester warrants the Services will perform materially as documented and that it won't knowingly introduce malicious code.
- Each party warrants it has authority to enter this Agreement.
- [Other warranties disclaimed to the extent the law allows; counsel to draft.]

12. Indemnities

[Semester: third-party IP infringement claims against the Services. Institution: to the extent its governing law allows. Many public institutions can't indemnify; counsel to adjust.]

13. Limitation of liability

[Cap: fees paid in the 12 months before the claim. Carve-outs: data breach caused by Semester's breach of the DPA (super-cap [x] or insurance limits), confidentiality, indemnity. No indirect damages. Counsel to set.]

14. Insurance

Semester will keep cyber liability and technology errors & omissions insurance at the limits in the Order Form or Institution's requirements, and provide certificates on request. *Status: not yet bound. This is a launch gate.*

15. Publicity

Neither party uses the other's name or marks without written approval, except that Semester may list Institution as a customer once Institution approves the wording.

16. General

Governing law: [Institution's state where required, otherwise Semester's state]. Notices in writing to the contacts in the Order Form. No assignment without consent, except to a successor of Semester's business that assumes this Agreement and the DPA. Entire agreement; amendments in writing.

Signatures

	Semester	Institution
Name		
Title		
Date		
Signature		

SEMESTER

Order Form

Under the Master Services Agreement dated [date] · Order Form #[ ]

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Institutions often require their own paper; use this as Semester's starting position and fallback.

1. Parties and contacts

Role	Institution	Semester
Legal name	[ ]	Semester [LLC legal name]
Executive sponsor	[name, title, email]	[founder]
Operational champion	[ ]	—
IT / SSO contact	[ ]	[ ]
Registrar data owner	[ ]	—
Security / incident contact	[ ]	security@[domain]
Billing contact	[ ]	billing@[domain]

2. Services ordered

Item	Scope	Term	Fee
Registration Readiness Pilot	[cohort, e.g. 500 first-year students], one term, read-only SIS + LMS connection, SAML SSO	[start] – [end of term]	[$ fixed]
Implementation	SSO, SIS read sync, role mapping, staff training	Before pilot start	Waived for pilot
Support	Pilot support per the support plan: S1 any hour in week 1; pilot hours 08:00–18:00 [TZ] weekdays	Pilot term	Included
Premium support (optional)	Named contact, quarterly review	Annual	15% of platform fee, min $15,000

3. Success measures

Agreed before launch and signed by the sponsor. Attach the measures sheet.

Measure	Baseline	Target	Source
[e.g. share of cohort with no unresolved hold at registration open]	[ ]	[ ]	Registrar extract

Measure	Baseline	Target	Source
[e.g. weekly active students in cohort]	—	[ ]	Semester analytics (aggregate)
[e.g. advisor time on registration questions]	[ ]	[ ]	Advisor survey

4. Conversion option

If Institution signs an annual Order Form within 60 days of the results report, the pilot fee is credited against year-1 fees. Planning price for annual: $[18] per enrolled student per year for the agreed scope, minimum $[30,000]. Prices are confirmed in the annual Order Form.

5. Data and security terms

- DPA dated [ ] applies. Data categories and subprocessors are listed there.
- Feature switches at launch: [community: off] · [marketplace: off] · [Ask Semester: on, course rules apply] · [family sharing: on].
- Insurance limits: cyber $[ ] · E&O $[ ].

6. Billing

Field	Value
Invoice schedule	[100% at signature / 50% at signature, 50% at launch]
Payment terms	Net [30]
PO number	[ ]
Tax status	[exempt — certificate attached]

Signatures

	Semester	Institution
Name		
Title		
Date		
Signature		

SEMESTER

Data Protection Addendum (FERPA)

Addendum to the Master Services Agreement · Template · Institution paper takes precedence where required

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Institutions often require their own paper; use this as Semester's starting position and fallback.

1. Roles

Institution is the owner and controller of Education Records. Semester is designated a school official with a legitimate educational interest under FERPA (34 CFR §99.31(a)(1)(i)(B)), performs an institutional service, is under Institution's direct control for its use and maintenance of Education Records, and uses them only for the authorized purposes below.

2. Purpose

Provide the Services in the Order Form. No other use. No sale, no advertising, no profiling for non-educational purposes, no AI model training.

3. Data categories

Category	Examples	Source	Classification
Directory / identity	Name, institutional email, student ID, program	IdP, SIS	Directory
Enrollment and registration	Terms, sections, holds, registration windows	SIS (read)	Education record
Course context	Course list, assignments, due dates	LMS (read)	Education record
Advising	Shared plans and notes the student chooses to share	Student, advisor	Education record · sensitive
Account balance (if enabled)	Balance, holds, payment plan status	SIS / bursar (read)	Education record · financial
Usage	Sign-ins, feature use, errors	Semester	Personal
Student-entered	Notes, tasks, preferences	Student	Personal · student-controlled

4. Redisclosure

Semester won't redisclose Education Records except to subprocessors listed in Annex B under written terms at least as protective as this DPA, to the student with Institution's authorization, or as required by law with prompt notice to Institution unless legally prohibited.

5. Security

- Tenant isolation enforced in the database (row-level security on every table, tenant ID on every row).
- Encryption in transit (TLS 1.2+) and at rest.
- Least-privilege access for Semester personnel, MFA, access logged and reviewed [quarterly].
- Audit log of record access by staff users, available to Institution.
- AI gateway blocks Education Records from model providers; tested before launch and on each change.
- Backups with tested restore; documented incident response plan.

6. Incident notification

Semester notifies Institution's security contact without undue delay and within [72] hours of confirming unauthorized access to Education Records, with the facts known, the data involved, steps taken and a contact. Semester cooperates with Institution's investigation and any required notices; Institution controls notices to students.

7. Student rights

Semester supports Institution in responding to requests to inspect, correct or delete records within [10] business days of Institution's request. Corrections to official records are made in the Official System by Institution.

8. Retention and deletion

Data	Retention	On termination
Synced Education Records	Duration of the Order Form	Deleted within [30] days after the export window
Student-entered content	Until deleted by the student or termination	Exported to student on request, then deleted
Audit logs	[1–7] years per Institution policy	Delivered to Institution, then deleted
Backups	Rolling [30] days	Expire on schedule

Semester certifies deletion in writing on request.

9. Data location

Data is hosted in [United States] regions of the subprocessors in Annex B.

10. Audits

On reasonable notice, once a year, Semester answers Institution's security questionnaire (HECVAT) and provides evidence summaries. On-site audits by agreement.

11. Children

Where any user is under 18, Semester follows Institution's instructions and applicable law; marketplace features stay off for users under 18.

Annex A · Institution-specific terms

[State student-privacy law requirements, e.g. data governance board approvals; Institution's own DPA language.]

Annex B · Subprocessors

See Subprocessors. Semester gives [30] days' notice before adding one; Institution may object on reasonable grounds.

Signatures

	Semester	Institution
Name		
Title		
Date		
Signature		

SEMESTER

Subprocessors

The vendors that process institution data for Semester. We give 30 days' notice before adding one.

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Don't publish this until counsel approves it.

Vendor	Purpose	Data	Location
Vercel	Application hosting	Request data in transit	[US region]
Supabase	Database, authentication, storage	Institution data at rest	[US region]
[AI model provider]	Ask Semester answers	Course content and student prompts only, no student records, no training	[region]
[Payment processor]	Marketplace payments	Buyer and seller payment details	[region]
[Email provider]	Transactional email	Name, email	[region]
[Error monitoring]	Error tracking	Technical logs with identifiers scrubbed	[region]

SEMESTER

Terms of Service

Last updated: [date] · Semester [LLC legal name], a [state] limited liability company

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Don't publish this until counsel approves it.

1. Who these terms are for

These terms cover your use of Semester through your school. If your school has a separate agreement with us, that agreement controls how your school's data is handled. Where it conflicts with these terms, it wins.

2. Your account

- You sign in with your school account. Keep it secure, and tell your school if you think someone else has used it.
- You must be eligible under your school's rules. Some features, including the marketplace, need you to be 18 or older.

3. Your school's information

Your school's systems remain the official record. Semester shows information from them along with its source and when it last updated. If something looks wrong, your school's office decides what's correct.

4. Ask Semester and AI features

- AI-assisted answers can be wrong. Check them against the sources shown.
- Ask Semester doesn't receive your student records.
- Follow your instructor's course AI policy. Using AI against that policy is an academic integrity matter for your school.

5. Community and marketplace rules

- Be respectful. No harassment, threats, hate, or sharing other people's private information.
- Don't sell or share graded work, exams, answer keys or anything that breaks academic integrity rules.
- No illegal items, weapons, drugs, alcohol, counterfeit goods or off-app payment requests.
- Marketplace payments run through our payment processor under its own terms. Semester isn't a party to sales between users and doesn't hold funds.
- We and your school may remove content or limit accounts that break these rules.

6. Your content

You own what you post. You give us permission to host and display it to the audience you choose, only to run the service. You can delete it at any time, though copies may stay in backups for a limited period.

7. Acceptable use

Don't attempt to access data you aren't permitted to see, interfere with the service, scrape it, or reverse-engineer it except where the law allows.

8. Device permissions

Camera, microphone, location and notifications are used only after you allow them, only for the feature you're using, and you can turn them off in your device or in Semester's privacy settings.

9. Changes and ending

We'll tell you about material changes before they take effect. You can stop using Semester at any time. If your school ends its agreement, your access ends and data is handled as that agreement requires.

10. Disclaimers and liability

[Standard warranty disclaimer and limitation of liability. Counsel to draft for the governing state, and to check consumer-protection limits where users are students.]

11. Governing law and disputes

[Governing law: state]. [Dispute resolution clause: counsel to decide.]

12. Contact

[legal@ email] · [mailing address]

SEMESTER

Privacy Policy

Last updated: [date]

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Don't publish this until counsel approves it.

Summary

- Your school decides how your student information is used. We act on its behalf under a written agreement that covers FERPA.
- We never sell personal information, and we don't use student data for advertising.
- AI models never receive your student records.
- Our company staff in sales, marketing and finance never see student records.

What we collect

Type	Examples	Source
School records	Enrollment, courses, holds, grades as released	Your school's systems
Account	Name, school email, role	Your school sign-in
What you add	Notes, plans, posts, listings, messages	You
Device (if you allow it)	Location while using, camera or mic for a feature, notification token	Your device
Usage	Pages viewed, errors, device type	Automatically

How we use it

To provide the service, keep it secure, support you, and improve it using aggregate data. Personalisation uses only the signals you allow, and you can reset it.

Who we share it with

Your school; subprocessors that host and run the service (listed at [subprocessors URL]); payment processors for marketplace purchases; and authorities when the law requires it. Nothing else.

Your choices

See, correct or delete your data through Privacy & data in the app, or through your school. Control who sees your profile details, turn off device permissions, and reset personalisation.

Security and retention

Encrypted in transit and at rest, with role-based access and every access logged. Retention follows your school's agreement. By default, data is deleted within 30 days after it ends.

Children

Semester is for postsecondary students. Where a school enrols users under 18, the school's consent and the applicable laws apply, and some features stay off.

Contact

[privacy@ email]

SEMESTER

Cookie and storage notice

Last updated: [date] · Applies to the Semester app and semester.[domain]

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in.

1. The short version

Semester uses only the cookies and browser storage it needs to sign you in, keep you secure and remember your settings. We don't use advertising cookies, and we don't let third parties track you across sites.

2. What we store

Name / type	Purpose	Category	Lasts
Session cookie	Keeps you signed in after your school sign-in	Strictly necessary	Session, or [x] hours
CSRF token	Protects forms from cross-site attacks	Strictly necessary	Session
SSO state	Completes the sign-in round-trip with your school	Strictly necessary	Minutes
Preferences (local storage)	Theme, text size, calm mode, dismissed tips	Functional	Until you clear it
Offline queue (local storage / IndexedDB)	Saves actions made offline until you reconnect	Functional	Until sent
Privacy-preserving analytics	Aggregate page counts, no cross-site tracking, no student record content	Analytics (off by default where consent is required)	[x] days

3. Public website

The marketing site uses no advertising or social-media tracking. If we add analytics, they will be aggregate and cookieless where possible, and we will update this notice first.

4. Your choices

- Strictly necessary items can't be switched off; Semester won't work without them.
- Functional and analytics items can be cleared in your browser or turned off in You → Privacy & data.
- Where law requires consent (for example in the EU or UK), analytics stay off until you agree.

5. Changes and contact

We'll update this notice before adding any new kind of cookie or storage. Questions: privacy@[domain].

SEMESTER

Accessibility statement

Last updated: [date] · Applies to the Semester app and semester.[domain]

Draft. Update the status table from the latest test run before publishing. Never state full conformance until the ACR supports it.

1. Our commitment

Semester should work for every student and staff member, including people who use screen readers, keyboards, voice control, magnification or captions. We design and test to the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2, Level AA.

2. Current status

Area	Status	Last tested
Pilot student paths (sign-in, Today, registration readiness, Ask Semester, sharing, settings)	Working toward WCAG 2.2 AA; manual testing in progress	[date]
Staff pilot paths (advisor, registrar, institution console)	Working toward WCAG 2.2 AA	[date]
Public website	Working toward WCAG 2.2 AA	[date]
Accessibility Conformance Report (VPAT 2.x)	In preparation; available to institutions on request when complete	—

3. How we test

- Automated checks on every change before it ships.
- Manual keyboard and screen-reader testing (NVDA, JAWS, VoiceOver, TalkBack) on pilot paths each release.
- Zoom to 200%, reflow at 320 px, reduced motion, high contrast and forced colors.
- Plain language, visible focus and target sizes of at least 44 px in the product.

4. Known limitations

[List any known issues with a workaround and a fix date. Example: "Charts in Progress have a data table alternative; a fully navigable chart is planned for [month]."]

5. Report a barrier

Email access@[domain] or use "Report a barrier" in Help. Tell us the page, what you were trying to do, and the device or assistive technology if you're comfortable sharing it. We reply within two business days with a fix or a workaround. Students can also contact their school's disability services office, which can work with us directly.

6. Formal complaints

If you aren't satisfied with our response, contact your institution's accessibility or ADA/504 coordinator. [Institution-specific contact added per tenant.]

SEMESTER

Community & marketplace guidelines

Plain-language rules. The Terms of Service are the binding version.

Do

- Help each other: answer questions, share study tips, show up for your groups.
- Keep it on campus: meet at the suggested safe spots and pay in the app.
- Report what's wrong. Reports are confidential.

Don't

- Harass, threaten, demean or share someone's private information.
- Sell or trade graded work, exams, answer keys, or offers to do someone's work.
- List prohibited items: weapons, drugs, alcohol, counterfeits, anything illegal.
- Ask for payment outside the app, or impersonate anyone, including school offices.

What happens

Severity	Example	Typical action
Low	Spam, off-topic	Content removed, reminder
Medium	Integrity violation, scam attempt	Removal, feature limit, school notified per policy
High	Threats, self-harm risk, illegal items	Immediate removal; escalated to the school's designated contacts

You can appeal through Privacy & safety, and a different moderator will review it.

Company data catalogs

The structured data behind the company workspaces: operating streams, owners, metrics, plans and copy.

Company OS — ui_kits/company-os/company-os-data.js

Window.COMPANYOS

Principle

Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Functions

Corporate governance and legal

Id: governance
Name: Corporate governance and legal
File: CORPORATE_GOVERNANCE_AND_LEGAL_OPS
Owner: Founder + fractional counsel
Review: True
Mission: Keep the company legally sound, its IP owned, and every contract and obligation tracked.
Sor: Contracts register in /ops legal; corporate records folder
Inputs: Formation documents, contracts, policies, counsel advice
Workflows: Request → classify → business owner → legal owner → risk rating → template → redline → approval → signature → obligations extracted → renewal reminder → evidence → amendment/termination
Kpis: Contracts with obligations logged, Days to signature, Renewals missed (0)
Reports: Monthly legal queue and obligations calendar
Cadence: Weekly legal queue review (15 min)
Controls: No signature without template or counsel redline; IP assignment for every contributor
Thresholds: Any contract with student data, liability above fees, or non-standard indemnity → counsel
Docs: Operating agreement, IP assignment, NDA, MSA, Order form, DPA, SLA, Terms, Privacy, Acceptable use, Cookie notice, Accessibility statement, Security addendum, Contractor / employee / advisor templates, Marketplace publisher agreement, Trademark register
Integrations: E-sign (embedded), contracts register
Have: docs/legal/ (MSA, order form, DPA, terms, privacy, cookie, accessibility, community, subprocessors)
Gaps: SLA, SOW, security addendum, contractor/advisor templates, trademark filing, policy register
Priority: P0
Next: Counsel review of MSA, DPA and order form before pilot launch

Finance, accounting and capital

Id: finance

Name: Finance, accounting and capital

File: FINANCE_AND_CAPITAL_SYSTEM

Owner: Founder + bookkeeper

Review: True

Mission: Know cash, runway and unit economics every month; bill accurately and collect on time.

Sor: /ops finance (invoices, AR, dunning); accounting ledger (bookkeeper); bank

Inputs: Bank and card feeds, invoices, contracts, payroll/contractor costs, vendor bills

Workflows: Month ends → invoices and payments reconciled → expenses categorized → payroll posted → vendor costs reviewed → revenue/deferred revenue reviewed → P&L → balance sheet → cash flow → runway → forecast variance → executive review → investor summary

Kpis: Cash, burn, runway, ARR, pilot revenue, Gross margin incl. AI and cloud cost, DSO, Forecast variance

Reports: Monthly close pack; dashboards: cash, revenue, pipeline, margin, CAC, retention, spend, forecast (conservative/base/ambitious/downside)

Cadence: Monthly close (1 h); weekly cash check

Controls: Founder approves spend above $500; separation of invoicing and payment where possible

Thresholds: Spend > $500 → founder; discounts per price book; anything off price book → founder

Docs: Chart of accounts, Expense policy, Tax calendar, Price book, Discount policy, Finance model

Integrations: Bank, payment processor, accounting software (embedded views)

Have: docs/run/Finance Model.html, docs/grow/GTM Plan.html (price book), ui_kits/ops (finance console)

Gaps: 36-month model, AI cost per workflow, revenue recognition review, tax calendar

Priority: P0

Next: Open business bank account and accounting ledger; set the monthly close date

Product and engineering operations

Id: product

Name: Product and engineering operations

File: PRODUCT_AND_ENGINEERING_OPERATIONS

Owner: Founder → founding engineer

Review: False

Mission: Turn evidence into shipped, reliable, accessible product.

Sor: GitHub (code, PRs), /ops product operations (backlog, flags, releases)

Inputs: Customer signals, research, catalog gaps, incidents

Workflows: Signal → research → problem → opportunity → strategy fit → priority score → PRD → design → threat/privacy/accessibility review → technical design → build → test → controlled release → measure → iterate or retire

Kpis: Release cadence, Change failure rate, Error budget remaining, Accessibility issues open

Reports: Release notes; monthly product review

Cadence: Weekly planning; release per engineering playbook

Controls: CI gates, RLS proof, two-person review for auth/RLS/AI/billing

Thresholds: No release in pilot launch week, finals or registration opening except S1/S2 fixes

Docs: Engineering playbook, QA test plan, Accessibility test plan, ADR log, PRD template

Integrations: GitHub, Vercel, Supabase (deploy status in /ops)

Have: docs/build/, handoff/execute/, docs/master/

Gaps: PRD template, ADR log, experiment registry

Priority: P1

Next: Run execute stream 00 and approve the design-system baseline

Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance

Id: trust

Name: Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance

File: TRUST_PROGRAM

Owner: Founder + fractional security lead

Review: True

Mission: Make trust evidence-based: controls designed, implemented, tested and shown to buyers.

Sor: /ops trust & compliance (controls, evidence, HECVAT, data requests)

Inputs: Asset/data inventory, policies, vendor list, incidents, questionnaires

Workflows: Inventory → risk assessment → control design → implementation → evidence → testing → monitoring → intake → remediation → verification → control review → customer evidence, Vendor intake → purpose → data classification → security/privacy review → contract terms → access scope → onboarding → periodic review → incident escalation → renewal → offboarding

Kpis: Controls with evidence, Questionnaire turnaround, Access reviews on time, Open high vulnerabilities

Reports: Quarterly trust report; HECVAT response

Cadence: Quarterly access review and tabletop; annual policy review

Controls: Vendor security obligations in writing, need-to-know access, MFA, encryption, vendor-breach plan (FTC vendor guidance)

Thresholds: Any new subprocessor → privacy review + 30-day notice

Docs: Security policies, Security readiness, Incident response, BCP/DR, Vendor risk, Claims register

Integrations: Evidence links to GitHub, Supabase, Vercel

Have: docs/secure/, docs/operate/, ui_kits/compliance/

Gaps: HECVAT submitted, insurance bound, ACR, vendor reviews documented

Priority: P0

Next: Bind insurance; submit HECVAT Full; complete vendor reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider

Go-to-market and revenue operations

Id: revops

Name: Go-to-market and revenue operations

File: REVENUE_OPERATIONS

Owner: Founder

Review: False

Mission: A predictable path from target account to annual contract.

Sor: /ops GTM pipeline (CRM)

Inputs: ICP, target list, conversations, pilot results

Workflows: Target → outreach → discovery → qualified → role demo → pilot design → security/procurement → proposal → mutual action plan → contract → implementation → activation → outcome report → annual conversion → expansion/reference

Kpis: Target accounts, replies, discovery meetings, Qualified opportunities, demos, pilot designs, Pilots signed, activation, KPI attainment, Pilot-to-annual conversion, ACV, NRR, Sales cycle, win/loss, CAC, payback

Reports: Weekly pipeline; monthly forecast

Cadence: Weekly pipeline review

Controls: Price book and discount rules; claims register for every deck

Thresholds: Below floor not allowed; discounts per GTM plan

Docs: GTM plan, Buyer map, Mutual action plan, Proposal template, Order form

Integrations: Email and calendar inside Semester

Have: docs/grow/GTM Plan.html, ui_kits/business (GTM), templates (decks)

Gaps: Target list built, win/loss log

Priority: P1

Next: Build the 40-account target list in /ops

Marketing, brand and communications

Id: marketing
Name: Marketing, brand and communications
File: MARKETING_AND_BRAND_SYSTEM
Owner: Founder
Review: False
Mission: Explain Semester honestly and earn buyer and student trust.
Sor: Company site + content register; /ops social
Inputs: Positioning, proof, product releases
Workflows: Plan → draft → claims check → approve → publish → measure
Kpis: Qualified site requests, Trust Center visits, Content published per month, Ambassador activations (later)
Reports: Monthly marketing summary
Cadence: Monthly content plan
Controls: Every claim sourced in the claims register; status, not certifications
Thresholds: Customer names or quotes → written approval
Docs: Brand system, Messaging, Claims register, Content calendar
Integrations: Site CMS, social channels (embedded scheduling)
Have: ui_kits/company-site/ (10 pages), design system, ui_kits/ops (social, marketing)
Gaps: Content calendar, SEO plan, webinar plan
Priority: P2
Next: Publish pilot, pricing and trust pages

Customer success and implementation

Id: cs
Name: Customer success and implementation
File: CUSTOMER_SUCCESS_AND_IMPLEMENTATION
Owner: Founder → implementation lead
Review: False
Mission: Every customer launches cleanly and can prove value.
Sor: /ops customer success (implementation, health, QBR)
Inputs: Signed order form, measures sheet, contacts
Workflows: Signed → sales-to-CS hand-off → kickoff → implementation → data readiness → admin setup → training → launch → activation → adoption → weekly review → midpoint → value report → conversion → QBR → renewal → expansion → reference
Kpis: Days signature-to-launch, Activation, Health score, Renewal rate
Reports: Weekly sponsor update; results report
Cadence: Weekly during pilot; quarterly QBR after
Controls: Go/no-go gates with evidence
Thresholds: Scope change → order form amendment
Docs: Launch runbook, Cutover plan, Support plan, Results report template
Integrations: Tenant health from the platform
Have: docs/launch/, templates/pilot-results-report/
Gaps: Health score definition, customer advisory board
Priority: P0
Next: Kick off Vanderbilt implementation with the mutual action plan

Support and service operations

Id: support
Name: Support and service operations
File: SUPPORT_AND_SERVICE_OPERATIONS
Owner: Founder → support specialist
Review: False
Mission: Fast, honest help that feeds the product.
Sor: /ops support desk
Inputs: Tickets, status, incidents
Workflows: Intake → classify → severity → assign → respond → escalate → communicate → resolve → root cause → KB/product update → satisfaction
Kpis: First response, Resolution time, P0/P1 count, CSAT
Reports: Weekly support summary
Cadence: Daily triage in pilot
Controls: No student record content in tickets
Thresholds: P0 = security/data exposure/broad outage; P1 = critical workflow blocked; P2 degraded with workaround; P3 minor
Docs: Support plan, Runbooks, Macros, Escalation matrix
Integrations: Status page, incident console
Have: docs/launch/Support Plan.html, docs/operate/
Gaps: Help center, KB articles, feature-request taxonomy
Priority: P1
Next: Write the first 10 KB articles from the pilot paths

Partnerships, marketplace and developer relations

Id: partners
Name: Partnerships, marketplace and developer relations
File: PARTNERSHIPS_AND_MARKETPLACE
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Borrow trust and distribution; let others build on Semester safely.
Sor: /ops partnerships
Inputs: Partner targets, integration needs
Workflows: Target → qualify → due diligence → value proposition → agreement → technical integration → security/privacy approval → GTM plan → launch → measure → co-sell → renew → offboard
Kpis: Active partners, Certified integrations, Partner-sourced pipeline
Reports: Quarterly partner review
Cadence: Quarterly
Controls: Security/privacy approval before any data access
Thresholds: Any data-sharing partner → DPA + review
Docs: Partner agreement, Publisher agreement, Certification checklist
Integrations: Developer platform (later)
Have: ui_kits/workflow-runner (Developer platform workflow)
Gaps: Partner list, agreements
Priority: P3
Next: List the integration partners the pilot depends on (SIS, LMS, IdP, AI provider)

People, hiring and culture

Id: people
Name: People, hiring and culture
File: PEOPLE_AND_HIRING_SYSTEM
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Hire on triggers, onboard safely, keep the culture evidence-first.
Sor: /ops people (hiring, onboarding); payroll provider (embedded)
Inputs: Hiring triggers, revenue
Workflows: Trigger → scorecard → recruit → loop → references → offer → onboarding → access provisioning → 90-day review → offboarding → access revocation
Kpis: Time to hire, Onboarding checklist completion, Access revoked same day on exit
Reports: Quarterly workforce plan
Cadence: Quarterly
Controls: IP + confidentiality before access; FERPA/security training
Thresholds: Every hire tied to signed revenue
Docs: Hiring plan, Job descriptions, Handbook, Equity plan
Integrations: Payroll provider, identity provider
Have: docs/run/Hiring Plan.html
Gaps: Handbook, equity plan, compensation bands
Priority: P2
Next: Engage counsel and bookkeeper as the first contractors

Data, research and outcomes

Id: data
Name: Data, research and outcomes
File: DATA_RESEARCH_AND_OUTCOMES
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Prove outcomes with privacy-safe evidence.
Sor: Analytics (aggregate), research repository
Inputs: Event taxonomy, cohorts, measures
Workflows: Hypothesis → baseline → cohort → intervention → measurement → analysis → evidence review → customer validation → claim approval → iteration
Kpis: Pilots with baseline, Measures met, Claims approved with evidence
Reports: Pilot results report
Cadence: Per term
Controls: Minimum cell size; no row-level export; research governance
Thresholds: Any publication → institution approval
Docs: Event taxonomy, Metric definitions, Research governance
Integrations: Warehouse (later)
Have: templates/pilot-results-report/, docs/platform/RESEARCH_AND_OUTCOMES_ENGINE.md
Gaps: Event taxonomy, metric definitions
Priority: P1
Next: Define the pilot event taxonomy (no PII)

Procurement, vendors and supply chain

Id: vendors
Name: Procurement, vendors and supply chain
File: VENDOR_AND_PROCUREMENT_SYSTEM
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Every vendor has a purpose, a review and an exit.
Sor: /ops vendors
Inputs: Vendor requests
Workflows: Intake → purpose → data classification → security/privacy review → contract terms → access scope → onboarding → periodic review → incident escalation → renewal → offboarding
Kpis: Vendors reviewed, Vendors with DPA, Renewals reviewed before date
Reports: Subprocessor list (public)
Cadence: Annual vendor review
Controls: Need-to-know access, MFA, encryption, breach plan
Thresholds: Student-data vendors → subprocessor notice
Docs: Vendor risk policy, Subprocessors
Integrations: —
Have: docs/legal/Subprocessors.html, docs/secure/
Gaps: Vendor review records
Priority: P1
Next: Record reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider, email provider

Risk, resilience and continuity

Id: risk
Name: Risk, resilience and continuity
File: RISK_RESILIENCE_AND_CONTINUITY
Owner: Founder
Review: False
Mission: See risks early and recover fast.
Sor: /ops risk register, incidents, SLOs
Inputs: Risk register, incidents, SLO data
Workflows: Identify → rate → owner → mitigation → review
Kpis: Risks with owners, Restore drill time, Postmortems on time
Reports: Monthly risk review
Cadence: Monthly
Controls: Error budget policy; key-person continuity plan
Thresholds: P0 risks reviewed weekly
Docs: Risk register, BCP/DR, Runbooks, Platform risk register
Integrations: Monitoring
Have: ui_kits/business (risks), docs/operate/, docs/platform/PLATFORM_RISK_REGISTER.md
Gaps: Key-person continuity plan, customer concentration plan
Priority: P1
Next: Write the key-person continuity plan (credentials escrow, runbooks, counsel contact)

Board, investor and stakeholder operations

Id: board
Name: Board, investor and stakeholder operations
File: BOARD_AND_INVESTOR_OPERATIONS
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Clear, honest updates when there are stakeholders to update.
Sor: /ops board/investor reports; investor portal
Inputs: KPI tree, finance, pipeline, risks
Workflows: Monthly update → board deck (when a board exists) → decisions → follow-ups
Kpis: Updates sent on time
Reports: Monthly founder update
Cadence: Monthly (deferred while bootstrapped)
Controls: Numbers from the close pack only
Thresholds: Fundraising deferred until pilot results
Docs: Investor deck, Data room index, Cap table
Integrations: —
Have: templates/investor-deck/, ui_kits/investor/
Gaps: Data room index
Priority: P3
Next: Draft the data room index (deferred)

Operations command center

Id: occ
Name: Operations command center
File: OPERATIONS_COMMAND_CENTER
Owner: Founder
Review: False
Mission: Run the platform and the company from one place.
Sor: /ops
Inputs: Every function above
Workflows: Request → evidence → approval → impact preview → execution → audit → read-model refresh → operator review
Kpis: Decisions with owner and date, Approvals in SLA
Reports: Executive overview
Cadence: Daily glance; weekly operating review
Controls: Business data only; two-person approvals
Thresholds: See approvals matrix
Docs: Operating manual
Integrations: All company modules
Have: ui_kits/ops/ (12 consoles), templates/command-center/, ui_kits/one-place/
Gaps: Decisions log, work items
Priority: P1
Next: Start the weekly operating review from the executive overview

Kpi Tree

- North star: students who complete their next action each week (pilot cohort)
- Product, Weekly actives, First meaningful action, Readiness completion, Support load
- Revenue, Pipeline, Pilots signed, Pilot-to-annual conversion, ARR, NRR
- Customer, Activation, Health, Measures met, References

- Trust, Controls with evidence, Incidents, Questionnaire turnaround
- Finance, Cash, Runway, Gross margin, AI cost per workflow
- Reliability, SLO attainment, Error budget, Restore time
- People, Capacity vs demand, Hires on trigger

Cadence

- Daily, Ops inbox, tickets, alerts (15 min)
- Monday, Plan the week: top 3 company outcomes
- Weekly, Pipeline, pilot health, support, SLOs, risks (operating review, 60 min)
- Monthly, Close, runway, scorecard re-score, risk review, founder update
- Quarterly, Access review, tabletop, roadmap and hiring plan, QBRs
- Yearly, Policy review, insurance renewal, HECVAT refresh, ACR re-test, planning

Plans

D90	Sellable pilot package complete (contracts reviewed, insurance bound), Finance: bank, ledger, monthly close, Trust: HECVAT, vendor reviews, ACR in progress, Pipeline: 40 targets, 10 discovery calls, Implementation: Vanderbilt launched with support plan, Reliability: monitoring, restore drill
M12	Pilot results and annual conversion, Pilots #2–#3, First engineer and implementation lead, KB and help center, Event taxonomy and results reporting, SOC 2 readiness plan
M36	Repeatable implementation factory, Platform maturity stages 2–4, Partner program and certified integrations, Board and investor operations if raising, Multi-campus customers, Published outcomes research

Top50

Counsel review: MSA, DPA, order form, Bind cyber + E&O insurance, Open business bank account, Set up accounting ledger and chart of accounts, Register for state/local taxes (accountant), Sign Vanderbilt DPA, Submit HECVAT Full, Record vendor reviews (Supabase, Vercel, AI, email), Publish subprocessor list, Sign success-measures sheet, Kickoff with mutual action plan, Name Vanderbilt contacts, Set monthly close date, Invoice the pilot (50% at signature if possible), Start weekly operating review, Create contracts register with obligations, Create decisions log, Write key-person continuity plan, Escrow credentials and runbooks, Define pilot event taxonomy, Write 10 KB articles, Set up status page, Run support plan on launch, Build 40-account target list, Book 10 discovery calls, Publish pilot, pricing, trust pages, Claims register review of site and decks, Write SLA document, Write SOW template, Write security addendum, Contractor and advisor templates, File trademark search (counsel), Draft employee handbook (counsel), Midpoint review, Case-study permission, Results report, Annual conversion proposal, Extend finance model to 36 months, AI cost per workflow model, Health score definition, Win/loss log, Content calendar, Partner list for pilot dependencies, Policy register, Quarterly access review, Tabletop incident exercise, Restore drill, Hiring trigger review, Data room index (deferred), Quarterly scorecard and plan refresh

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`Business workspace — ui_kits/business/business-data.js`

Window.BIZ

Facts

Entity	LLC (home state)
Stage	Pre-seed, no revenue, bootstrapping

Team	Solo founder; contractors with signed IP assignments
Pilot	Paid university pilot signed — DPA/FERPA addendum, HECVAT Full, VPAT/ACR, SAML SSO, cyber + E&O insurance required; real student records; dates not decided
Hosting	Vercel + Supabase; AI never sees student records
Budget	$5k–$20k setup budget

Items

1

Id: 1
Area: Formation
Item: LLC formed in home state, operating agreement signed
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Done
Gate: Before any contract
Evidence: Confirmed by founder

2

Id: 2
Area: Formation
Item: EIN, state/local tax registrations
Owner: Founder + accountant
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Before invoicing the pilot
Evidence: Not confirmed — verify

3

Id: 3
Area: Formation
Item: Dedicated business bank + payments account
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Before pilot invoice
Evidence: Not confirmed — verify

4

Id: 4
Area: Formation
Item: Corporate records folder + contract repository
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Before diligence
Evidence: —

5

Id: 5
Area: Formation
Item: Cap table (single-member LLC; record any promised equity)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Before advisors/hires
Evidence: Solo founder

6

Id: 6
Area: Formation
Item: IP assignment from founder + every contractor
Owner: Founder + counsel
Priority: P0
Status: Done
Gate: Before code ships to customer
Evidence: Confirmed: contractors signed

7

Id: 7
Area: Formation
Item: Trademark / name clearance for "Semester"
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Before public launch
Evidence: docs/BRAND-PLATFORM.md: no clearance performed

8

Id: 8
Area: Formation
Item: Decision: convert LLC → Delaware C-corp
Owner: Founder + counsel
Priority: P2
Status: Deferred
Gate: Before priced equity round
Evidence: Bootstrapping — revisit at fundraising

9

Id: 9
Area: Insurance
Item: Cyber liability
Owner: Founder + broker
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot contract requires it
Evidence: Required by pilot; not held

10

Id: 10
Area: Insurance
Item: Professional / E&O
Owner: Founder + broker
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot contract requires it
Evidence: Required by pilot; not held

11

Id: 11
Area: Insurance
Item: General liability
Owner: Founder + broker
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Campus presence
Evidence: —

12

Id: 12
Area: Contracts
Item: Pilot agreement (signed)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Done
Gate: —
Evidence: Paid pilot signed

13

Id: 13
Area: Contracts
Item: Data Processing Addendum / FERPA addendum
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P0
Status: In review
Gate: Before real student records
Evidence: Pilot has DPA/FERPA addendum — confirm obligations mapped

14

Id: 14
Area: Contracts
Item: Master Services Agreement + SaaS terms
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P1
Status: Draft
Gate: Before annual conversion
Evidence: docs/legal-drafts/ (72 files)

15

Id: 15
Area: Contracts
Item: Order form + SOW template
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Annual proposal
Evidence: —

16

Id: 16
Area: Contracts
Item: Service Level Agreement / support policy
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Draft
Gate: Annual conversion
Evidence: docs/sre/ (34 files)

17

Id: 17
Area: Contracts
Item: Mutual NDA
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P2
Status: Not started
Gate: New prospects
Evidence: —

18

Id: 18
Area: Privacy
Item: Privacy Policy + Terms of Service
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P0
Status: Draft
Gate: Before student sign-in
Evidence: docs/legal-drafts/

19

Id: 19
Area: Privacy
Item: Subprocessor list (Vercel, Supabase, AI provider)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: DPA requires it
Evidence: Hosting: Vercel + Supabase

20

Id: 20
Area: Privacy
Item: Data inventory + data-flow map (student records)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: In progress
Gate: Before real data
Evidence: database/DATA_CLASSIFICATION_REGISTER.md

21

Id: 21
Area: Privacy
Item: Retention + deletion schedule
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: DPA / HECVAT
Evidence: —

22

Id: 22
Area: Privacy
Item: AI boundary: student records never reach an AI provider — enforce + document
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT, DPA
Evidence: Policy decided; needs a test + doc

23

Id: 23
Area: Security
Item: HECVAT Full completed
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: University security review
Evidence: Required by pilot

24

Id: 24
Area: Security
Item: Security questionnaire answer library
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: HECVAT, RFPs
Evidence: docs/trust/ (66 files) as source

25

Id: 25
Area: Security
Item: University SSO (SAML / Shibboleth)
Owner: Engineering
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot launch
Evidence: Required by pilot

26

Id: 26
Area: Security
Item: Access-control + least-privilege policy
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: database/TENANT_ISOLATION_MATRIX.md, RLS

27

Id: 27
Area: Security
Item: Incident response plan + tabletop
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Draft
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: docs/INCIDENT-RECOVERY-PLAYBOOK.md

28

Id: 28
Area: Security
Item: Backup + disaster-recovery runbook (tested)
Owner: Engineering
Priority: P0
Status: Draft
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: docs/sre/

29

Id: 29
Area: Security
Item: Vulnerability management + dependency scanning
Owner: Engineering
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: codeql.yml, supply-chain.yml, hawkscan.yml

30

Id: 30
Area: Security
Item: Logging + monitoring policy
Owner: Engineering
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: production-smoke.yml

31

Id: 31
Area: Security
Item: Evidence register mapped to controls
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: EVIDENCE-REGISTER.md

32

Id: 32
Area: Security
Item: Penetration-test plan
Owner: Founder
Priority: P2
Status: Not started
Gate: After first renewal
Evidence: —

33

Id: 33
Area: Security
Item: Trust Center page (verified controls only)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Procurement
Evidence: docs/trust/

34

Id: 34
Area: Accessibility
Item: VPAT / ACR (WCAG 2.1 AA)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot contract requires it
Evidence: a11y tests exist; no ACR

35

Id: 35
Area: Accessibility
Item: Accessibility statement + feedback route
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Public launch
Evidence: —

36

Id: 36
Area: Finance
Item: Bookkeeping + accounting system
Owner: Founder + accountant
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Before pilot invoice
Evidence: —

37

Id: 37
Area: Finance
Item: Pilot invoice + revenue recognition
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: Paid pilot

38

Id: 38
Area: Finance
Item: 12-month model: burn, runway, scenarios
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Bootstrapped planning
Evidence: Budget $5k–$20k for setup

39

Id: 39
Area: Finance
Item: Unit costs: infra + AI cost per active user
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Pricing
Evidence: —

40

Id: 40
Area: Finance
Item: Pricing memo: pilot → department → institution
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Draft
Gate: Annual proposal
Evidence: PUBLIC-CLAIMS register: prices "planned"

41

Id: 41
Area: Sales
Item: Ideal customer profile + tier-1 account list
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Second pilot
Evidence: —

42

Id: 42
Area: Sales
Item: Discovery + demo scripts by persona
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Second pilot
Evidence: —

43

Id: 43
Area: Sales
Item: Pilot success plan + baseline metrics
Owner: Founder + champion
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: Pilot dates not decided

44

Id: 44
Area: Sales
Item: Mutual action plan with named decision date
Owner: Founder + champion
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: Renewal date not decided

45

Id: 45
Area: Sales
Item: Results deck + annual conversion proposal
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Before renewal decision
Evidence: —

46

Id: 46
Area: Sales
Item: Security/procurement response kit
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Second pilot
Evidence: —

47

Id: 47
Area: Customer success
Item: Onboarding plan for pilot users
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: —

48

Id: 48
Area: Customer success
Item: Support intake, severity levels, response times
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: —

49

Id: 49
Area: Customer success
Item: Weekly pilot check-in + KPI review
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: —

50

Id: 50
Area: Customer success
Item: QBR / renewal process
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Mid-pilot
Evidence: —

51

Id: 51
Area: Operations
Item: Weekly operating cadence + decision log
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: Ongoing
Evidence: DECISIONS.md, docs/decisions/

52

Id: 52
Area: Operations
Item: Risk register (owner, mitigation, review)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: Ongoing
Evidence: LAUNCH-RISK-REGISTER.md

53

Id: 53
Area: Operations
Item: Public claims approval register
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: Any marketing
Evidence: PUBLIC-CLAIMS-APPROVAL-REGISTER.md

54

Id: 54
Area: Hiring
Item: Contractor onboarding/offboarding (access, IP, NDA)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Next contractor
Evidence: IP assignments in place

55

Id: 55
Area: Hiring
Item: First hire profile + trigger
Owner: Founder
Priority: P2
Status: Not started
Gate: Second paid customer
Evidence: Solo founder

56

Id: 56
Area: Fundraising
Item: Fundraising readiness checklist
Owner: Founder
Priority: P2
Status: Deferred
Gate: When raising
Evidence: Bootstrapping for now

`Business extras and launch plan — ui_kits/business/extras.js`

Window.BIZ EXTRA

Roadmap

Span	Items
Days 1–30 · Make the pilot legal to run	Bind cyber + E&O insurance (contract requirement), EIN, state tax registration, business bank, bookkeeping, Map every DPA/FERPA obligation to a control and an owner, Publish subprocessor list: Vercel, Supabase (+ AI provider, with "no student records" boundary), Data inventory + data-flow map for student records, Retention + deletion schedule, Test that student records never reach an AI provider; document it
Days 31–60 · Pass the university reviews	Complete HECVAT Full from docs/trust + evidence register, Ship SAML / Shibboleth SSO with the university IdP, VPAT / ACR against WCAG 2.1 AA (use existing a11y tests as evidence), Incident-response tabletop; record it, Restore-from-backup test; record RTO/RPO, Privacy Policy + Terms reviewed by counsel
Days 61–90 · Launch and prove the pilot	Agree pilot start + renewal decision dates in a mutual action plan, Baseline the success metrics with the champion, Onboarding + support intake with severity levels, Weekly check-in and KPI review, Draft the results deck and annual conversion proposal

Risks

- Pilot starts without required insurance, High, High, Bind cyber + E&O in days 1–30; send certificate to the university, Founder
- HECVAT Full not complete → security review stalls, High, High, Start from docs/trust; answer only verified controls; book a review call, Founder
- SAML SSO not ready for launch, Medium, High, Prioritise SSO in days 31–60; test with the university IdP early, Engineering
- Student record exposure / breach, Low, Critical, RLS + tenant isolation tests, least privilege, IR plan, AI boundary test, Founder

- VPAT gaps found late, Medium, Medium, Run ACR early; fix blockers before launch; disclose known gaps, Founder
- No decision date → pilot drifts, no conversion, High, High, Mutual action plan with named economic buyer and decision date, Founder
- Solo-founder capacity, High, Medium, Use budget for counsel/broker/accountant; contractors with IP + NDA; defer P2, Founder
- Claims outrun evidence in marketing, Medium, Medium, Public claims register; no "secure/compliant" without evidence, Founder

Hiring

- Now, Fractional counsel (DPA, MSA, privacy), Contract, Pilot obligations
- Now, Insurance broker, Contract, Cyber + E&O
- Now, Bookkeeper / accountant, Contract, First invoice
- After pilot launch, Implementation / support contractor, Contract, Pilot support load > founder capacity
- After second paid customer, First full-time engineer, Hire, Two institutions live

Fundraising

- Decide raise vs. bootstrap after pilot results, Deferred
- Convert LLC → Delaware C-corp before a priced round, Deferred
- Clean cap table + IP chain, Ready (IP signed)
- Data room: contracts, security, financials, Not started
- Investor deck from pilot results, Draft (this kit)
- 12-month model with scenarios, Not started

Window.BIZ LAUNCH

- Corporate, Company owns all IP; founder + contractor assignments filed, Signed assignments in records folder
- Banking, Business account, approval rules, chart of accounts, Business funds separate from personal
- Accounting, Bookkeeping, monthly close checklist, expense policy, tax calendar, Monthly P&L, balance sheet, cash flow
- Financial model, 36-month driver-based model, Unit economics, runway, break-even
- Pricing, Pilot, institution, implementation, AI overage, support, Approved price book + discount rules
- Insurance, Cyber, E&O, general liability; evaluate D&O later, Coverage reviewed against contract
- Legal, Terms, Privacy, DPA, SLA, MSA, Versioned and counsel-reviewed
- Identity, MFA on admin, code, cloud, finance, CRM, support, production, MFA report
- Access, Least privilege, role review, contractor offboarding, Quarterly access review log
- Data, Encryption in transit/at rest, backups, restore test, Restore test record with RTO/RPO
- Monitoring, Errors, uptime, security alert triage, audit logging, Alert runbook + on-call
- Resilience, Business continuity + DR runbook, tested, Tabletop record
- Vendor risk, Subprocessor review + vendor register, Vendor register
- Procurement, HECVAT Full, answer library, DPA/SLA path, Completed HECVAT
- Accessibility, ACR/VPAT, manual test protocol, statement, Published ACR

Window.GTM COPY

Personas

- VP Student Success, Retention and on-time progress, Fewer students surprised by holds and deadlines, Will it add work for my advisors?, Advisors see only what students share; no new queue
- Registrar, Accurate records, clean registration, Students arrive at registration ready, Will it change official records?, Read-only; your SIS stays authoritative
- CIO / IT, Security, integration load, One governed integration, SSO, audit, Another system to secure?, HECVAT Full, SAML SSO, RLS per tenant, subprocessor list
- Accessibility office, WCAG 2.2 AA, Accessible by design, ACR provided, Do you have a VPAT?, ACR in preparation; manual test protocol shared
- Procurement / counsel, Risk and terms, Standard DPA/FERPA, insurance, SLA, FERPA and AI?, DPA addendum; student records never reach an AI provider
- Students, What do I do next?, One clear next step with its source, Is this tracking me?, You decide what is shared; export or delete anytime

Messages

- Headline, One clear next step for every student.
- Subhead, Semester turns the semester into the next thing to do — and shows where each fact came from. Your official systems stay official.
- Pilot CTA, Request a pilot design session
- Proof line, In a bounded, paid pilot with one university.
- AI line, AI-assisted, source-linked. Student records never reach an AI provider.

Objections

- We already have a portal, Semester sits on top of it and turns its data into a next step; nothing is replaced in the pilot.
- Our advisors are overloaded, Students resolve more on their own; advisors get shared plans, not a new inbox.
- AI risk, Course AI policy is enforced, answers are labelled and cited, and records stay out of AI providers.
- No budget this year, A one-term paid pilot fits a discretionary budget; annual pricing is decided after results.
- You are a small company, Insurance, DPA, HECVAT and exit/export terms are in the contract; data is yours to export.

PART 2

Brand

Identity, voice, the mark and logo system, iconography, imagery and launch materials.

Brand identity

docs/system/design/SEMESTER_BRAND_IDENTITY.md

Brand identity

Semester design, intelligence, workflow and data system · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/expand further on brand identy algorthims workflow.pdf, reconciled with this design system (readme.md, tokens/, components/). Where they differ, this design system wins and the difference is listed.

> Semester should make an institutionally complex world feel personally clear.

Position

Semester is the education operating system. It turns fragmented academic information, campus systems, learning tools, support workflows, productivity tools and AI into one clear, governed, human-centered environment.

Emotional outcome by audience

Audience	Desired feeling
Student	I know what to do next.
Faculty	This helps me teach clearly without adding administrative burden.
Advisor	I can support students without chasing information across systems.
Registrar	This respects academic authority, auditability and correctness.
CIO / security	This is controlled, governable, interoperable and operationally mature.
Parent / guardian	I can support without invading the student's privacy.
Employer	This is credible, verified educational evidence — not a scraped profile.
Semester operator	I can see, govern, support and improve the platform safely.

Personality

- Calm, not sterile
- Intelligent, not patronizing
- Ambitious, not inflated
- Academic, not bureaucratic
- Modern, not trendy for its own sake
- Warm, not childish
- Trustworthy, not vague

- Human-centered, not surveillance-centered
- Powerful, not overwhelming

Vocabulary

Use: path, action, progress, evidence, source, guide, workspace, Course Studio, support, plan, clarity, next step, governed, trusted, connected, official, student-controlled, explainable, accessible, institution-ready.

Avoid: disrupt everything, revolutionary AI magic, replace humans, guaranteed outcomes, fully automated advising, perfect personalization, total surveillance, one-click compliance, all-in-one without explanation, enterprise-grade without evidence.

Core statements

Context	Statement
Short	Semester is the education operating system.
Student	Semester helps you understand where you are, what matters next, and how to move forward.
Institution	Semester connects student action, learning, planning, support and institutional operations in one governed platform.
Technical	A multi-tenant education platform with role-aware workflows, policy-governed AI, source authority, evidence, interoperability and operational controls.
Trust	Built to make educational information clearer, more actionable, more accessible and more accountable.

These sit alongside the existing tagline system in readme.md (Content fundamentals). Assets: assets/logo-*.svg, guidelines/brand-*.html.

`docs/system/design/SEMESTER_VISUAL_LANGUAGE.md`

Visual language

Semester design, intelligence, workflow and data system · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/expand further on brand identy algorthims workflow.pdf, reconciled with this design system (readme.md, tokens/, components/). Where they differ, this design system wins and the difference is listed.

> Semester should make an institutionally complex world feel personally clear.

Primary feeling: a calm, high-trust academic workspace. Not a noisy social app, a legacy portal, a generic corporate dashboard, a childish EdTech product, or a glowing "AI" landing page.

Color semantics (adopted) and hues (this design system)

Role	Meaning	Token in this system
Action / focus / selected	User action, trusted navigation	Semester blue —blue-700 #416180 (light), —blue-400 #94bce3 (dark)

Role	Meaning	Token in this system
Neutral	Calm, focus, readable density	Ink (#090a0e family) chrome, Parchment (#f4f1ea) content, text tokens
Success	Completed, healthy, confirmed	Source/status "done" stone hue (ink + hairline + 8% wash)
Warning	Needs attention, review, limited confidence, freshness	Attention / review stone hue
Critical	Error, security concern, failed, urgent	—status-danger
Information	Source, guidance, context	Connected / official source hues
Context	Inactive, historical, unavailable	Text secondary / tertiary

Rules: never use status colour as decoration; never show a critical state by colour alone (glyph + words: ◆ ○ ✦ ⇄ ? ! ✓ ⊘).

Open decision for the founder: the source PDF proposes indigo/blue-violet as primary and emerald/amber/rose as status hues. This design system uses Semester blue and desaturated stone status hues (readme.md, Visual foundations). The roles above are adopted; the hues are unchanged until you decide otherwise.

Type

Role	Use	Token
Display	Narrative statements, hero	Cinzel (rare)
Heading	Screen titles, sections, steps	Barlow Condensed 600
Subheading	Cards, modules	Barlow Condensed
Body	Explanation and reading	Barlow 16/1.55
Body small	Metadata, source, freshness	Barlow 13–14
Label	Forms, controls, status	Kicker 10.5 tracked caps
Mono	Record, audit, correlation IDs	System mono

One H1 per page; strict heading order; short student sentences; plain language first; expand acronyms; no long all-caps; tabular figures for money, analytics, schedules; source and freshness readable but secondary.

Shape, depth, motion

Corners 3/6/10 (moderate, never toy-like). Border and contrast before shadow. Motion 130–280 ms, purposeful, zeroed by reduced motion and calm mode. Illustration only when it clarifies a workflow or reduces anxiety; never filler art.

Voice and content

Content fundamentals

From `docs/BRAND-PLATFORM.md` (draft) and in-app copy. **Personality:** a good registrar's assistant crossed with a precision instrument — exact, calm, candid, warm sparingly, self-possessed. **Public descriptor:** "the student action platform" ("Student OS" is internal only — it implies replacement). **Assistant name:** *Ask Semester* — no human name, face or persona; always labelled AI-assisted.

The status sentence (the unit of Semester voice): *what is true → what that means for you → what you can do.* "Your Canvas calendar hasn't updated since Tuesday. Deadlines below may have moved. Reconnect it, or check the course page."

Prefer / avoid: "helps you organise" not "revolutionises"; "alongside your school's systems" not "replaces / all-in-one"; "AI-assisted, source-linked" not "AI-powered / intelligent / magic"; name the control, never "secure / private / compliant / certified"; "planned / in private beta / pilot" not "launching soon"; "can / is designed to" not "guarantees / always / 100%"; "student" not "user / learner". Destinations are always Today, My Path, Search, Plan, Me.

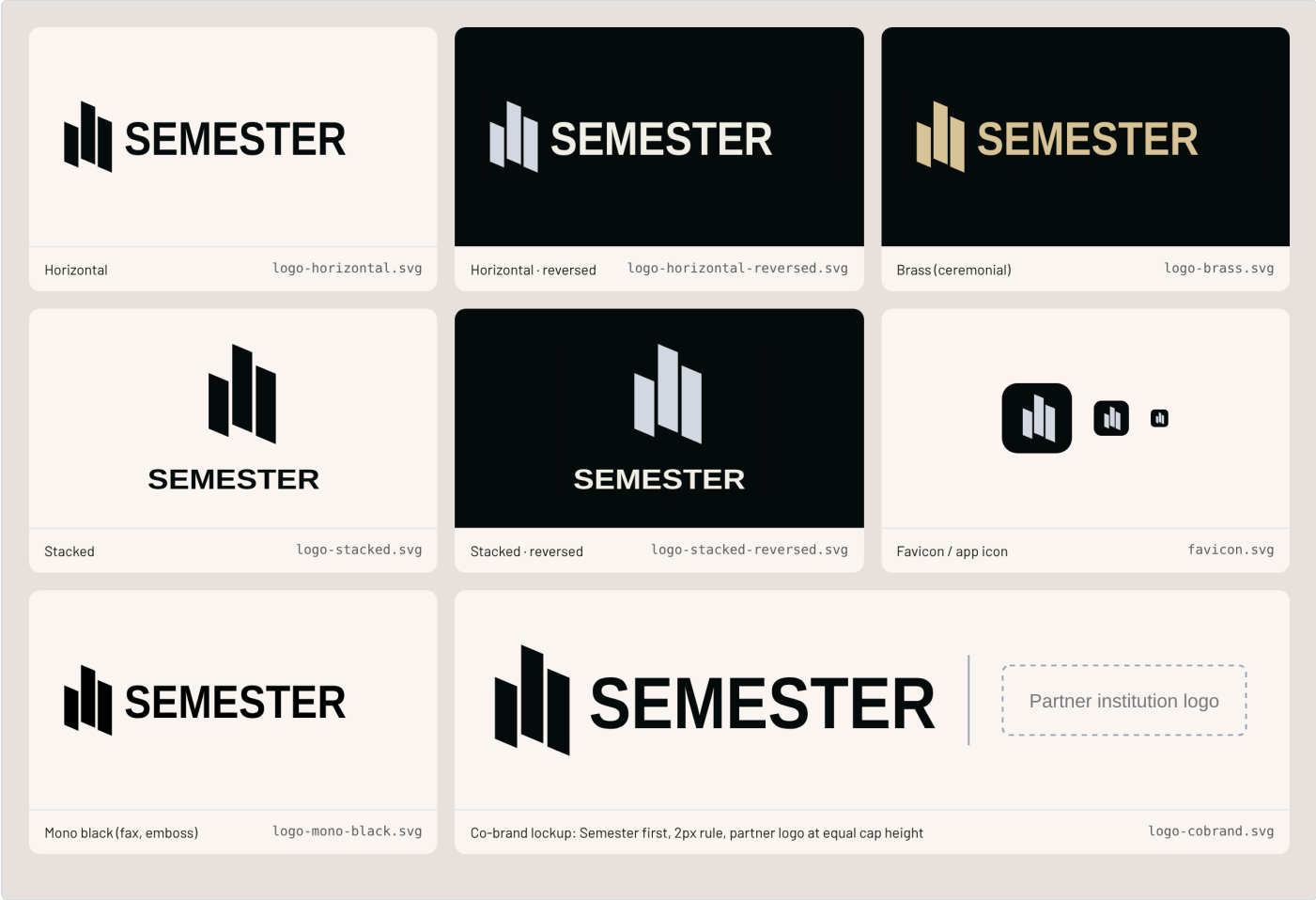
Consequence copy from the product: "Confirming puts you on the waitlist, number 3 in line. You are not enrolled until a seat comes to you." · "You leave CHEM 101 and a W is recorded on your transcript. It cannot be undone here." · "Worked out by Semester from released grades only; your instructor's final grade is the one that counts." · "Only what you tick here can be shared. Nothing else — not your study history, grades, notes or anything else — ever is."

- **Voice:** plain, precise, quietly warm. Speaks to the student as **"you"**; the product never says "we" about itself in-UI ("Semester has not checked it with your institution"). First person only in the assistant's own answer ("I'd place them…").
- **Casing:** Sentence case everywhere — buttons, titles, chips ("Needs confirmation", "Sync trouble"). UPPERCASE only for tracked kickers/eyebrows and the wordmark.
- **Say what, why, who decides.** Every state explains itself: *"You are offline. You can keep working — 2 changes will sync when you are back."* Errors say what is safe: *"Your draft is safe on this device."*
- **Name the source.** "Institution verified", "Imported", "Student entered", "Estimated", "AI-assisted", "Needs review". Never "verified" unless it was.
- **Consequences before confirm:** What happens / Exactly what / What stays the same / Taking it back. *"This can be reversed on request: ask the Registrar before Oct 20."*
- **Respectful, not celebratory:** no streaks, ranks, exclamation marks or confetti. *"Registration submitted. Next: review your fall schedule."*
- **Never overclaim:** don't call Semester the official gradebook, registrar or payment system; label demo data "Sample".
- **Numbers:** tabular figures; dates as "Thu 9 Oct · 23:59"; middle dot `·` separates metadata.
- **Emoji:** never. Unicode glyphs are used as status marks: ◆ official, ○ yours, ✦ AI, ⇄ connected/conflict, ? review, ! attention, ✓ done, ⊘ offline, … working, ◌ sample.

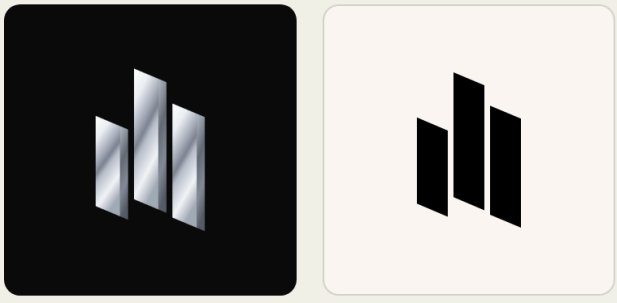
✓ helps you organise · turns … into	✕ revolutionises · transforms · supercharge
✓ alongside your school’s systems	✕ replaces · all-in-one · everything school
✓ AI-assisted, source-linked · Ask Semester	✕ AI-powered · intelligent · knows you · magic
✓ built with controls for [named control]	✕ secure · private · compliant · certified
✓ planned · in private beta · in a pilot	✕ launching soon · coming Spring
✓ can · is designed to	✕ guarantees · always · never fails · 100%
✓ student	✕ user · learner
✓ Your Canvas calendar hasn’t updated since Tuesday. Deadlines may have moved. Reconnect it.	✕ Oops! Something went wrong 😕

Voice — prefer / avoid

The mark and logo system

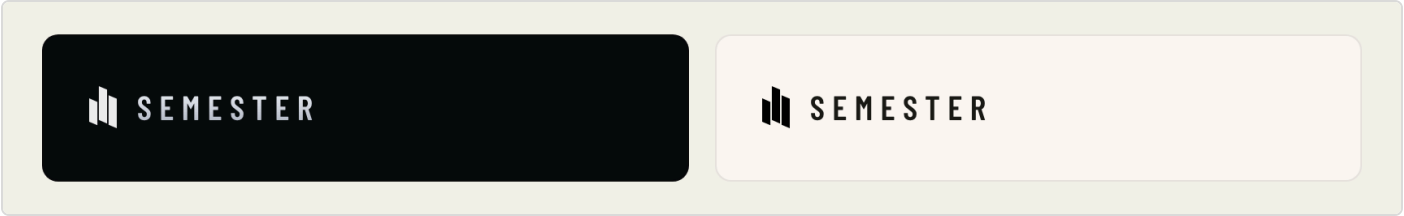


Logo system



Lit silver on Ink for app icons and splash; flat currentColor everywhere in-app so it follows the ground. Never recolour into the accent, add glow, or place on photography.

Logo mark

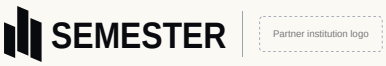


Wordmark lockup

Every logo file



logo-brass.svg



logo-cobrand.svg



logo-horizontal-reversed.svg



logo-horizontal.svg



logo-mark-maskable.svg



logo-mark-tile.svg



logo-mark.svg



logo-mono-black.svg



logo-mono-white.svg



logo-stacked-reversed.svg



logo-stacked.svg



logo-mark-silver.png



logo-mark-512.png



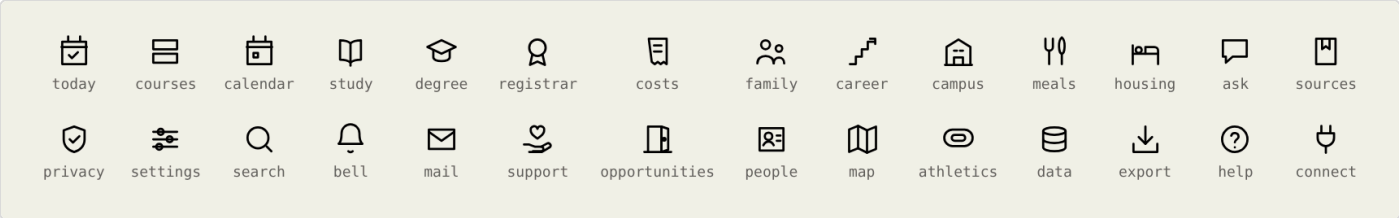
apple-touch-icon.png



favicon.svg

Iconography

- The app ships its **own inline icon set** (`app/src/components/icons.data.ts`): Lucide-like, 24×24 grid, **1.5px stroke, round caps/joins, no fills** (one exception: the favourite star fills when on). 108 glyphs, copied programmatically to `assets/icons/*.svg` and to `components/icons/iconShapes.js` for the `<Icon>` component.
- Default size 19px in rows/rails, 21px in the tab bar, 15–17px inside buttons. Always `currentColor`.
- `assets/icons-sprite.svg` is the app's public sprite; logo files: `assets/logo-horizontal(-reversed).svg`, `logo-stacked(-reversed).svg`, `logo-brass.svg`, `logo-mono-black/white.svg`, `favicon.svg`, `logo-cobrand.svg` (see Brand → Logo system), `assets/logo-mark.svg` (flat, currentColor, generated from `mark.data.ts`), `assets/logo-mark-tile.svg` / `-maskable.svg` / `-512.png` (lit silver app icons), `assets/logo-mark-silver.png` (uploaded render).
- Unicode glyphs carry status (see Content). Emoji are never used. Icon-only controls always have an accessible name. If a glyph you need is missing, use the matching **Lucide** icon at stroke-width 1.5 (CDN) and flag it.



Iconography overview

Sizes

15px 17px 19px 21px

15–17 in buttons · 19 in rows and rails · 21 in the tab bar

Drawing

24×24 grid, 1.5px stroke, round caps and joins, no fills (favourite star fills when on). Always currentColor. 108 glyphs.

Missing glyph
Matching Lucide icon at stroke 1.5, flagged

Status glyphs

◆ official ○ yours ✦ AI

⇄ connected ? review ! attention

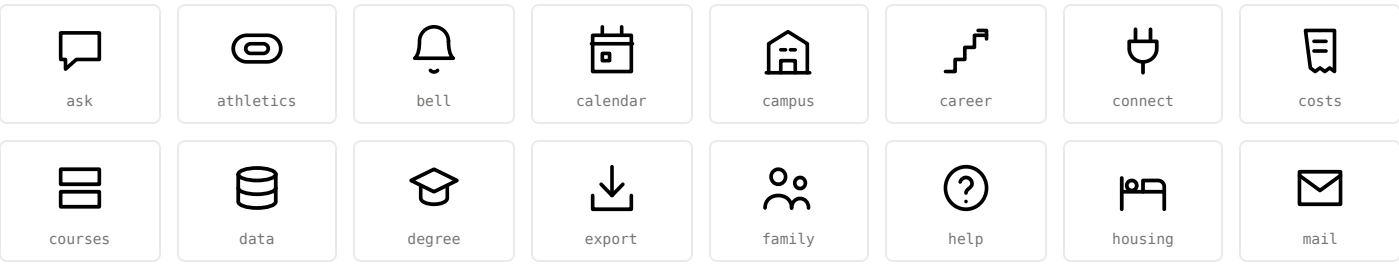
✓ done ⊘ offline … working ◌

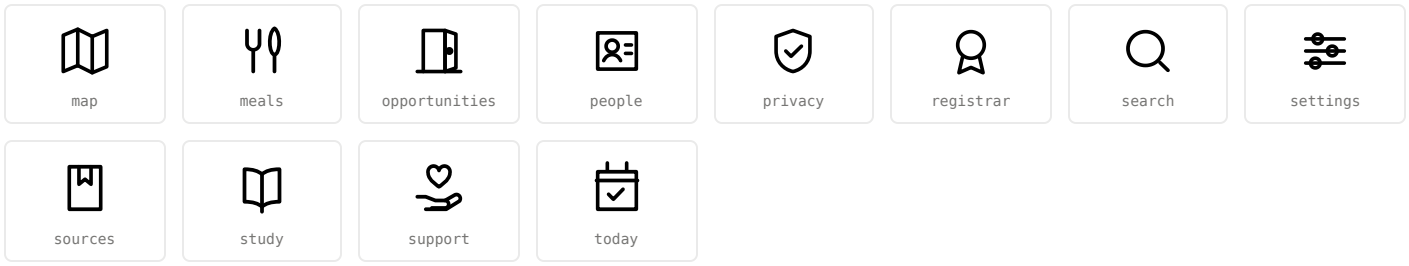
sample

No emoji. Icon-only controls always have an accessible name.

Iconography rules

The complete icon set (28 glyphs)

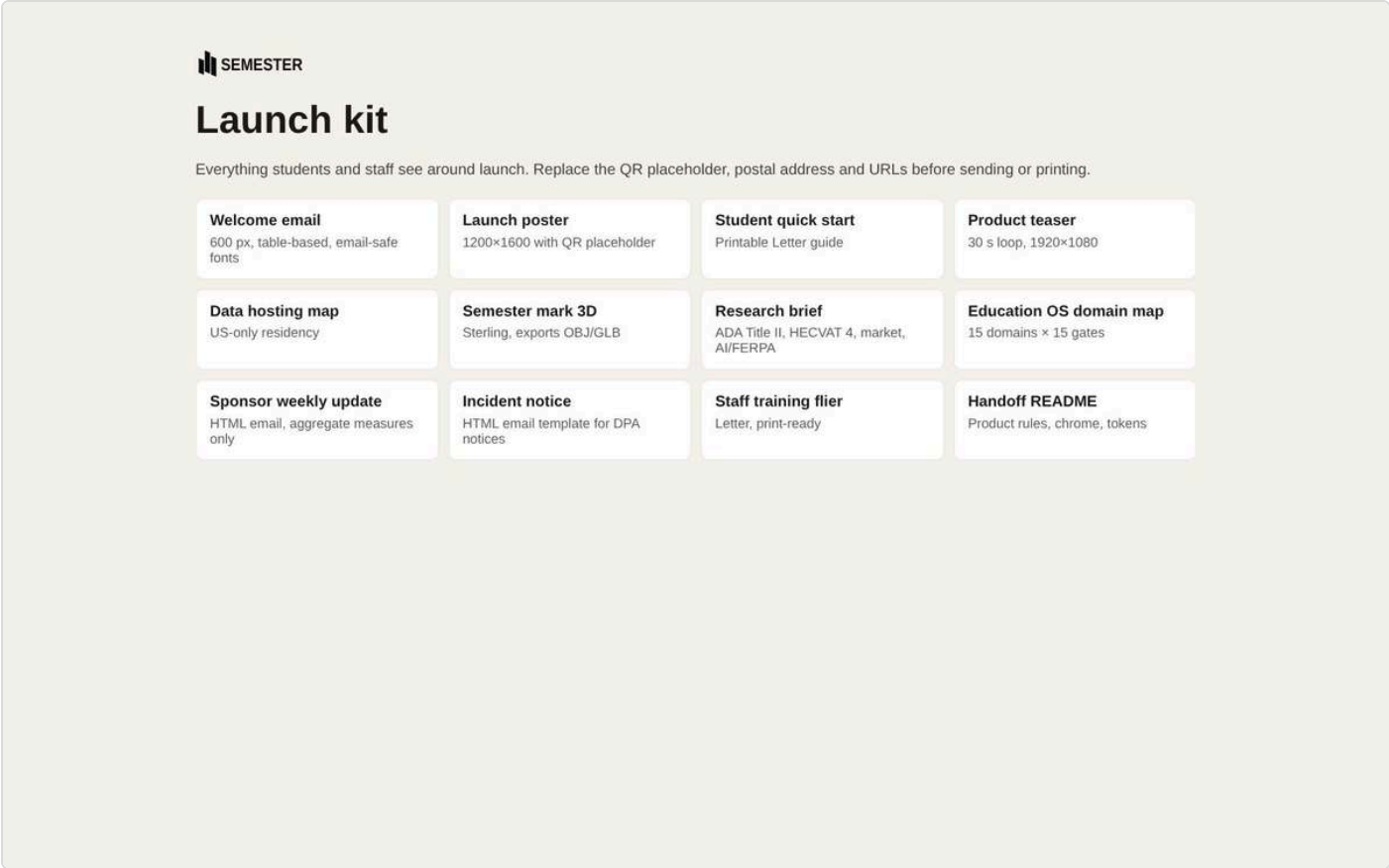



map
meals
opportunities
people
privacy
registrar
search
settings
sources
study
support
today

Launch kit

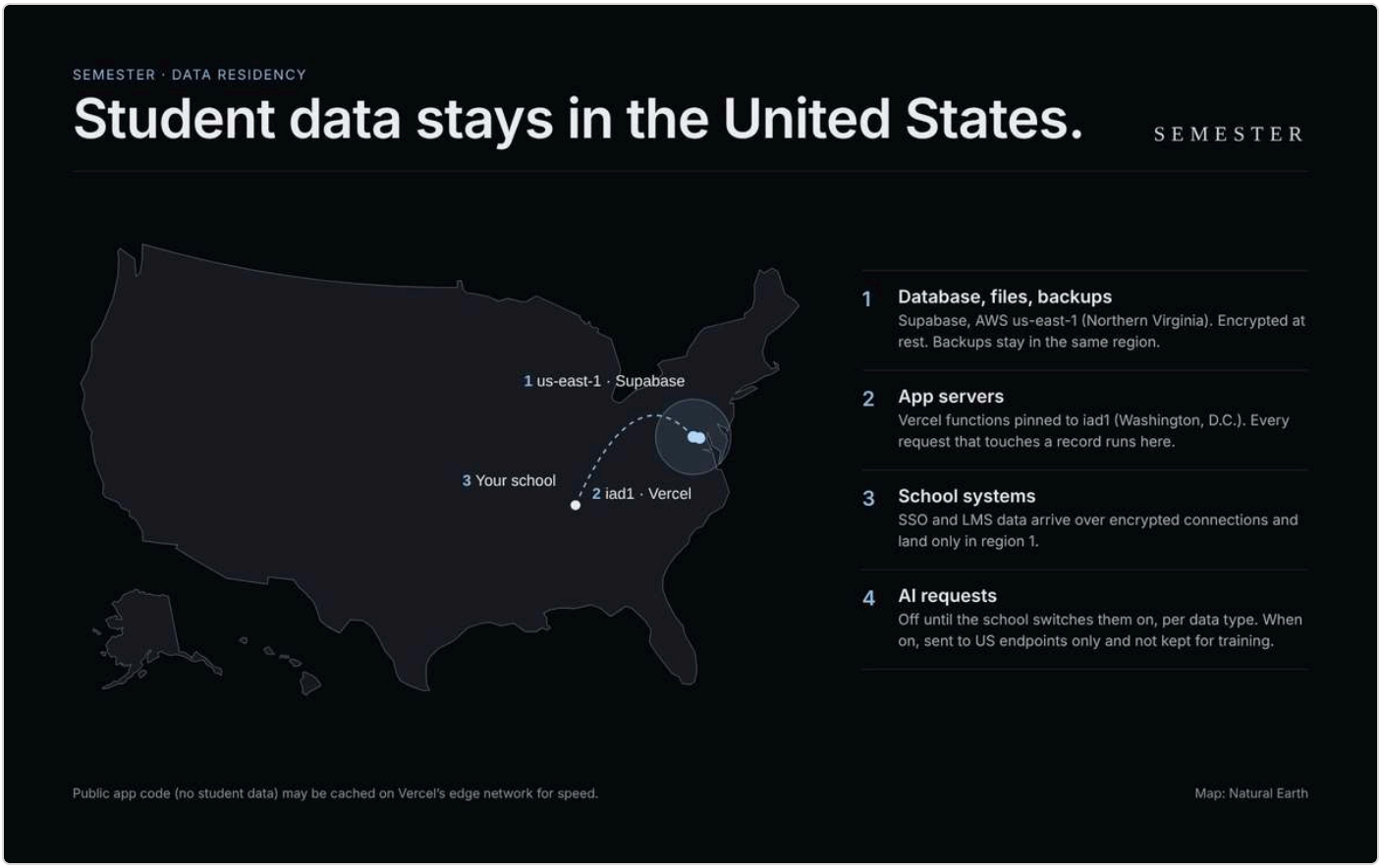
Welcome and incident emails, sponsor update, staff flier, data hosting map and the 3D mark. **6 screens.**

launch-kit



Opening view

Data Hosting Map



Opening view

Incident Notice Email

SEMESTER INCIDENT NOTICE

SEVERITY [S1/S2] · REFERENCE [INC-0001] · [DATE, TIME, TIMEZONE]

[Short plain description, e.g. “Sign-in unavailable for 40 minutes”]

What happened	**[Facts known now; no speculation]**
When	**[Start] – [end or “ongoing”]**
Who is affected	**[Cohort, roles, approximate count]**
Data that may be affected	**[Categories, or “No student data involved”]**
What we have done	**[Feature turned off / fix deployed / access revoked]**
What you can do now	**[Action or “Nothing needed”]**
Next update	**[Time] or sooner if anything changes**

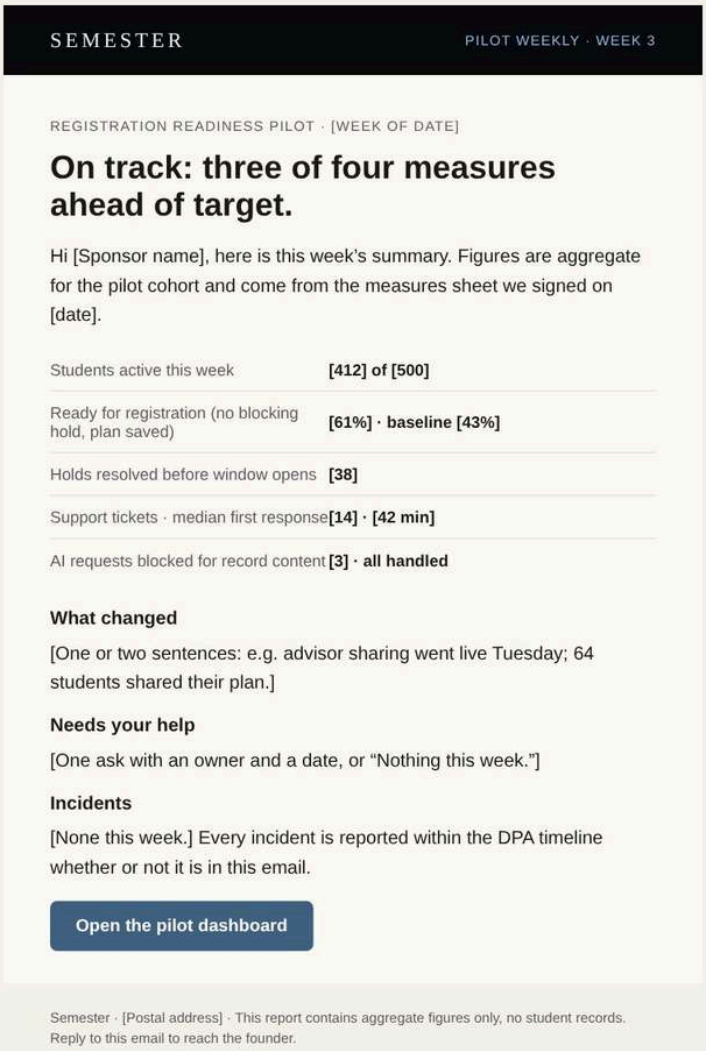
This notice goes to the institution's named security contact under the DPA. The institution decides whether and how to notify students; we will help with wording and facts.

Contact: [Incident commander name], security@semester.app, [phone].

Semester · [Postal address] · This report contains aggregate figures only, no student records. Reply to this email to reach the founder.

Opening view

Sponsor Weekly Update



SEMESTER

PILOT WEEKLY · WEEK 3

REGISTRATION READINESS PILOT · [WEEK OF DATE]

On track: three of four measures ahead of target.

Hi [Sponsor name], here is this week's summary. Figures are aggregate for the pilot cohort and come from the measures sheet we signed on [date].

Students active this week	**[412] of [500]**
Ready for registration (no blocking hold, plan saved)	**[61%] · baseline [43%]**
Holds resolved before window opens	**[38]**
Support tickets · median first response	**[14] · [42 min]**
AI requests blocked for record content	**[3] · all handled**

What changed

[One or two sentences: e.g. advisor sharing went live Tuesday; 64 students shared their plan.]

Needs your help

[One ask with an owner and a date, or "Nothing this week."]

Incidents

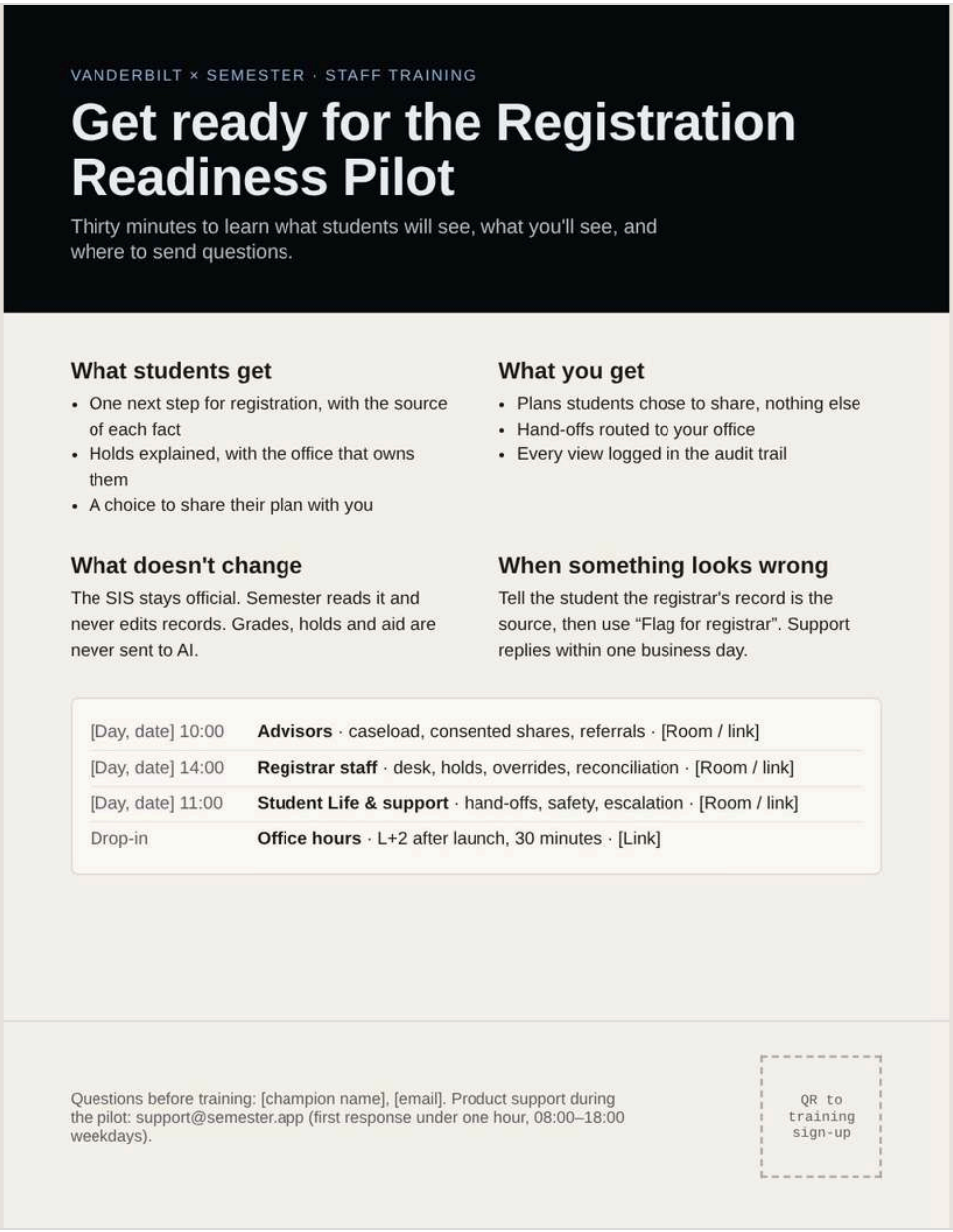
[None this week.] Every incident is reported within the DPA timeline whether or not it is in this email.

Open the pilot dashboard

Semester · [Postal address] · This report contains aggregate figures only, no student records. Reply to this email to reach the founder.

Opening view

Staff Training Flier



VANDERBILT × SEMESTER · STAFF TRAINING

Get ready for the Registration Readiness Pilot

Thirty minutes to learn what students will see, what you'll see, and where to send questions.

What students get

- One next step for registration, with the source of each fact
- Holds explained, with the office that owns them
- A choice to share their plan with you

What you get

- Plans students chose to share, nothing else
- Hand-offs routed to your office
- Every view logged in the audit trail

What doesn't change

The SIS stays official. Semester reads it and never edits records. Grades, holds and aid are never sent to AI.

When something looks wrong

Tell the student the registrar's record is the source, then use “Flag for registrar”. Support replies within one business day.

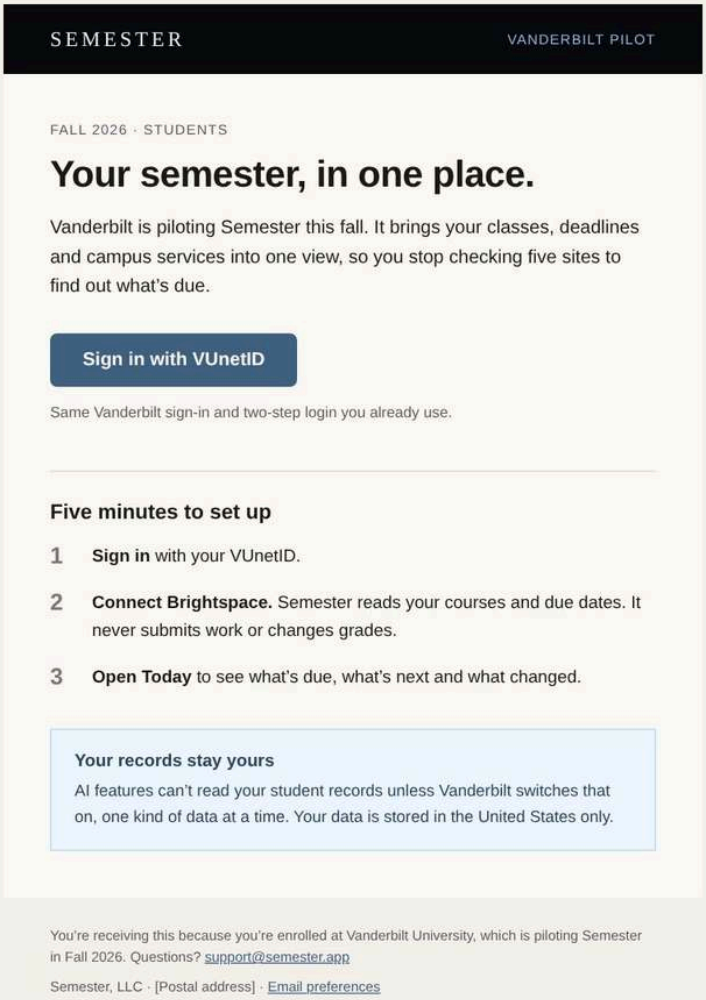
[Day, date] 10:00	**Advisors** · caseload, consented shares, referrals · [Room / link]
[Day, date] 14:00	**Registrar staff** · desk, holds, overrides, reconciliation · [Room / link]
[Day, date] 11:00	**Student Life & support** · hand-offs, safety, escalation · [Room / link]
Drop-in	**Office hours** · L+2 after launch, 30 minutes · [Link]

Questions before training: [champion name], [email]. Product support during the pilot: support@semester.app (first response under one hour, 08:00–18:00 weekdays).

QR to training sign-up

Opening view

Welcome Email



Opening view

Launch kit notes

ui_kits/launch-kit/README.md

Handoff: Semester UI

Overview

Semester is an education operating system. It gives every campus role one home on a shared education graph, connecting first to existing systems (SSO, Brightspace, SIS) and replacing them only once proven. This package holds every designed surface: 13 role onboarding flows, the student Platform, Institution OS, the Company Command Center, the planning maps, the vision deck, and the launch pieces (student quick start, welcome email, poster, teaser, data-hosting map, 3D mark, research brief).

The engineering phase plan lives separately in `handoff/education-os/` (phase prompts + `run.sh`). Build order and review gates come from that kit; this package is the visual and behavioural reference.

About the design files

The `.dc.html` / `.html` files here are **design references built in HTML**. They are prototypes that show intended look, copy and behaviour; they are not production code. Recreate them in the target codebase (the Semester app: Next.js on Vercel, Supabase), using its existing components and patterns. The design-system bundle in `_ds/` mirrors components from the app (`SideRail`, `SystemContextBar`, `MetricTile`, `DataTable`, `SourceBadge`, `Notice`, `NextSteps`, `Choice`, `Switch`, `Button`, `TextField`, `Fields`, `DecisionTrail`, `StepStatus`, `ProvenanceChart`, `Wordmark`, `Mark`). Use the app's own versions where they exist.

Open any `.dc.html` file directly in a browser to see it run. `support.js` is the prototype runtime and is not needed in production.

Fidelity

High fidelity. Colours, type, spacing, copy and interaction states are final, and the screens use real design-system tokens. Sample data is Vanderbilt pilot data and must be replaced with live data and permission checks.

Non-negotiable product rules (enforce in code, not just UI)

- AI never reads student records until the institution switches it on, per data type. The UI shows the current state in Settings › Privacy.

- Every date, grade and answer carries a source label: **Institution verified**, **Yours**, **External**, **Estimated**, or **AI**. Never present AI or estimated values as official.
- Search results are filtered by the viewer's role and permissions before ranking, and AI answers cite sources with those labels.
- Instructors see approved accommodations, never the reason for them.
- Safety reports go to the institution, and Semester keeps no record of them.
- Marketplace apps never receive student records. Partner certification is required.
- Connections only shows users who opted into **Findable**.
- Data residency is US only: Vercel functions on iad1 and Supabase on AWS us-east-1.
- Semester never submits work or changes grades in the LMS; the Brightspace connection is read-only in phase 1.

Screens / views

Application chrome is the same on every product surface: - **Grid:** a `248px` SideRail (always lnk `#090a0e`), then a content column at `minmax(0,1fr)`, full viewport height. - **Context bar:** `SystemContextBar` (44px) shows location, term and sync state. - **Content:** scrolls inside `<main>`, `max-width: 1180px`, padding `28px 30px 64px`. - **Page header:** - Eyebrow: 10.5px Barlow, uppercase, letter-spacing .08em, `--text-secondary`. - H1: Barlow Condensed 600, 26px, letter-spacing –.015em. - Optional subline: `--text-secondary`. - Bottom border: `1px --border-subtle`, with 20px padding below the header. - **Two-column bodies:** `grid-template-columns: repeat(auto-fit, minmax(min(100%,420px),1fr)); gap: 32px`. - **Metric rows:** `repeat(auto-fill, minmax(200px,1fr)); gap: 12px`.

Onboarding (`Onboarding.dc.html` + 13 role files)

- Hub: role picker linking to each role file.
- Each role file has three parts: a sign-in screen ("Sign in with Vanderbilt", simulated SSO delay of about 1.5s), the role home, and a three-step **Finish setting up** checklist (for example, Faculty: Import Brightspace courses → Set your course AI policy → Publish office hours).
- The rail on onboarding homes is static (current item fixed); the destinations are built in Platform and Institution OS.
- Roles: Student, Faculty, TA, Advisor, Registrar, Student affairs, Finance, IT security, Support, Applicant, Guardian, Alumni, Employer.

Semester Platform (`Semester Platform.dc.html`)

Screen	What it does
Search	Filtered results, plus an AI-assisted answer with cited, source-labelled references
Study cards	Flashcards generated from course slides; flip, mark known
Connections	Social layer; only Findable users appear
Safety	One-tap emergency contacts and anonymous reporting (not recorded by Semester)
Accessibility	Accommodations and instructor letters (reason hidden from instructors)
Marketplace	Six certified apps; install never shares records
Developers	Sandbox API keys, webhooks, certification checklist

Institution OS (`Institution OS.dc.html`)

The screens are Executive, Communications, Course Studio, Registrar OS, Research and Admissions. These are operational dashboards built from MetricTile, DataTable and DecisionTrail.

Company Command Center (`Company Command Center.dc.html`)

- **Production strip** above the context bar: `#090a0e` background, 13px text. The "Production" label is uppercase in `#94bce3`. The line reads "Vercel us-east-1 · Supabase us-east-1 · every action here is audited."
- **Overview:** six pilot blockers (HECVAT, data agreement, SSO, accessibility, insurance, incident plan), each a checkbox ticked when evidence is filed.
- **Other screens:** Tenants, Revenue, Releases (gates and feature flags; AI flags belong to the institution), Reliability (incident toggle and sync freshness), Support, Trust (control → evidence table; never write "compliant" without a document), Finance (runway calculator: cash, pilot fee, monthly cost toggles) and Localisation.

Planning surfaces

- `Semester Master Operating Map.dc.html`: the 40 domains, each with what it replaces, its phase and its design link, plus a 35-item definition checklist. Selections persist in localStorage.
- `Education OS Domain Map.dc.html`: 15 domains filterable by phase, each with 15 gates.
- `Semester Finish Line.dc.html`: Pilot loop (18 steps), Readiness (14 domains × 21 gates), Release evidence (20 items) and Cadence. Selections persist.

Launch pieces

- `Semester Vision Deck.dc.html`: 12 slides at 1920×1080 with speaker notes. An offline copy, `Semester Vision Deck (offline).html`, is in the project root.
- `Student Quick Start.dc.html`: printable Letter guide with three setup steps, the source-label table, privacy rules and help contacts.
- `Welcome Email.html`: send-ready, table-based, 600px wide, using email-safe fonts. Replace `[Postal address]` and confirm the `semester.app/vanderbilt` and `/preferences` URLs before sending.
- `Launch Poster.dc.html`: 1200×1600 (3:4). The dashed QR box is a placeholder for a code that points to the sign-in URL.
- `Product Teaser.dc.html` + `teaser.jsx`: 30-second loop at 1920×1080 in five scenes (Chaos, Merge, Today, Trust, Close). Public piece, so it says "your school" rather than Vanderbilt.
- `Data Hosting Map.html`: 1600×1000 map of the US drawn from real Natural Earth geometry (d3), with US-only residency notes.
- `Semester Mark 3D.html`: the three-slab mark extruded in sterling, 0.30 m tall. Exports to OBJ or GLB.
- `Research Brief.dc.html`: sourced brief covering ADA Title II, HECVAT 4, the Canvas breach, Anthology, the market and AI/FERPA.

Interactions & behaviour

- **Rail navigation:** clicking a SideRail item swaps the `<main>` content and resets scroll to the top. The current item is highlighted.
- **Sync states:** `synced`, `syncing` and `delayed` (shown as "Connected · may be out of date"). They appear in the SystemContextBar.
- **Motion:**
- Easing: `--ease: cubic-bezier(.22,1,.36,1)`.
- Durations: fast 130ms, standard 180ms, slow 240ms, sheet 280ms.
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- **Checklists:**
- Pilot blockers, the domain checklist and finish-line gates are local toggles in the prototype.
- In production they need persistence and an audit trail of who ticked what, when and with which evidence.
- **Incident toggle** (Reliability): opens a notice and updates the status page. In production this is an audited action.
- **Accessibility:**
- Target WCAG 2.2 AA.
- Minimum hit target 44px for primary controls and 24px minimum overall.
- Focus ring 2px with a 2px offset.
- Every status pairs a word and a glyph, never colour alone.

State management (production)

State	Scope	Notes
Session and role	Per user	Comes from institution SSO
Institution AI switches	Per tenant, per data type	Read by every AI call server-side
Connector status per source	Per tenant	Drives sync badges
Source label	Per record	Stored on the graph record, not derived in the UI
Findable flag	Per user	Gates Connections
Accommodation grants	Per student	The reason field is never sent to instructor clients
Checklist and gate evidence	Per company/tenant	Append-only

Design tokens

These are the source files in `_ds/.../tokens/`. Key values:

Colour, grounds: - Ink: `#090a0e` background, `#12141a` panel, `#191c23` hero, `#22262f` raise, `#eceef2` text. - Parchment: `#f4f1ea` background, `#fbf9f4` panel, `#ffffff` hero, `#1b1a17` text. - Chrome (rail, tab bar, console header) is always Ink. Content defaults to Parchment.

Colour, text: - Secondary: `rgba(27,26,23,.68)` on Parchment, `rgba(236,238,242,.64)` on Ink. - Links: `#416180` on light, `#b5d9fd` on dark.

Colour, borders: `rgba(27,26,23,.09)` subtle, `.16` default, `.34` strong.

Colour, Semester blue: 100 `#eef6ff` · 200 `#d6ebff` · 300 `#b5d9fd` · 400 `#94bce3` · 500 `#749dc4` · 600 `#597ea3` · 700 `#416180` · 800 `#2c455d` · 900 `#1d2d3d`.

Colour, metals: sterling `#d4d9e2` (bright `#f6f8fb`, deep `#9ca3b2`); brass `#d8c79a`.

Colour, source and status (ink on light / tint on dark): - Official: `#2c455d` / `#b5d9fd` - Connected: `#2d5c61` / `#9fcbcd` - Personal: `#4a4b4f` / `#b9b9bd` - AI: `#544a7f` / `#bcb2df` - Pending: `#7a5310` / `#e2c27a` - Risk: `#a3301f` / `#f0907a` - Success: `#3e6141` / `#a9c9a3`

Type: - Families: - Barlow for body text. - Barlow Condensed 600 for headings, labels and controls. - Cinzel for editorial display only: the wordmark, deck titles and the poster mark. - System mono for identifiers. - Scale: 9 · 10 · 10.5 · 11 · 11.5 · 12 · 12.5 · 14 (control) · 16 (base) · 16.5 · 17 · 18 · 19 · 20 · 22 · 24 · 26 · 28 · 32 · 42 · 56px, all multiplied by `--text-scale`.

Spacing: - Compact steps: `--sp-1…7` = 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 16px, multiplied by `--density` (1 comfortable, .86 snug, .74 tight). - Layout grid: 8, 16, 24, 32, 40, 48, 64, 80, 96px. - Page padding: 18px, then 20px from 760px wide, then 30px from 1100px wide.

Radii: 3px (controls), 6px (cards), 10px (surfaces and sheets), 999px (pill).

Elevation: - On light: `0 1px 2px rgba(43,43,45,.14)`, `0 3px 10px …/.16`, `0 12px 32px …/.22`. - On dark: lift-1/2/3, as in `effects.css`. - Use a border first and a shadow second.

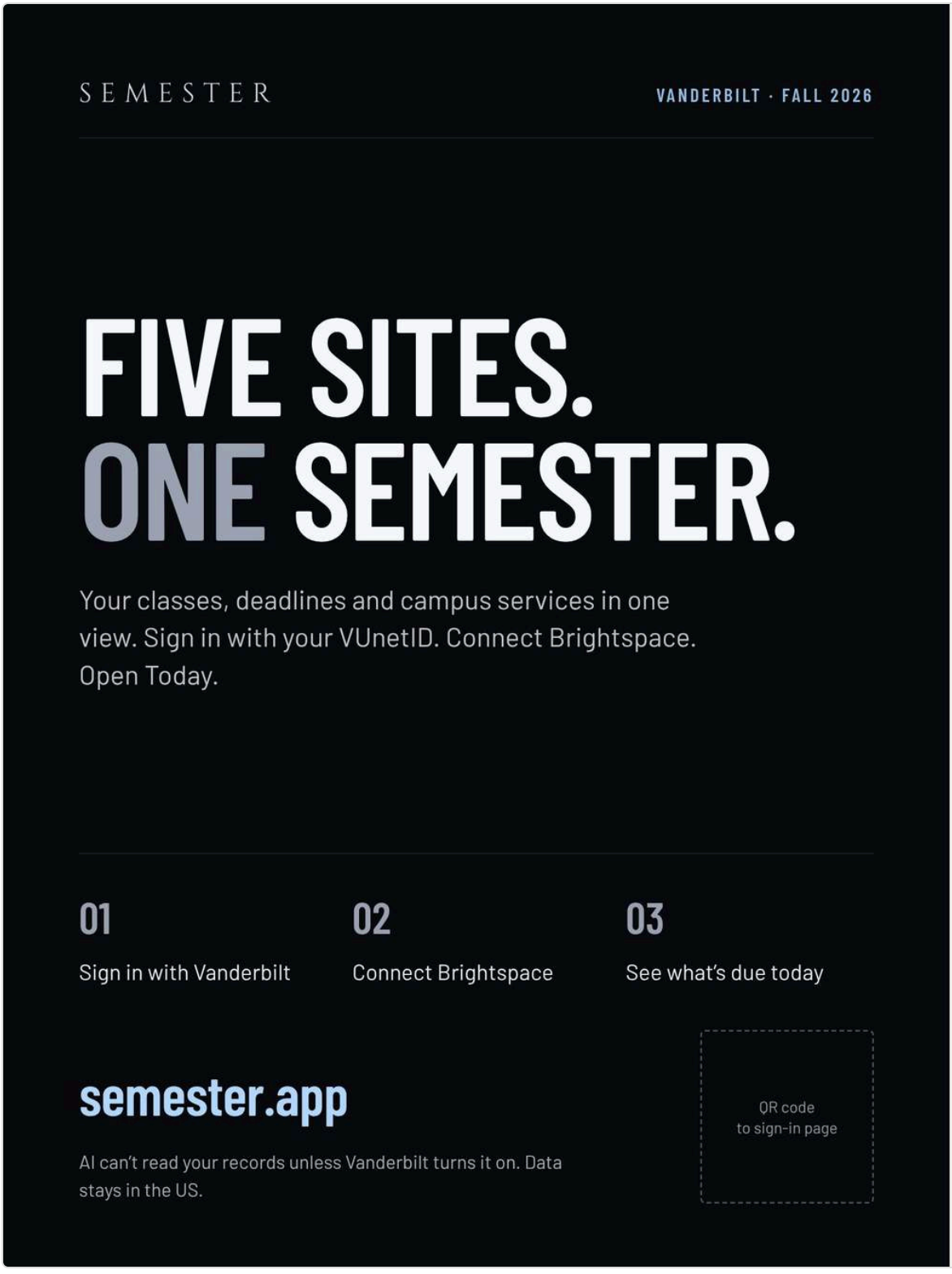
Assets

- Fonts are in `_ds/.../fonts/` as woff2 files: Barlow 400/500/700, Barlow Condensed 400/600, Cinzel.
- The mark is three slabs on a 512 grid, with viewBox `128 65 256 382`:
- `M128 176L204 208L204 420L128 388Z`
- `M218 65L294 97L294 404L218 372Z`
- `M308 147L384 179L384 447L308 415Z`
- Map geometry: Natural Earth via `world-atlas@2.0.2`, public domain.
- Icons come from the design-system bundle's icon set (`SideRail` `icon` ids).
- There's no photography. Image needs are marked as placeholders.

Files

All design files are copied into this folder: - **Design files:** every `.dc.html` / `.html` file listed above. - **Prototype runtime:** `support.js`, `deck-stage.js`, `doc-page.js`, `three-d-stage.js`, `animations-v3.jsx`, `tweaks-panel.jsx`. - **Teaser source:** `teaser.jsx`. - **Design system:** `_ds/` (bundle, styles, tokens, fonts). - **Screen captures:** `Screen Renders.dc.html` in the project root shows every screen, with images in `renders/`. They are not bundled here; ask for them if you want them included.

Launch poster



Opening view

PART 3

Operating

How Semester is run day to day: operations, support, launch, security, trust and compliance.

Support and service operations

docs/business/SUPPORT_AND_SERVICE_OPERATIONS.md

Support and service operations

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Field	Value
Mission	Fast, honest help that feeds the product.
Owner	Founder → support specialist
Inputs	Tickets, status, incidents
System of record	/ops support desk
KPIs	First response; Resolution time; P0/P1 count; CSAT
Reports	Weekly support summary
Meeting cadence	Daily triage in pilot
Risk controls	No student record content in tickets
Approval thresholds	P0 = security/data exposure/broad outage; P1 = critical workflow blocked; P2 degraded with workaround; P3 minor
Required documents	Support plan, Runbooks, Macros, Escalation matrix
Required integrations	Status page, incident console
Current status	docs/launch/Support Plan.html, docs/operate/
Gaps	Help center, KB articles, feature-request taxonomy
Priority	P1
Next action	Write the first 10 KB articles from the pilot paths

Workflows

- Intake → classify → severity → assign → respond → escalate → communicate → resolve → root cause → KB/product update → satisfaction

SEMESTER

Operations handbook · on-call, SLOs, monitoring

Owner: founder (on-call lead until the first engineer joins). Status: draft, October 2026. Companion to the runbooks and the support plan.

Sized for a solo founder: narrow pilot hours, S1 always on, and alerts only for things that need a human now. Everything else goes to the daily review.

1. Service level objectives

Service	SLI	SLO (30-day)	Error budget
Sign-in (SSO)	Successful SSO round-trips ÷ attempts	99.5%	~3.6 h of failures
App availability	Successful page + API requests ÷ total (5xx = bad)	99.5% during pilot hours	~3.6 h
Read-model freshness	Share of minutes SIS projection lag ≤ 15 min	99%	~7.2 h
API latency	p95 of api.* reads	< 800 ms	—
AI gateway	Requests answered or safely refused ÷ total	99%	—
AI safety	Student-record leaks to a provider	0	None: any leak is an S1

These are starting targets for the pilot, not contractual SLAs. Contract SLAs go in the order form after a term of real data.

2. Error budget policy

- Budget above 50%: normal releases.
- Budget 0–50%: only fixes and reliability work; no feature releases to the affected service.
- Budget exhausted: freeze, write a reliability plan, review with the sponsor if a pilot is affected.

3. On-call

Item	Rule
Rotation	Founder until the first engineer; then weekly rotation, handover Monday 09:00
Hours	S1: any hour. S2: 07:00–22:00. S3/S4: pilot hours (08:00–18:00 weekdays)

Item	Rule
Acknowledge	S1 within 15 min, S2 within 30 min
Escalation	On-call → founder → vendor support (Vercel, Supabase, IdP) → institution IT contact
Handover note	Open incidents, alerts silenced and why, risky changes this week
Load limit	More than 2 night pages in a week → next week is reliability work

4. Alerts

Alert	Condition	Severity	Runbook
Error rate high	5xx > 2% for 15 min	S2 (rollback trigger)	R1 Bad release
SSO failures	> 10 failures in 15 min, or IdP metadata error	S2	R2 SSO outage
SIS sync stale	Projection lag > 60 min in pilot hours	S2	R3 SIS sync
Sync mismatches	Reconciliation shows unexplained mismatches	S2	R3 SIS sync
Cross-tenant access attempt	RLS denial spike from one session	S1 (investigate)	R5 Suspected exposure
AI gateway block spike	Blocks > 5× daily baseline	S3	R6 AI gateway
AI provider down	Gateway error rate > 10% for 10 min	S3	R6 AI gateway
Database near limit	Storage > 80% or connections > 80%	S3	R7 Capacity
Backup failed	Nightly backup missing	S2	R4 Backup and restore
Certificate expiry	TLS or SAML cert < 21 days	S3	R2 SSO outage

5. Monitoring

Signal	Source	Where it shows
Errors and traces	Error tracker (no student data in payloads)	/ops incidents
Uptime	External synthetic check on sign-in and Today	/ops SLOs, public status page
Database health	Supabase metrics	/ops site operations
Sync lag and mismatches	Projection worker + reconciliation job	/ops integrations
AI gateway	Gateway logs: blocks, cost, errors	/ops AI gateway
Audit	audit.events	Institution audit explorer

6. Daily and weekly reviews

Cadence	Review
Daily (pilot)	Overnight errors, sync lag, gateway blocks, ticket queue, error budget
Weekly	SLO report, alerts that fired and whether each was useful, top tickets, patch status
Monthly	Restore drill result, access review, dependency report, cost vs finance model

7. Maintenance cadence

Cadence	Task
Weekly	Dependency alerts: patch critical/high within 7 days
Monthly	Restore drill to a scratch project, timed; minor dependency bumps
Quarterly	Access review of all production access; secret rotation; tabletop incident exercise; subprocessor review
Yearly	Pen test (when funded), ACR re-test, policy review, HECVAT refresh

SEMESTER

Runbooks

Owner: on-call. Status: draft, October 2026. Each runbook: detect → stabilise → fix → verify → tell people → write it down. Log every step with time in the incident record in /ops.

R1 · Bad release

1. Confirm the error spike started with the latest deploy (deploy time vs error graph).
2. Promote the previous Vercel deployment. If a migration ran, check it's backwards-compatible; if not, follow R4.
3. Verify error rate back under 1% for 15 min.
4. If a pilot is affected for more than 30 min, tell the sponsor within 1 hour.
5. Open a fix PR with a test that reproduces the failure.

R2 · SSO outage

1. Check the IdP status and the SAML error in logs (metadata, certificate, clock skew, attribute mapping).
2. If the IdP is down: post on the status page, tell the institution IT contact; nothing to fix on our side.
3. If our config: restore the last known-good SP config from the config history; never weaken signature checks.
4. Certificate rotation: exchange new metadata with institution IT, test with a staging account first.
5. Verify a test login per pilot role.

R3 · SIS sync stale or mismatched

1. Open the sync run history: last success, failing step, dead-letter count.
2. Credential or API error: check expiry with institution IT; rotate server-side only.
3. Schema drift: pause the mapping, show the delay badge to users (freshness policy blocks consequential actions automatically), fix mapping in a new version, re-run.
4. Mismatches: never auto-correct. List them, ask the registrar data owner which source is right, re-sync.
5. Replay dead-letter events after the fix; confirm reconciliation shows 0 unexplained mismatches.

R4 · Backup and restore

1. Identify the restore point (point-in-time or nightly backup ID).
2. Restore to a new scratch project first; never overwrite production blindly.
3. Verify row counts and a sample of records against the last reconciliation.
4. Cut over by pointing the app at the restored database, or copy back the affected tables only.
5. Record start and end time: that's the measured recovery time. Monthly drills follow the same steps on a scratch project.

R5 · Suspected student-data exposure

1. **Turn off the affected feature or the pilot cohort flag first.**
2. Preserve evidence: logs, audit events, the request IDs. Don't delete anything.
3. Founder becomes incident commander. Start the incident record (S1).
4. Assess: which records, which tenant, who could see them, for how long.
5. Notify the institution's security contact without undue delay and within the DPA deadline; the institution decides on notices to students.
6. Fix, add a test that proves the fix, re-run RLS suite, re-enable only after the go/no-go check.
7. Postmortem within 5 business days, shared with the institution.

R6 · AI gateway

1. Provider outage: switch to the fallback model if approved for the tenant, else show "Ask Semester is unavailable" with links to the official offices.
2. Block spike: sample blocked prompts (metadata only) to check whether a UI change is sending record fields; fix the client.
3. Cost spike: spend cap stops requests; check for loops or abuse; raise the cap only with founder approval.

R7 · Capacity

1. Check storage, connections and compute in Supabase metrics.
2. Clear stale projections or logs past retention.
3. Upgrade compute size if sustained; note the cost change against the finance model.

R8 · Student can't see their data

1. Confirm membership and role mapping for the user (IdP attributes).
2. Check the student is in the pilot cohort and the feature flag is on.
3. Check sync freshness for that student's records.
4. Reply with the support macro; never paste record content into the ticket.

Support macros

Macro	Use
Sign-in problem	Ask for time and error shown; point to the campus help channel first
Data looks wrong	Explain the registrar is the source; flag for registrar confirmation within one business day
AI and records	Assistant never receives records; how to turn it off
Not in pilot	Pilot is for a set group this term; school will share any rollout

Macro	Use
Known issue	Link the known-issues note; say when we will update
Accessibility barrier	Thank them; workaround if any; fix timeline

SEMESTER

Pilot launch runbook · Vanderbilt University

Owner: founder. Status: draft, October 2026. Pilot dates aren't set yet, so every date below is relative to launch day (L).

Rule: nothing launches until every go/no-go gate is green, with evidence attached. "Ready" means tested in staging with the institution's real configuration, not described in a document.

1. Go / no-go gates

Gate	Evidence required	Owner	Due
DPA / FERPA addendum signed	Countersigned PDF on file	Founder	L−45
HECVAT Full submitted and accepted	Vanderbilt IT acceptance email	Founder	L−30
Cyber and E&O insurance bound	Certificates of insurance sent to Vanderbilt	Founder	L−30
VPAT / ACR delivered	ACR document and test log	Founder	L−30
SAML SSO working in staging	Test logins for each pilot role	Eng	L−21
SIS read sync reconciled	Reconciliation report: 0 unexplained mismatches	Eng	L−14
RLS tests pass	CI run link; company roles can't read student tables	Eng	L−14
AI gateway blocks student records	Red-team test log	Eng	L−14
Backups and restore drill	Restore timed and documented	Eng	L−10
Incident response contacts exchanged	Named contacts on both sides	Founder	L−7
Success measures agreed	Signed one-page measures sheet	Founder + sponsor	L−7

2. Timeline

When	What
L−45 to L−30	Contracts, insurance, security review, accessibility report
L−30 to L−14	SSO, SIS connection, role mapping, staging data checks
L−14 to L−7	Staff training (advisors, registrar, Student Life), dry run with test accounts

When	What
L−3	Final go/no-go meeting with the sponsor, then freeze changes
L	Turn on for the pilot group, send the welcome email, open the watch room
L+1 to L+7	Daily check-ins, then the week-1 review
End of term	Results report against the agreed measures

3. Launch day

Time	Step	Check
08:00	Confirm status page green and SIS sync fresh (<15 min)	Ops console
08:30	Enable pilot cohort flag	Test login per role
09:00	Institution sends the welcome email (from Vanderbilt, not Semester)	Sponsor confirms
09:00–17:00	Watch errors, sign-in failures, support tickets and AI gateway blocks	Hourly note in the log
17:00	Day-1 summary to the sponsor	Sent

4. Rollback

Trigger any one of these: a suspected student-data exposure; SSO down for more than 30 minutes; SIS data shown wrongly to a student; error rate above 2% for 15 minutes.

Steps: 1) turn off the pilot cohort flag; 2) show the holding message; 3) tell the Vanderbilt contact within 1 hour; 4) if student data might be involved, follow the incident response plan and the DPA notice terms; 5) fix, retest in staging, and re-run the go/no-go before re-enabling.

5. Support in week 1

Staff questions go to the support desk (target first response under 1 hour during pilot hours). Student questions go through Vanderbilt's help channel first and are escalated to Semester only when needed. Every issue is logged with its cause and fix, and the log feeds the week-1 review.

6. Communications

Audience	Message	Sender
Pilot students	What it is, what data it uses, how to get help	Vanderbilt
Pilot staff	Training links, the support path, what's in scope	Vanderbilt + Semester
Sponsor	Daily in week 1, then weekly	Founder

Audience	Message	Sender
Public	Nothing until both sides approve. The Vanderbilt name is cleared for use, but the wording is agreed first	Founder

SEMESTER

Production cutover plan · Vanderbilt pilot

Owner: founder. Status: draft, October 2026. Companion to the launch runbook. Times are relative to launch day (L); clock times are US Central.

Scope: moving the pilot from staging to production — environments, identity, SIS data, configuration and DNS. The runbook's go/no-go gates must all be green before step C1 starts. Every step names its check and its undo.

1. Environments

Environment	Hosting	Data	Who has access
Local	Supabase CLI + Next.js dev	Synthetic seed only	Engineers
Staging	Vercel preview + Supabase staging project	Synthetic, plus Vanderbilt test IdP accounts	Engineers, Vanderbilt IT testers
Production	Vercel production + Supabase production project (separate keys)	Real student records under the DPA	Named operators only, MFA required, access logged

Production never receives a copy of staging data, and staging never receives production data. Secrets are set per environment and are not shared.

2. Freeze and roles

Item	Rule
Code freeze	From L−3 after the final go/no-go. Only fixes for a failed cutover check, approved by the founder.
Change log	Every cutover step is logged with time, operator, result and evidence link.
Operator	Founder (or contracted engineer) runs the steps; a second person reads the checklist aloud where available.
Vanderbilt contacts	IT (SSO, SIS), registrar data owner, pilot sponsor — named in the incident contact sheet.

3. Cutover sequence

#	When	Step	Check	Undo
C1	L−2 09:00	Apply migrations to production; run RLS test suite against production schema (no data yet)	CI link: all RLS tests pass; company roles read 0 student rows	Restore empty-schema snapshot

#	When	Step	Check	Undo
C2	L−2 11:00	Set production secrets: Supabase keys, SAML certs, SIS read credentials, AI gateway key, email sender	Secret checklist signed; no staging values present	Rotate and re-set
C3	L−2 13:00	Vanderbilt IT registers the production SAML service provider; exchange metadata	Test login for each pilot role succeeds; attributes map to the right role	Disable SP; stay on staging
C4	L−2 15:00	Load institution configuration: terms, roles, pilot cohort, feature switches (community and marketplace off unless agreed)	Config export matches the signed scope sheet	Re-import previous config
C5	L−1 08:00	First SIS read sync into production (pilot cohort only)	Reconciliation: row counts match the registrar extract; 0 unexplained mismatches	Truncate synced tables; re-run
C6	L−1 11:00	Registrar spot-check: 25 random students viewed by a registrar user	Registrar signs off in writing	Truncate and re-sync
C7	L−1 13:00	Point DNS (app subdomain) to Vercel production; confirm TLS	Certificate valid; HSTS set; status page live	Revert DNS record
C8	L−1 15:00	Take baseline backup; record point-in-time recovery window	Backup ID logged; restore drill already passed (runbook gate)	—
C9	L−1 16:00	Enable staff accounts for advisors, registrar, Student Life (student cohort flag still off)	Each staff role logs in and sees only scoped records	Disable staff flag
C10	L 08:00	Fresh SIS sync; confirm lag < 15 min	Ops console green	Hold launch
C11	L 08:30	Enable pilot student cohort flag	Five test students sign in end to end	Turn flag off; holding message

4. Point of no return

There isn’t one. Until C11, students see nothing. After C11, the cohort flag turns everything off in under a minute without deleting data. Data is deleted only on Vanderbilt’s written instruction under the DPA.

5. Verification after cutover

Check	How	Pass
Role isolation	Sign in as each pilot role; try a cross-role URL	Denied and logged
AI gateway	Send a prompt containing a test student ID	Blocked; event in gateway log
Audit log	View a record as an advisor	Entry with actor, record and time

Check	How	Pass
Email	Trigger a test notification	Delivered from the agreed sender; no student data in body
Performance	Load the student home and advisor queue	Under 2 s on campus Wi-Fi

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6. Sign-off

Cutover is complete when C1–C11 and every section 5 check are logged with evidence, and the sponsor confirms by email. The log is attached to the week-1 review.

SEMESTER

Day-1 and week-1 support plan · Vanderbilt pilot

Owner: founder. Status: draft, October 2026. Companion to the launch runbook and cutover plan.

Reality check: Semester is one founder. This plan is sized for that: narrow hours, a clear first line at Vanderbilt, and a short list of things that get an immediate response.

1. Who answers what

Line	Who	Handles
Tier 0 — self-help	In-app help, User guide, FAQ	How-to questions, where things are
Tier 1 — campus	Vanderbilt help channel (named by IT)	Sign-in, account, routing
Tier 2 — Semester	Founder via the support desk	Bugs, wrong data shown, configuration, staff questions
Tier 3 — vendors	Vercel, Supabase, IdP, SIS vendor	Platform outages, through their status pages and support

2. Severity and response targets

Severity	Example	First response	Updates
S1 — data or safety	Possible student-data exposure; one student sees another’s record	15 min, any hour in week 1	Hourly; incident plan and DPA notice terms apply
S2 — blocked	SSO down; SIS data wrong; app unavailable	30 min, 07:00–22:00	Every 2 h
S3 — degraded	One feature broken; slow pages	1 h during pilot hours (08:00–18:00)	Daily
S4 — question	How do I…; feature request	Same business day	On close

Rollback triggers in the runbook override this table: if one fires, turn the cohort flag off first, then respond.

3. Day 1

Time	Activity
07:30	Read overnight errors, sync lag and gateway blocks; open the watch log
08:00–17:00	Watch room: support desk, error tracker, sign-in failures, SIS lag. Hourly note in the log.
10:00, 14:00	Check-in with the Vanderbilt Tier 1 lead: new themes, anything to escalate

Time	Activity
17:00	Day-1 summary to the sponsor: sign-ins, tickets by severity, open issues, next steps
21:00	Last check of the S1/S2 queue; phone on for S1

4. Week-1 rhythm

Day	Focus
L+1	Fix top day-1 issues; publish a known-issues note to Tier 1
L+2	Staff office hour (30 min) for advisors and registrar
L+3	Re-run SIS reconciliation; registrar spot-checks 10 records
L+4	Student feedback pulse (3 questions, in-app, optional)
L+5	Week-1 review with the sponsor

Daily: 17:00 summary to the sponsor, known-issues note refreshed, no untriaged tickets.

5. Ready-to-send replies

Situation	Reply outline
Can’t sign in	Use your Vanderbilt login at the pilot link. If it fails, contact the campus help channel with the time and the error shown.
My information looks wrong	Semester shows what the registrar holds. We’ve flagged it and the registrar will confirm within one business day. Nothing here changes your official record.
Is AI reading my records?	No. The assistant never receives student records. It sees only what you type, and you can turn it off in settings.
I’m not in the pilot	The pilot is for a set group this term. Your school will share any wider rollout.

6. Logging

Every ticket records severity, role, area, cause, fix and time to resolve. No student record content goes in a ticket; reference records by internal ID only.

7. Week-1 review agenda

Item	Output
Sign-in and adoption by role	Numbers from the ops console
Tickets by severity and cause	Top 5 causes and their fixes
Data accuracy	Reconciliation and spot-check results

Item	Output
Incidents	None, or the incident report
Changes for week 2	Agreed list; anything that needs a go/no-go gate re-run

8. Exit to steady state

Week-1 cover ends when there are no open S1/S2 issues, two consecutive days pass without a new S2, reconciliation is clean, and the sponsor agrees. Support then moves to pilot hours (08:00–18:00 weekdays, S1 always on) and sponsor updates go weekly.